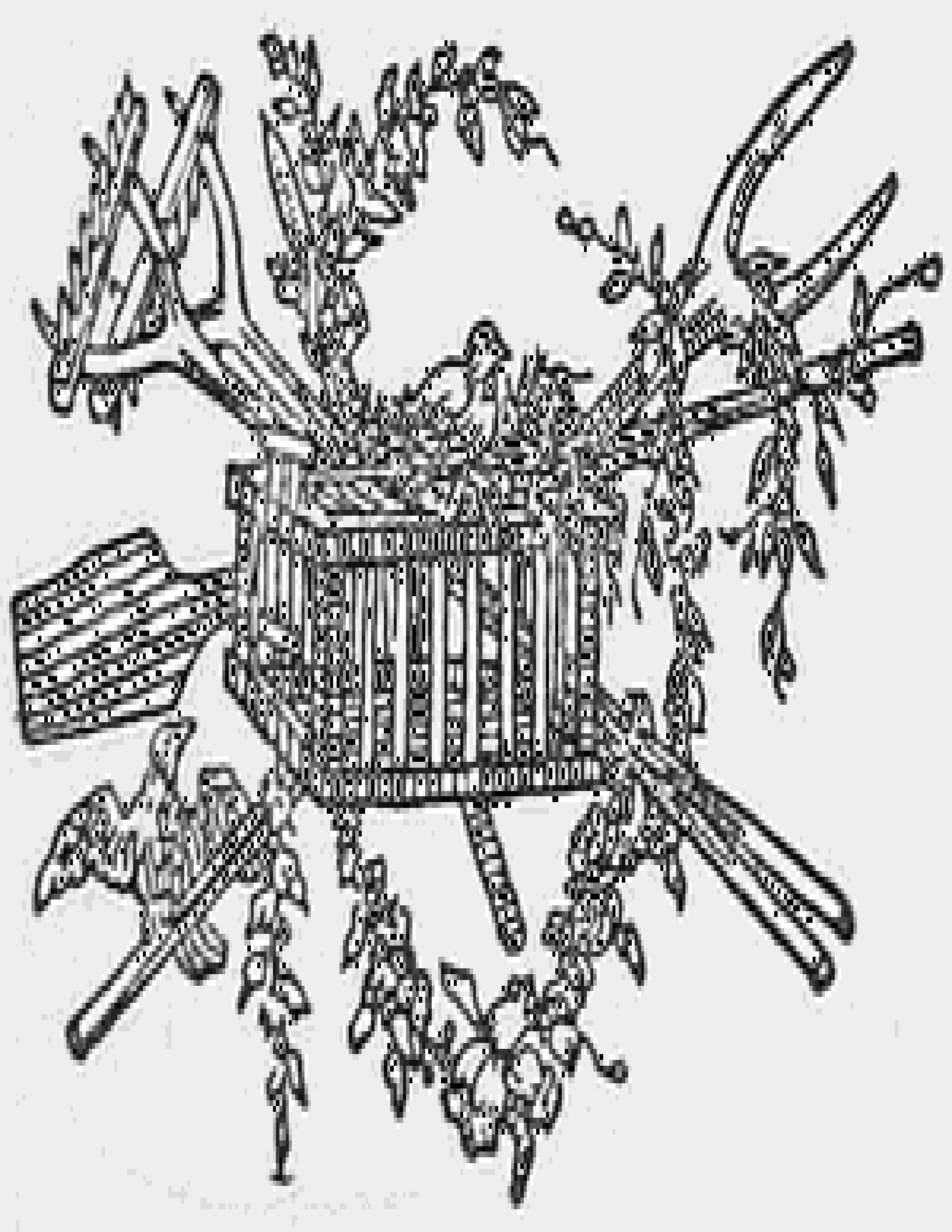
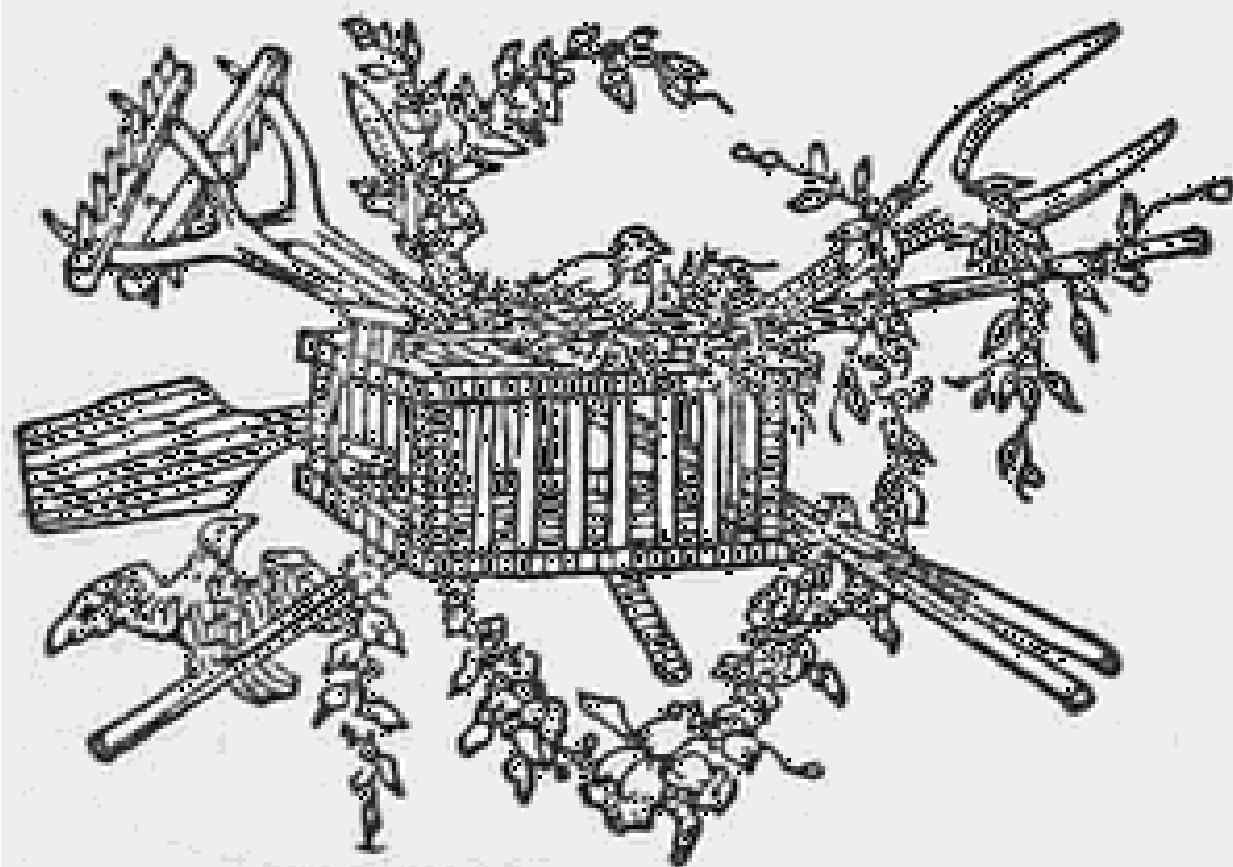






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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE MELODY
OF EARTH ***

THE MELODY OF EARTH

**AN ANTHOLOGY
OF GARDEN AND NATURE POEMS
FROM PRESENT-DAY POETS**

SELECTED

AND ARRANGED BY

MRS. WALDO RICHARDS

BOSTON AND NEW YORK
HOUGHTON MIFFLIN COMPANY
1918

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Published March 1918

TO
MY DEAR SISTER
A LOVER OF GARDENS

FOREWORD

How many of us are conscious of the subtle melodies, "through which the myriad lisplings of the earth find perfect speech"?

Our poets are listeners; their ears are tuned to the magic call of secret voices that we who are not singers may never hear. They capture the "Melody" in chalices of song, and their message is: that whosoever will bend his ear to earth, may hear from field and furrow, from the many-bladed grass and the soft-petalled flowers—in the sighing of the pine tree or the rustle of leaves—an immortal music that revivifies the soul.

In the quiet tilled spots of earth, from time immemorial, men have sown rare seeds of poetic thought that have flowered into song. Amiel wrote in his *Journal*: "All seed-sowing is a mysterious thing whether the seed fall into earth or into souls; man is a husbandman, and his work rightly understood is to develop life, to sow it everywhere." The poets are our seed-sowers, and *their* work is to develop life and to enrich it. They are never happier than when writing about gardens and the growing things of earth—at once their symbol and their solace. In turn gardens have in the poets their happiest interpreters.

Here I have culled and gathered together songs and poems that reflect the melody and harmony of Nature's forces. In these days of the world's travail, let us seek inspiration and content within the delightful confines of these Gardens of Poetry.

GERTRUDE MOORE RICHARDS

March, 1918

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With very few exceptions only the poets who are writing to-day, or who have written within a period of ten years, are represented in this collection; and certain favorite poems peculiarly suited to the spirit of this book which chanced to be included in *High Tide* may be missed here. G. M. R.

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WITHIN GARDEN WALLS

EARTH

*Grasshopper, your fairy song
And my poem alike belong
To the deep and silent earth
From which all poetry has birth;
All we say and all we sing
Is but as the murmuring
Of that drowsy heart of hers
When from her deep dream she stirs:
If we sorrow, or rejoice,
You and I are but her voice.*

*Deftly does the dust express
In mind her hidden loveliness,
And from her cool silence stream
The cricket's cry and Dante's dream:
For the earth that breeds the trees
Breeds cities too, and symphonies,
Equally her beauty flows
Into a savior or a rose.*

*Even as the growing grass
Up from the soil religions pass,
And the field that bears the rye
Bears parables and prophecy.
Out of the earth the poem grows
Like the lily, or the rose;*

*And all that man is or yet may be,
Is but herself in agony
Toiling up the steep ascent
Towards the complete
 accomplishment
When all dust shall be, the whole
Universe, one conscious soul.*

*Yea, and this my poem, too,
Is part of her as dust and dew,
Wherein herself she doth declare
Through my lips, and say her prayer.*

JOHN HALL WHEELLOCK

THE FURROW

Stride the hill, sower,
Up to the sky-ridge,
Flinging the seed,
Scattering, exultant!
Mouthing great rhythms
To the long sea beats
On the wide shore, behind
The ridge of the hillside.

Below in the darkness—
The slumber of mothers—
The cradles at rest—
The fire-seed sleeping
Deep in white ashes!

Give to darkness and sleep:
O sower, O seer!

Give me to the Earth.
With the seed I would enter.
O! the growth thro' the silence
From strength to new strength;
Then the strong bursting forth
Against primal forces,
To laugh in the sunshine,
To gladden the world!

PADRAIC COLUM

"THERE IS STRENGTH IN THE SOIL"

There is strength in the soil;
In the earth there is laughter and
 youth.
There is solace and hope in the
 upturned loam.
And lo, I shall plant my soul in it here
 like a seed!
And forth it shall come to me as a
 flower of song;
For I know it is good to get back to
 the earth
That is orderly, placid, all-patient!
It is good to know how quiet
And noncommittal it breathes,
This ample and opulent bosom
That must some day nurse us all!

ARTHUR STRINGER

IN THE WOMB

Still rests the heavy share on the dark
soil:
Upon the black mould thick the dew-
damp lies:
The horse waits patient: from his
lowly toil
The ploughboy to the morning lifts
his eyes.

The unbudding hedgerows dark
against day's fires
Glitter with gold-lit crystals: on the
rim
Over the unregarding city's spires
The lonely beauty shines alone for
him.

And day by day the dawn or dark
unfolds
And feeds with beauty eyes that
cannot see
How in her womb the mighty mother
moulds
The infant spirit for eternity.

"A. E."
(GEORGE WILLIAM RUSSELL)

PUTTING IN THE SEED

You come to fetch me from my work
to-night
When supper's on the table, and we'll
see
If I can leave off burying the white

Soft petals fallen from the apple tree.

(Soft petals, yes, but not so barren
quite,
Mingled with these, smooth bean and
wrinkled pea;)
And go along with you ere you lose
sight
Of what you came for and become
like me,

Slave to a springtime passion for the
earth.
How Love burns through the Putting
in the Seed
On through the watching for that
early birth
When, just as the soil tarnishes with
weed,

The sturdy seedling with arched body
comes
Shouldering its way and shedding the
earth crumbs.

ROBERT FROST

THE WHISPER OF EARTH

In the misty hollow, shyly greening
branches
Softened to the south wind, bending to
the rain.
From the moistened earthland flutter
little whispers,

Breathing hidden beauty, innocent of
stain.

Little plucking fingers tremble
through the grasses,
Little silent voices sigh the dawn of
spring,
Little burning earth-flames break the
awful stillness,
Little crying wind-sounds come
before the King.

Powers, dominations urge the
budding of the crocus,
Cherubim are singing in the moist
cool stone,
Seraphim are calling through the
channels of the lily,
God has heard the earth-cry and
journeys to His throne.

EDWARD J. O'BRIEN

"WITHIN THE GARDEN THERE IS HEALTHFULNESS"

Within the garden there is
healthfulness.

Lavishly it gives it us
In light that cleaves
To every movement of its thousand
hands
Of palms and leaves.

And the good shade where it accepts,
After long journeyings,
Our steps,

Pours on the weary limb
A force of life and sweetness like
Its mosses dim.

When the lake is playing with the
wind and sun.
It seems a crimson heart
Within, all ardent, has begun
To throb with the moving wave;
The gladiolus and the fervent rose,
Which in their splendor move
unshadowèd,
Upon their vital stems expose
Their cups of gold and red.

Within the garden there is
healthfulness.

EMILE VERHAEREN

IN A GARDEN

I stood within a Garden during rain
Uncovering to the drops my lifted
brow:
O joyous fancy, to imagine now
I slip, with trees and clouds, the
social chain,
Alone with nature, naught to lose or
gain
Nor even to become; no, just to be
A moment's personal essence, wholly
free
From needs that mold the heart to
forms of pain.
Arise, I cried, and celebrate the hour!

Acclaim serener gladness; if it fail,
New courage, nobler vision, will
 survive
That I have known my kinship to the
 flower,
My brotherhood with rain, and in this
 vale
Have been a moment's friend to all
 alive.

HORACE HOLLEY

A SHOWER

You may have seen, when winds were
 high,
That hesitant buds would not unfold
In garden-borders chill and dry,
Bright with the Easter-lilies' gold.

Then, suddenly, would come a
 shower—
The big breeze veering to the west—
And happier music filled the bower
Above the thrush's hidden nest:

The elm-tree's inconspicuous bloom
Vanished amidst her little leaves;
In box and bay a fragrant gloom
Inspired the wren's recitatives:

The woods assumed their delicate
 green
And spoke in songs that brought you
 bliss:
Ay, and your withered heart has been

Quickened on such a day as this!

ROWLAND THIRLMERE

THE RAIN

I hear leaves drinking Rain;
 I hear rich leaves on top
Giving the poor beneath
 Drop after drop;
'Tis a sweet noise to hear
These green leaves drinking near.

And when the Sun comes out,
 After this Rain shall stop,
A wondrous Light will fill
 Each dark, round drop;
I hope the Sun shines bright;
'Twill be a lovely sight.

WILLIAM H. DAVIES

THE DEWS

We come and go, as the breezes blow,
 But whence or where
Hath ne'er been told in the legends
 old
 By the dreaming seer.
The welcome rain to the parching
 plain
 And the languid leaves,
The rattling hail on the burnished
 mail

Of the serried sheaves,
The silent snow on the wintry brow
Of the aged year,
Wends each his way in the track of
day
From a clouded sphere:
But still as the fog in the dismal bog
Where the shifting sheen
Of the spectral lamp lights the
marshes damp,
With a flash unseen
We drip through the night from the
starlids bright,
On the sleeping flowers,
And deep in their breast is our
perfumed rest
Through the darkened hours:
But again with the day we are up and
away
With our stolen dyes,
To paint all the shrouds of the drifting
clouds
In the eastern skies.

JOHN B. TABB

SONNET

It may be so; but let the unknown be.
We, on this earth, are servants of the
sun.
Out of the sun comes all the quick in
me,
His golden touch is life to everyone.

His power it is that makes us spin
 through space,
His youth is April and his manhood
 bread,
Beauty is but a looking on his face,
He clears the mind, he makes the
 roses red.

What he may be, who knows? But we
 are his,
We roll through nothing round him,
 year by year,
The withering leaves upon a tree
 which is
Each with his greed, his little power,
 his fear.

What we may be, who knows? But
 everyone
Is dust on dust a servant of the sun.

JOHN MASEFIELD

CHARM: TO BE SAID IN THE SUN

I reach my arms up, to the sky,
And golden vine on vine
Of sunlight showered wild and high,
Around my brows I twine.

I wreathe, I wind it everywhere,
The burning radiancy
Of brightness that no eye may dare,
To be the strength of me.

Come, redness of the crystalline,
Come green, come hither blue

And violet—all alive within,
For I have need of you.

Come honey-hue and flush of gold,
And through the pallor run,
With pulse on pulse of manifold
New largess of the Sun!

O steep the silence till it sing!
O glories from the height,
Come down, where I am garlanding
With light, a child of light!

JOSEPHINE PRESTON PEABODY

THE DIALS

With fingers softer than the touch of
 death
The sundial writes the passing of the
 day,
The hours unfolding slow to twilight
 gray,
The gleaming moments vanish in a
 breath.

But sunny hours alone the sundial
 names;
All unrecorded are the midnight
 spans
And vain within the dusk the watcher
 scans
The marble face; thereon no record
 flames.

So on eternal dials that God may
 hold,

And those more humble in the human
heart,
No bitter deeds their passing hours
impart;
Kind deeds alone are marked in
fadeless gold!

ARTHUR WALLACE PEACH

TO A NEW SUNDIAL

Oh, Sundial, you should not be
young,
Or fresh and fair, or spick and span!
None should remember when began
Your tenure here, nor whence you
sprung!

Like ancient cromlech notch'd and
scarr'd,
I would have had you sadly tow'r
Above this world of leaf and flower
All ivy-tress'd and lichen-starr'd;

Ambassador of Time and Fate,
In contrast stern to bud and bloom,
Seeming half temple and half tomb,
And wholly solemn and sedate;

Till, one with God's own works on
earth,
The lake, the vale, the mountain-
brow,
We might have come to count you
now

Whose home was here before our
birth.

But lo! a priggish, upstart thing—
Set here to tell so old a truth—
How fleeting are our days of youth—
You, that were only made last spring!

Go to!... What sermon can you
preach,
Oh, mushroom—mentor pert and
new?
We are too old to learn of you
What you are all too young to teach!

Yet, Sundial, you and I may swear
Eternal friendship, none the less,
For I'll respect your youthfulness
If you'll forgive my silver hair!

VIOLET FANE

THE FOUNTAIN

I thought my garden finished. I beheld
Each bush bee-visited; a green charm quelled
The louder winds to music; soft boughs made
Patches of silver dusk and purple shade—
And yet I felt a lack of something still.

There was a little, sleepy-footed rill
That lapsed among sun-burnished stones, where slept
Fish, rainbow-scaled, while dragon-flies, adept,
Balanced on bending grass.

All perfect? No.
My garden lacked a fountain's upward flow.

I coaxed the brook's young Naiad to resign
Her meadow wildness, building her a shrine
Of worship, where each ravished waif of air
Might wanton in the brightness of her hair.

So here my fountain flows, loved of the wind,
To every vagrant, aimless gust inclined,
Yet constant ever to its source. It greets
The face of morning, wavering windy sheets
Of woven silver; sheer it climbs the noon,
A shaft of bronze; and underneath the moon
It sleeps in pearl and opal. In the storm
It streams far out, a wild, gray, blowing form;
While on calm days it heaps above the lake,—
Pelting the dreaming lilies half awake,
And pattering jewels on each wide, green frond,—
Recurrent pyramids of diamond!

HARRY KEMP

THE PAGEANTRY OF GARDENS

THE BIRTH OF THE FLOWERS

*God spoke! and from the arid scene
Sprang rich and verdant bowers,
Till all the earth was soft with green,*

—

He smiled; and there were flowers.

MARY MCNEIL FENOLLOSA

THE WELCOME

God spreads a carpet soft and green
O'er which we pass;
A thick-piled mat of jeweled sheen—
And that is Grass.

Delightful music woos the ear;
The grass is stirred
Down to the heart of every spear—
Ah, that's a Bird.

Clouds roll before a blue immense
That stretches high
And lends the soul exalted sense—
That scroll's a Sky.

Green rollers flaunt their sparkling
crests;

Their jubilee
Extols brave Captains and their
 quests—
And that is Sea.

New-leaping grass, the feathery flute,
 The sapphire ring,
The sea's full-voiced, profound
 salute,—
Ah, this is Spring!

ARTHUR POWELL

THE JOY OF THE SPRINGTIME

Springtime, O Springtime, what is
 your essence,
The lilt of a bulbul, the laugh of a
 rose,
The dance of the dew on the wings of
 a moonbeam,
The voice of the zephyr that sings as
 he goes,
The hope of a bride or the dream of a
 maiden
Watching the petals of gladness
 unclose?

Springtime, O Springtime, what is
 your secret,
The bliss at the core of your magical
 mirth,
That quickens the pulse of the
 morning to wonder
And hastens the seeds of all beauty to
 birth,

That captures the heavens and
conquers to blossom
The roots of delight in the heart of the
earth?

SAROJINI NAIDU

SPRING

At the first hour, it was as if one said, "Arise."
At the second hour, it was as if one said, "Go forth."
And the winter constellations that are like patient ox-
eyes
Sank below the white horizon at the north.

At the third hour, it was as if one said, "I thirst;"
At the fourth hour, all the earth was still:
Then the clouds suddenly swung over, stooped, and
burst;
And the rain flooded valley, plain and hill.

At the fifth hour, darkness took the throne;
At the sixth hour, the earth shook and the wind cried;
At the seventh hour, the hidden seed was sown,
At the eighth hour, it gave up the ghost and died.

At the ninth hour, they sealed up the tomb;
And the earth was then silent for the space of three
hours.
But at the twelfth hour, a single lily from the gloom
Shot forth, and was followed by a whole host of
flowers.

JOHN GOULD FLETCHER

PRIMAVERA

Spirit immortal of mortality,
Imperishable faith, calm miracle
Of resurrection, truth no tongue
can tell,
No brain conceive,—now
witnessed utterly
In this new testament of earth and
sea,—
To us thy gospel! Where the
acorn fell
The oak-tree springs: no seed is
infidel!
Once more, O Wonder, flower
and field and tree
Reveal thy secret and significance!
And we, who share unutterable
things
And feel the foretaste of eternity,
Haply shall learn thy meaning and
perchance
Set free the soul to lift immortal
wings
And cross the frontiers of
infinity.

GEORGE CABOT LODGE

THE GREEN O' THE SPRING

Sure, afther all the winther,
An' afther all the snow,
'Tis fine to see the sunshine,
'Tis fine to feel its glow;

'Tis fine to see the buds break
On boughs that bare have been—
But best of all to Irish eyes
'Tis grand to see the green!

Sure, afther all the winther,
An' afther all the snow,
'Tis fine to hear the brooks sing
As on their way they go;
'Tis fine to hear at mornin'
The voice of robineen,
But best of all to Irish eyes
'Tis grand to see the green!

Sure, here in grim New England
The spring is always slow,
An' every bit o' green grass
Is kilt wid frost and snow;
Ah, many a heart is weary
The winther days, I ween
But oh, the joy when springtime
comes
An' brings the blessed green!

DENIS A. MCCARTHY

AN APRIL MORNING

Once more in misted April
The world is growing green.
Along the winding river
The plumey willows lean.

Beyond the sweeping meadows
The looming mountains rise,
Like battlements of dreamland

Against the brooding skies.

In every wooded valley
The buds are breaking through,
As though the heart of all things
No languor ever knew.

The golden-wings and bluebirds
Call to their heavenly choirs.
The pines are blued and drifted
With smoke of brushwood fires.

And in my sister's garden
Where little breezes run,
The golden daffodillies
Are blowing in the sun.

BLISS CARMAN

"WITH MEMORIES AND ODORS"

With memories and odors
The wind is warm and mild;
The earth is like a mother
Where leaps the unborn child.

The grackles flock returning
Like rain-clouds from the south.
And all the world lies yearning
Toward summer, mouth to mouth.

How soft the hills and hazy
Seen through the open door!—
The crocus shines, a virgin,
White from the grassy floor.

The children whirl around in a ring,

And laugh and sing, and dance and
sing:
But the blackbird whistles clear,
O clear,
"The Spring, the Spring!"

JOHN HALL WHEELLOCK

APRIL RAIN

Fall, rain! You are the blood of
coming blossom,
You shall be music in the young
birds' throats,
You shall be breaking, soon, in silver
notes;
A virgin laughter in the young earth's
bosom.
Oh, that I could with you reënter
earth,
Pass through her heart and come
again to sun,
Out of her fertile dark to sing and run
In loveliness and fragrance of new
mirth!
Fall, rain! Into the dust I go with you,
Pierce the remaining snows with
subtle fire,
Warming the frozen roots with soft
desire,
Dreams of ascending leaves and
flowers new.
I am no longer body,—I am blood
Seeking for some new loveliness of
shape;

Dark loveliness that dreams of new
 escape,
The sun-surrender of unclosing bud.
Take me, O Earth! and make me what
 you will;
I feel my heart with mingled music
 fill.

CONRAD AIKEN

WHILE APRIL RAIN WENT BY

Under a budding hedge I hid
 While April rain went by,
But little drops came slipping
 through,
 Fresh from a laughing sky:

A-many little scurrying drops,
 Laughing the song they sing,
Soon found me where I sought to
 hide,
 And pelted me with Spring.

And I lay back and let them pelt,
 And dreamt deliciously
Of lusty leaves and lady-blossoms
 And baby-buds I'd see

When April rain had laughed the land
 Out of its wintry way,
And coaxed all growing things to
 greet
 With gracious garb the May.

SHAEMAS O SHEEL

SPRING

The dews drip roses on the meadows
Where the meek daisies dot the
 sward.

And Æolus whispers through the
 shadows,

"Behold the handmaid of the Lord!"
The golden news the skylark waketh
And 'thwart the heavens his flight is
 curled;

Attend ye as the first note breaketh
And chrism droppeth on the world.

The velvet dusk still haunts the
 stream

Where Pan makes music light and
 gay.

The mountain mist hath caught a
 beam

And slowly weeps itself away.

The young leaf bursts its chrysalis
And gem-like hangs upon the bough,
Where the mad throstle sings in bliss
O'er earth's rejuvenated brow.

ENVOI

Slowly fall, O golden sands,
Slowly fall and let me sing,
Wrapt in the ecstasy of youth,
The wild delights of Spring.

FRANCIS LEDWIDGE

APRIL WEATHER

Oh, hush, my heart, and take thine
 ease,
For here is April weather!
The daffodils beneath the trees
Are all a-row together.

The thrush is back with his old note;
The scarlet tulip blowing;
And white—ay, white as my love's
 throat—
The dogwood boughs are glowing.

The lilac bush is sweet again;
Down every wind that passes,
Fly flakes from hedgerow and from
 lane;
The bees are in the grasses.

And Grief goes out, and Joy comes
 in,
And Care is but a feather;
And every lad his love can win,
For here is April weather.

LIZETTE WOODWORTH REESE

DAFFODILS

There flames the first gay daffodil
Where winter-long the snows have
 lain:
Who buried Love, all spent and still?
There flames the first gay daffodil.

Go, Love's alive on yonder hill,
And yours for asking, joy and pain,
There flames the first gay daffodil
Where winter-long the snows have
lain!

RUTH GUTHRIE HARDING

THE CROCUS FLAME

The Easter sunrise flung a bar of gold
O'er the awakening wold.
What was thine answer, O thou
brooding earth,
What token of re-birth,
Of tender vernal mirth,
Thou the long-prisoned in the bonds
of cold?

Under the kindling panoply which
God
Spreads over tree and clod,
I looked far abroad.
Umber the sodden reaches seemed
and seer
As when the dying year,
With rime-white sandals shod,
Faltered and fell upon its frozen bier.
Of some rathe quickening, some
divine
Renascence not a sign!

And yet, and yet,
With touch of viol-chord, with
mellow fret,

The lyric South amid the bough-tops
 stirred,
And one lone bird
An unexpected jet
Of song projected through the
 morning blue,
As though some wondrous hidden
 thing it knew.

And so I gathered heart, and cried
 again:
"O earth, make plain,
At this matutinal hour,
The triumph and the power
Of life eternal over death and pain,
Although it be but by some simple
 flower!"

And then, with sudden light,
Was dowered my veiled sight,
And I beheld in a sequestered place
A slender crocus show its sun-bright
 face.

O miracle of Grace,
Earth's Easter answer came,
The revelation of transfiguring Might,
In that small crocus flame!

CLINTON SCOLLARD

THE EARLY GODS

It is the time of violets.
 It is the very day
When in the shadow of the wood
 Spring shall have her say,

Remembering how the early gods
Came up the violet way.
Are there not violets
And gods—
To-day?

WITTER BYNNER

A TULIP GARDEN

Guarded within the old red wall's
 embrace,
 Marshalled like soldiers in gay
 company,
 The tulips stand arrayed. Here
 infantry
Wheels out into the sunlight. What
 bold grace
Sets off their tunics, white with
 crimson lace!
 Here are platoons of gold-frosted
 cavalry,
 With scarlet sabres tossing in the
 eye
Of purple batteries, every gun in
 place.
 Forward they come, with flaunting
 colors spread,
With torches burning, stepping out in
 time
 To some quick, unheard march.
 Our ears are dead,
We cannot catch the tune. In
 pantomime
 Parades the army. With our utmost
 powers

We hear the wind stream through a
bed of flowers.

AMY LOWELL

TULIPS

Brave little fellows in crimsons and
yellows,
Coming while breezes of April are
cold,
Winter can't freeze you, he flies when
he sees you
Thrusting your spears through the
redolent mold.

Jolly Dutch flowers, rejoicing in
showers,
Drink! ere the pageant of Spring
passes by!
Hold your carousals to Robin's
espousals,
Lifting rich cups for the wine of
the sky!

Dignified urbans in glossy silk
turbans,
Burgherlike blossoms of gardens
and squares,
Nodding so solemn by fountain and
column,
What is the talk of your weighty
affairs?

Pollen and honey (for such is your
money),—

Gossip and freight of the
 chaffering bee,—
Prospects of growing,—what colors
 are showing,—
News of rare tulips from over the
 sea?

Loitering near you, how often I hear
 you,
Just ere your petals at twilight are
 furled,
Laugh through the grasses while
 Evelyn passes,
"There goes the loveliest flower in
 the world!"

ARTHUR GUITERMAN

A WHITE IRIS

Tall and clothed in samite,
Chaste and pure,
In smooth armor,—
Your head held high
In its helmet
Of silver:
Jean D'Arc riding
Among the sword blades!

Has Spring for you
Wrought visions,
As it did for her
In a garden?

PAULINE B. BARRINGTON

MAY IS BUILDING HER HOUSE

May is building her house. With
apple blooms
She is roofing over the glimmering
rooms;
Of the oak and the beech hath she
builded its beams,
And, spinning all day at her secret
looms,
With arras of leaves each wind-
swayed wall
She pictureth over, and peopleth it all
With echoes and dreams,
And singing of streams.

May is building her house of petal
and blade;
Of the roots of the oak is the flooring
made,
With a carpet of mosses and lichen
and clover,
Each small miracle over and over,
And tender, travelling green things
strayed.

Her windows the morning and
evening star,
And her rustling doorways, ever ajar
With the coming and going
Of fair things blowing,
The thresholds of the four winds are.

May is building her house. From the
dust of things
She is making the songs and the
flowers and the wings;

From October's tossed and trodden
 gold
She is making the young year out
 of the old;
Yea! out of winter's flying sleet
She is making all the summer
 sweet,
And the brown leaves spurned of
 November's feet
She is changing back again to
 spring's.

RICHARD LE GALLIENNE

THE MAGNOLIA

Deep in the wood, of scent and song
 the daughter,
Perfect and bright is the magnolia
 born;
White as a flake of foam upon still
 water,
White as soft fleece upon rough
 brambles torn.

Hers is a cup a workman might have
 fashioned
Of Grecian marble in an age
 remote.
Hers is a beauty perfect and
 impassioned,
As when a woman bares her
 rounded throat.

There is a tale of how the moon, her
 lover,

Holds her enchanted by some
magic spell;
Something about a dove that broods
above her,
Or dies within her breast—I cannot
tell.

I cannot say where I have heard the
story,
Upon what poet's lips; but this I
know:
Her heart is like a pearl's, or like the
glory
Of moonbeams frozen on the
spotless snow.

JOSÉ SANTOS CHOCANO
(Translated by John Pierrepont Rice)

"GO DOWN TO KEW IN LILAC-TIME"

Go down to Kew in lilac-time, in lilac-time, in lilac-
time;
Go down to Kew in lilac-time (it isn't far from
London!)
And you shall wander hand in hand with love in
summer's wonderland;
Go down to Kew in lilac-time (it isn't far from
London!).

The cherry-trees are seas of bloom and soft perfume
and sweet perfume,
The cherry-trees are seas of bloom (and oh, so
near to London!)
And there they say, when dawn is high and all the
world's a blaze of sky

The cuckoo, though he's very shy, will sing a song
for London.

The Dorian nightingale is rare, and yet they say
you'll hear him there
At Kew, at Kew in lilac-time (and oh, so near to
London!)
The linnet and the throstle, too, and after dark the
long halloo
And golden-eyed *tu-whit, tu-whoo* of owls that
ogle London.

For Noah hardly knew a bird of any kind that isn't
heard
At Kew, at Kew in lilac-time (and oh, so near to
London!)
And when the rose begins to pout and all the
chestnut spires are out
You'll hear the rest without a doubt, all chorussing
for London:—

*Come down to Kew in lilac-time, in lilac-time, in
lilac-time;
Come down to Kew in lilac-time (it isn't far from
London!)
And you shall wander hand in hand with love in
summer's wonderland;
Come down to Kew in lilac-time (it isn't far from
London!).*

ALFRED NOYES

BEYOND

I wonder if the tides of Spring
Will always bring me back again

Mute rapture at the simple thing
Of lilacs blowing in the rain.

If so, my heart will ever be
Above all fear, for I shall know
There is a greater mystery
Beyond the time when lilacs blow.

THOMAS S. JONES, JR.

JUNE

I knew that you were coming, June, I knew that you
were coming!
Among the alders by the stream I heard a partridge
drumming;
I heard a partridge drumming, June, a welcome with
his wings,
And felt a softness in the air half Summer's and half
Spring's.

I knew that you were nearing, June, I knew that you
were nearing—
I saw it in the bursting buds of roses in the clearing;
The roses in the clearing, June, were blushing pink
and red,
For they had heard upon the hills the echo of your
tread.

I knew that you were coming, June, I knew that you
were coming,
For ev'ry warbler in the wood a song of joy was
humming.
I know that you are here, June, I know that you are
here—

The fairy month, the merry month, the laughter of
the year!

DOUGLAS MALLOCH

JUNE RAPTURE

Green! What a world of green! My
startled soul
Panting for beauty long denied,
Leaps in a passion of high gratitude
To meet the wild embraces of the
wood;
Rushes and flings itself upon the
whole
Mad miracle of green, with senses
wide,
Clings to the glory, hugs and holds it
fast,
As one who finds a long-lost love at
last.
Billows of green that break upon the
sight
In bounteous crescendos of delight,
Wind-hurried verdure hastening up
the hills
To where the sun its highest rapture
spills;
Cascades of color tumbling down the
height
In golden gushes of delicious light—
God! Can I bear the beauty of this
day,
Or shall I be swept utterly away?

Hush—here are deeps of green,
 where rapture stills,
Sheathing itself in veils of amber
 dusk;
Breathing a silence suffocating,
 sweet,
Wherein a million hidden pulses beat.
Look! How the very air takes fire and
 thrills
With hint of heaven pushing through
 her husk.
Ah, joy's not stopped! 'Tis only more
 intense,
Here where Creation's ardors all
 condense;
Here where I crush me to the radiant
 sod,
Close-folded to the very nerves of
 God.
See now—I hold my heart against
 this tree.
The life that thrills its trembling
 leaves thrills me.
There's not a pleasure pulsing through
 its veins
That does not sting me with ecstatic
 pains.
No twig or tracery, however fine,
Can bear a tale of joy exceeding
 mine.

Praised be the gods that made my
 spirit mad;
Kept me aflame and raw to beauty's
 touch.
Lashed me and scourged me with the
 whip of fate;

Gave me so often agony for mate;
Tore from my heart the things that
 make men glad—
Praised be the gods! If I at last, by
 such
Relentless means may know the
 sacred bliss,
The anguished rapture of an hour like
 this.
Smite me, O Life, and bruise me if
 thou must;
Mock me and starve me with thy
 bitter crust,
But keep me thus aquiver and awake,
Enamoured of my life for living's
 sake!
This were the tragedy—that I should
 pass,
Dull and indifferent through the
 glowing grass.
And this the reason I was born, I say
 —
That I might know the passion of this
 day!

ANGELA MORGAN

COLUMBINES

Late were we sleeping
 Deep in the mold,
Clasping and keeping
 Yesterday's gold—
Hoardings of sunshine,
 Crimson and gold;

Dreaming of light till our dream
became
Aureate bells and beakers of flame,—
Splashed with the splendor of wine of
flame.
 Raindrop awoke us;
 Zephyr bespoke us;
 Chick-a-dee called us,
 Bobolink called us,—
 Then we came.

ARTHUR GUITERMAN

THE MORNING-GLORY

Was it worth while to paint so fair
 Thy every leaf—to vein with
 faultless art
Each petal, taking the boon light and
 air
 Of summer so to heart?

To bring thy beauty unto perfect
 flower,
 Then, like a passing fragrance or a
 smile,
Vanish away, beyond recovery's
 power—
 Was it, frail bloom, worth while?

Thy silence answers: "Life was mine!
 And I, who pass without regret or
 grief,
Have cared the more to make my
 moment fine,
 Because it was so brief.

"In its first radiance I have seen
The sun!—why tarry then till
comes the night?
I go my way, content that I have been
Part of the morning light!"

FLORENCE EARLE COATES

THE BLOSSOMY BARROW

Antonio Sarto ees buildin' a wall,
But maybe he nevva gon' feenish at
all.

Eet sure wonta be
Teell flower an' tree
An' all kinda growin' theengs sleep
een da Fall.

You see, deesa 'Tonio always ees
want'
To leeve on a farm, so he buy wan
las' mont'.
I s'posa som' day eet be verra nice
place,
But shape dat he find eet een sure ees
"deesgrace";
Eet's busta so bad he must feexin' eet
all,
An' firs' theeng he starta for build ees
da wall.
Mysal' I go outa for see heem wan
day,
An' dere I am catcha heem sweatin'
away;
He's liftin' beeg stones from all parts
of hees land

An' takin' dem up to da wall een hees
hand!
I say to heem: "Tony, why don'ta you
gat
Som' leetla wheel-barrow for halp
you weeth dat?"
"O! com' an' I show you w'at's
matter," he said,
An' so we go look at hees tools een da
shed.
Dere's fina beeg wheel-barrow dere
on da floor,
But w'at do you s'pose? From een
under da door,
Som' mornin'-glor' vines have creep
eento da shed,
An' beautiful flower, all purpla an'
red,
Smile out from da vina so pretty an'
green
Dat tweest round da wheel an' da
sides da machine.
I look at dees Tony an' say to heem:
"Wal?"
An' Tony he look back at me an' say:
"Hal!
I no can bust up soocha beautiful
theeng;
I work weeth my han's eef eet tak' me
teell spreeng!"

Antonio Sarto ees buildin' a wall,
But maybe he nevva gon' feenish at
all.
Eet sure wonta be
Teell flower an' tree

An' all kinda growin' theengs sleep
een da Fall.

T. A. DALY

LARKSPUR

Blue morning and the beloved,
The hill-garden and I ...

Blue morning and the beloved,
Leaning, laughing and plucking,
Plucking wet roses ...

(She among the roses,
I among the larkspur,
Bob-white, warbler, meadowlark,
bobolink,
Song, sun,
And still morning air.)

I snipped off a larkspur blossom of
china-blue
And held it,
A blossom against the sky ...

And heaven opened out
In one small flower-face ...

And the beloved,
Plucking roses, plucking roses, old-
fashioned roses,
Lifted her face
With eyes of china-blue.

(She among the roses,
I among the larkspur,

Bee-hum, brown-mole, downy
 chick, humming-bird:
Light, dew,
And laughter of my love.)

JAMES OPPENHEIM

THE JULY GARDEN

It's July in my garden; and steel-blue are the globe
 thistles

And French grey the willows that bow to every
 breeze;

And deep in every currant bush a robber blackbird
 whistles

"I'm picking, I'm picking, I'm picking these!"

So off I go to rout them, and find instead I'm gazing
 At clusters of delphiniums—the seed was small
 and brown,

But these are spurs that fell from heaven and caught
 the most amazing

Colours of the welkin's own as they came hustling
 down.

And then some roses catch my eye, or may be some
 Sweet Williams

Or pink and white and purple peals of Canterbury
 bells

Or pencilled Violas that peep between the three-
 leaved trilliums

Or red-hot poker all aglow or poppies that cast
 spells—

And while I stare at each in turn I quite forget or
 pardon

The blackbirds—and the blackguards—that keep
robbing me of pie;
For what do such things matter when I have so fair a
garden
And what is half so lovely as my garden in July?

ROBERT ERNEST VERNÈDE

"MID-SUMMER BLOOMS WITHIN OUR QUIET GARDEN-WAYS"

Mid-summer blooms within our quiet
garden-ways;
A golden peacock down the dusky
alley strays;
Gay flower petals strew
—Pearl, emerald and blue—
The curving slopes of fragrant
summer grass;
The pools are clear as glass
Between the white cups of the lily-
flowers;
The currants are like jewelled fairy-
bowers;
A dazzling insect worries the heart of
a rose,
Where a delicate fern a filmy shadow
throws,
And airy as bubbles the thousands of
bees
Over the young grape-clusters swarm
as they please.

The air is pearly, iridescent, pure;
These profound and radiant noons
mature,

Unfolding even as odorous roses of
clear light;
Familiar roads to distances invite
Like slow and graceful gestures, one
by one
Bound for the pearly-hued horizon
and the sun.

Surely the summer clothes, with all
her arts,
No other garden with such grace and
power;
And 'tis the poignant joy close-folded
in our hearts
That cries its life aloud from every
flaming flower.

EMILE VERHAEREN

POPPIES

O perfect flowers of sweet
midsummer days,
The season's emblems ye,
As nodding lazily
Ye kiss to sleep each breeze that near
you strays,
And soothe the tired gazer's sense
With lulling surges of your softest
somnolence.

Like fairy lamps ye light the garden
bed
With tender ruby glow.
Not any flowers that blow

Can match the glory of your
gleaming red;
Such sunny-warm and dreamy hue
Before ye lit your fires no garden
ever knew.

Bright are the blossoms of the scarlet
sage,
And bright the velvet vest
On the nasturtium's breast;
Bright are the tulips when they
reddest rage,
And bright the coreopsis' eye;—
But none of all can with your brilliant
beauty vie.

O soft and slumberous flowers, we
love you well;
Your glorious crimson tide
The mossy walk beside
Holds all the garden in its drowsy
spell;
And walking there we gladly bless
Your queenly grace and all your
languorous loveliness.

JOHN RUSSELL HAYES

THE GARDEN IN AUGUST

From corn-crib by the level pasture-
lands
To knoll where spruce and boulders
hide the road
I know it like a book, and when my
heart

Is waste and dry and hard and choked
with weeds,
I come here till it gently blooms
again.
For gardens yield rich fruits that will
outlast
The autumn and the winter of the
soul,
Richest to him who toils with loving
hands.
'Tis delving thus we learn life's
secrets told
But to those favored few who dig for
them.
The Garden is an intimate and keeps
In touch with us, yet hath its own
high moods,
And doth impose them on the mind of
man
To shame his pettiness. So do I love
Its shimmering August mood keyed
to the sun,
A harlequin of color, birds and
bloom.
Nasturtiums, zinnias, balsams, salvias
blaze
By vivid dahlias; tiger-lilies burn
In scarlet shadow of Jerusalem-cross;
Beyond the queen-hydrangeas
splendid rule
Barbaric marigolds; chrysanthemums
Outshine gladioli, and sunflowers
flaunt
Their crests of gold beneath the giant
gourds.
Within the arbor, script forgot, I
muse,

While gorgeous hollyhocks sway to
 and fro
To mark the silences, and butterflies
Flit in and out like some bright
 memory,
And blinding poppies kindle slow
 watch-fires
Before the golden altar of the sun.

A spell lies on the Garden. Summer
 sits
With finger on her lips as if she heard
The steps of Autumn echo on the hill.
A hush lies on the Garden. Summer
 dreams
Of timid crocus thrust through drifted
 snow.

GERTRUDE HUNTINGTON MCGIFFERT

SUN, CARDINAL, AND CORN FLOWERS

Whence gets Earth her gold for thee,
O Sunflower?
Her woven, yellow locks so fine
Must go to make that gold of thine.

And whence thy red beside the
 stream,
O Cardinal-flower?
She pricks some vein lies near her
 heart
That thy rich, ruddy hue may start.

And whence thy blue amid the corn,
O Corn-flower?

Her deep-blue eyes gleam out in glee,
The glories of her work to see.

HANNAH PARKER KIMBALL

SUNFLOWERS

My tall sunflowers love the sun,
Love the burning August noons
When the locust tunes its viol,
And the cricket croons.

When the purple night draws on,
With its planets hung on high,
And the attared winds of slumber
Wander down the sky,

Still my sunflowers love the sun,
Keep their ward and watch and
wait
Till the rosy key of morning
Opes the eastern gate.

Then, when they have deeply quaffed
From the brimming cups of dew,
You can hear their golden laughter
All the garden through.

CLINTON SCOLLARD

THE END OF SUMMER

When poppies in the garden bleed,
And coreopsis goes to seed,

And pansies, blossoming past their
 prime,
Grow small and smaller all the time,
When on the mown field, shrunk and
 dry,
Brown dock and purple thistle lie,
And smoke from forest fires at noon
Can make the sun appear the moon,
When apple seeds, all white before,
Begin to darken in the core,
I know that summer, scarcely here,
Is gone until another year.

EDNA ST. VINCENT MILLAY

A LATE WALK

When I go up through the mowing
 field,
 The headless aftermath,
Smooth-laid like thatch with the
 heavy dew,
Half closes the garden path.

And when I come to the garden
 ground,
 The whir of sober birds
Up from the tangle of the withered
 weeds
Is sadder than any words.

A tree beside the wall stands bare,
 But a leaf that lingered brown,
Disturbed, I doubt not, by my
 thought,
Comes softly rustling down.

I end not far from my going forth
By picking the faded blue
Of the last remaining aster flower
To carry again to you.

ROBERT FROST

COLOR NOTES

The brown of fallen leaves,
The duller brown
Of withered moss
Stubble and bared sheaves,
And pale light filtering down
The fields across.

The gray of slender trees,
The softer gray
Of melting skies.
What sobering ecstasies
One drinks on such a day
With chastened eyes!

CHARLES WHARTON STORK

THE GOLDEN BOWL

I stand upon the broad and rounded summit
Of a high hill
In the full golden flood of an October day
Nearing to twilight.
Below lie bouquets of woods, flat fields,
White strings of roads winding like fairy tales into
the distance,

All steeped in sapphire mist like the blue bloom of
grapes.

Nearby a scarlet creeper trails a fence,
Nearer a hawthorn tree
Drops its wee crimson apples into the lush green
grass.

I stand with head thrown back,
Seeing and breathing deep,
My arms stretched out, in my two hands
I hold a golden bowl.
Luscious fruits fulfil the yellow lustre of its hollow
sphere,
Fruits like great gems,
A pear of russet topaz, a ruby peach,
A cluster of grapes—
Amethysts from the dewy cave of night—
A sapphire plum, a garnet apple, emerald nectarine,
And on them lies a rose.

Oh, empty golden bowl I call my soul,
Filled now with the precious fruits of life and time,
Topped with the rosy spray of grace,
A rose,
As though dropped to me from the sky above,
A crowning thing,
Love,
I lift and hold you out,
An offering,
And close my eyes.

MARY McMILLAN

THE AUTUMN ROSE

A Ghostly visitant, pale Autumn
Rose,

Haunting my garden that you once
loved well:
Ah, how you queened it ere the sweet
June's close,
And blushed anew to hear the
zephyrs tell
Your loveliness was fairer than a
dream!
But now your pride of beauty is all
gone,
And like some poor sad penitent you
seem,
Whose drooping head but hides a
visage wan
And wasted by the coldness of the
world.
Upon your faint sweet breath is borne
a sigh,
Within your petals lies a tear
impearled;
I hear you to my garden say good-
bye.

A sudden wind—the pale rose-petals
blow
Hither and yon—or are they flakes of
snow?

ANTOINETTE DE COURSEY PATTERSON

INDIAN SUMMER

Lyric night of the lingering Indian
Summer,
Shadowy fields that are scentless but
full of singing,

Never a bird, but the passionless
chant of insects,
Ceaseless, insistent.

The grasshopper's horn, and far off,
high in the maples
The wheel of a locust leisurely
grinding the silence,
Under the moon waning and worn
and broken,
Tired with summer.

Let me remember you, voices of little
insects,
Weeds in the moonlight, fields that
are tangled with asters,
Let me remember you, soon will the
winter be on us,
Snow-hushed and heartless.

Over my soul murmur your mute
benediction,
While I gaze, oh fields that rest after
harvest,
As those who part look long in the
eyes they lean to,
Lest they forget them.

SARA TEASDALE

"FROST TO-NIGHT"

Apple-green west and an orange bar,
And the crystal eye of a lone, one star

...

And, "Child, take the shears and cut
what you will.
Frost to-night—so clear and dead-
still."

Then, I sally forth, half sad, half
proud,
And I come to the velvet, imperial
crowd,
The wine-red, the gold, the crimson,
the pied,—
The dahlias that reign by the garden-
side.

The dahlias I might not touch till to-
night!
A gleam of the shears in the fading
light,
And I gathered them all,—the
splendid throng,
And in one great sheaf I bore them
along.

In my garden of Life with its all-late
flowers
I heed a Voice in the shrinking hours:
"Frost to-night—so clear and dead-
still ..."
Half sad, half proud, my arms I fill.

EDITH M. THOMAS

NOVEMBER NIGHT

Listen ...
With faint dry sound,

Like steps of passing ghosts,
The leaves, frost-crisp'd, break from
 the trees
And fall.

ADELAIDE CRAPSEY

THE SNOW-GARDENS

Like an empty stage
The gardens are empty and cold;
The marble terraces rise
Like vases that hold no flowers;
The lake is frozen, the fountain still;
The marble walls and the seats
Are useless and beautiful.
Ah, here
Where the wind and the dusk and the
 snow are
All is silent and white and sad!
Why do I think of you?
Why does your name remorselessly
Strike through my heart?
Why does my soul awaken and
 shudder?
Why do I seem to hear
Cries as lovely as music?
Surely you never came
Into these pale snow-gardens;
Surely you never stood
Here in the twilight with me;
Yet here I have lingered and dreamed
Of a face as subtle as music,
Of golden hair, and of eyes
Like a child's ...
I have felt on my brow

Your finger-tips, plaintive as music ...
O Wonder of all wonders, O Love—
Wrought of sweet sounds and of
 dreaming!—

Why do you not emerge
From the lilac pale petals of dusk,
And come to me here in the gardens
Where the wind and the snow are?

Beauty and Peace are here—
And unceasing music—
And a loneliness chill and wistful,
Like the feeling of death.

Like a crystal lily a star
Leans from its leaves of silver
And gleams in the sky;
And golden and faint in the shadows
You wait indistinctly,—
Like a phantom lamp that appears
In the mirror of distance that hovers
By the window at twilight—
You have come—and we stand
 together,
With questioning eyes—
Dreaming and cold and ghostly
In an empty garden that seems
Like an empty stage.

ZOË AKINS

A SONG FOR WINTER

Speak not of snow and cold and rime
 Now they prevail.
Would you have joy in winter-time,

Think of the pale
New green that comes, of blossoming
 lilacs think,
Larkspur, and borders of the fringed
 pink.
And sing, if winter grants you heart
 to sing,
Of summer and of spring.

Would you secure some happiness
 In frosty hours,
Trust to the eye external less
 Than to the powers
Of inward sight that even now may
 show
Opaline seas, blue hilltops, and the
 glow
Of daybreak on the glades where
 thrushes sing
In summer and in spring.

Gaze not on fettered lake and brook
 And sullen skies,
But in your happy memory look
 Where beauty lies
As once it was, as it shall be again
When sunshine floods the fields of
 blowing grain,
And sing, as must who would in
 winter sing,
Of summer and of spring.

MRS. SCHUYLER VAN RENSSELAER

WINGS AND SONG

"I MEANT TO DO MY WORK TO-DAY"

*I meant to do my work to-day—
But a brown bird sang in the apple-
tree
And a butterfly flitted across the field,
And all the leaves were calling me.*

*And the wind went sighing over the
land,
Tossing the grasses to and fro,
And a rainbow held out its shining
hand—
So what could I do but laugh and
go?*

RICHARD LE GALLIENNE

THE HUMMINGBIRD

Through tree-top and clover a-whirr
and away!
Hi! little rover, stop and stay.

Merry, absurd, excited wag—
Lilliput-bird in Brobdingnag!

Wild and free as the wild thrush, and
warier—

Was ever a bee merrier, airier?

Wings folded so, a second or two—
Was ever a crow more solemn than
you?

A-whirr again over the garden, away!
Who calls, little rover, Bird or fay?

Agleam and aglow, incarnate bliss!
What do you know that we humans
miss?

In the lily's chalice, what rune, what
spell,
In the rose's palace, what do they tell

(When the door you bob in, airily)
That they hush from the robin, hide
from the bee?—

Fearing the crew of chatter and song,
And tell to you of the chantless
tongue?

Chantless! Ah, yes. Is that the sting
Masked in gay dress and whirring
wing?

Faith! But a wing of such airy stuff!
What need to sing? Here's music
enough.

A-whirr, and over tree-top, and
through!
Hi! little rover, fair travel to you.

Sweet, absurd, excited wag—

Lilliput-bird in Brobdingnag!

HERMANN HAGEDORN

SPRING SONG

Softly at dawn a whisper stole
Down from the Green House on
the Hill,
Enchanting many a ghostly bole
And wood song with the ancient
thrill.

Gossiping on the countryside,
Spring and the wandering breezes
say
God has thrown heaven open wide
And let the thrushes out to-day.

WILLIAM GRIFFITH

NIGHTINGALES

At sunset my brown nightingales
Hidden and hushed all day,
Ring vespers, while the color pales
And fades to twilight gray:
The little mellow bells they ring,
The little flutes they play,
Are soft as though for practising
The things they want to say.
It's when the dark has floated down
To hide and guard and fold,

I know their throats that look so
 brown,
Are really made of gold.
No music I have ever heard
Can call as sweet as they!
I wonder if it *is* a bird
That sings within the hidden tree,
Or some shy angel calling me
To follow far away?

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING

THE GOLDFINCH

Down from the sky on a sudden he
 drops
Into the mullein and juniper tops,
Flushed from his bath in the
 midsummer shine
Flooding the meadowland, drunk
 with the wine
Spilled from the urns of the blue, like
 a bold
Sky-buccaneer in his sable and gold.

Lightly he sways on the pendulous
 stem,
Vividly restless, a fluttering gem,
Then with a flash of bewildering
 wings
Dazzles away up and down, and he
 sings
Clear as a bell at each dip as he flies
Bounding along on the wave of the
 skies.

Sunlight and laughter, a wingèd
 desire,
Motion and melody married to fire,
Lighter than thistle-tuft borne on the
 wind,
Frailer than violets, how shall we find
Words that will match him, discover a
 name
Meet for this marvel, this lyrical
 flame?

How shall we fashion a rhythm to
 wing with him,
Find us a wonderful music to sing
 with him
Fine as his rapture is, free as the
 rollicking
Song that the harlequin drops in his
 frolicking
Dance through the summer sky,
 singing so merrily
High in the burning blue, winging so
 airily?

ODELL SHEPARD

KINFOLK

O, we are Kinfolk, she and I,—
 The little mother-bird all brown,
Who broods above her nest on high,
 And with her soft, bright eyes
 looks down
To read the secret of my heart,—
We two from all the world apart!

She dreams there in her swaying nest;
I dream here 'neath my sheltering
vine.
The same love stirs her feathered
breast
That makes my heart-throb seem
divine.
We both dream 'neath the same kind
sky,—
The small brown mother-bird, and I.
KATE WHITING PATCH

A MOCKING-BIRD

An arrow, feathery, alive,
He darts and sings,—
Then with a sudden skimming dive
Of striped wings
He finds a pine and, debonair,
Makes with his mate
All birds that ever rested there
Articulate.

The whisper of a multitude
Of happy wings
Is round him, a returning brood,
Each time he sings.
Though heaven be not for them or
him
Yet he is wise,
And daily tiptoes on the rim
Of paradise.

WITTER BYNNER

THE CARDINAL-BIRD

Where snow-drifts are deepest he
 frolics along,
A flicker of crimson, a chirrup of
 song,
My Cardinal-Bird of the frost-
 powdered wing,
Composing new lyrics to whistle in
 Spring.

A plump little prelate, the park is his
 church;
The pulpit he loves is a cliff-sheltered
 birch;
And there, in his rubicund livery
 dressed,
Arranging his feathers and ruffling
 his crest,

He preaches, with most
 unconventional glee,
A sermon addressed to the squirrels
 and me,
Commending the wisdom of those
 that display
The brightest of colors when heavens
 are gray.

ARTHUR GUITERMAN

YELLOW WARBLERS

The first faint dawn was flushing up
 the skies,

When, dreamland still bewildering
mine eyes,
I looked out to the oak that, winter-
long,—
A winter wild with war and woe and
wrong,—
Beyond my casement had been void
of song.

And lo! with golden buds the twigs
were set,
Live buds that warbled like a rivulet
Beneath a veil of willows. Then I
knew
Those tiny voices, clear as drops of
dew,
Those flying daffodils that fleck the
blue,

Those sparkling visitants from myrtle
isles—
Wee pilgrims of the sun, that
measured miles
Innumerable over land and sea
With wings of shining inches. Flakes
of glee,
They filled that dark old oak with
jubilee,

Foretelling in delicious roundelays
Their dainty courtships on the
dipping sprays,
How they should fashion nests, mate
helping mate,
Of milkweed flax and fern-down
delicate,
To keep sky-tinted eggs inviolate.

Listening to those blithe notes, I
 slipped once more
From lyric dawn through dreamland's
 open door,
And there was God, Eternal Life that
 sings
Eternal joy, brooding all mortal
 things,
A nest of stars, beneath untroubled
 wings.

KATHARINE LEE BATES

WITCHERY

Out of the purple drifts,
 From the shadow sea of night,
On tides of musk a moth uplifts
 Its weary wings of white.

Is it a dream or ghost
 Of a dream that comes to me,
Here in the twilight on the coast,
 Blue cinctured by the sea?

Fashioned of foam and froth—
 And the dream is ended soon,
And, lo, whence came the moon-
 white moth
Comes now the moth-white moon!

FRANK DEMPSTER SHERMAN

THE SPRING BEAUTIES

The Puritan Spring Beauties stood freshly clad for
church;
A Thrush, white-breasted, o'er them sat singing on
his perch.
"Happy be! for fair are ye!" the gentle singer told
them,
But presently a buff-coat Bee came booming up to
scold them.
"Vanity, oh, vanity!
Young maids, beware of vanity!"
Grumbled out the buff-coat Bee,
Half parson-like, half soldierly.

The sweet-faced maidens trembled, with pretty,
pinky blushes,
Convinced that it was wicked to listen to the
Thrushes;
And when, that shady afternoon, I chanced that way
to pass,
They hung their little bonnets down and looked into
the grass.
All because the buff-coat Bee
Lectured them so solemnly:—
"Vanity, oh, vanity!
Young maids, beware of vanity!"

HELEN GRAY CONE

THE MOCKING-BIRD

He didn't know much music
When first he come along;
An' all the birds went wonderin'
Why he didn't sing a song.

They primped their feathers in the
 sun,
 An' sung their sweetest notes;
An' music jest come on the run
 From all their purty throats!

But still that bird was silent
 In summer time an' fall;
He jest set still and listened,
 An' he wouldn't sing at all!

But one night when them songsters
 Was tired out an' still,
An' the wind sighed down the valley
 An' went creepin' up the hill;

When the stars was all a-tremble
 In the dreamin' fields o' blue,
An' the daisy in the darkness—
 Felt the fallin' o' the dew,—

There come a sound o' melody
 No mortal ever heard,
An' all the birds seemed singin'
 From the throat o' one sweet bird!

Then the other birds went Mayin'
 In a land too fur to call;
For there warn't no use in stayin'
 When one bird could sing for all!

FRANK L. STANTON

THE MESSENGER

Bee! tell me whence do you come?
Ten fields away, twenty perhaps,

Have heard your hum.

If you are from the north, you may
Have passed my mother's roof of
 straw
Upon your way.

If you came from the south you
 should
Have seen another cottage just
Inside the wood.

And should you go back that way,
 please
Carry a message to the house
Among the trees.

Say—I will wait her at the rock
Beside the stream, this very night
At eight o'clock.

And ask your queen when you get
 home
To send my queen the present of
A honey-comb.

JAMES STEPHENS

FIREFLIES

Fireflies, Fireflies, little glinting
 creatures,
 Making night lovely with a rain of
 gold,
Born of the moonbeams, children all
 unearthly,

Ah how you vanish from a look too
bold!

Fireflies, Fireflies, lovely as our
dreams are,
Sewn with such fancies from the
years gone by,
Wayward, elusive, as the playful
zephyrs,
Hiding mid grasses, gleaming in
the sky.

Fireflies, Fireflies, like unto the silent
Brown nuns who gather for the
dead to pray,
As theirs your mission; holy, too,
your tapers,
Souls of dead flowers lighting on
their way.

ANTOINETTE DE COURSEY PATTERSON

JULY MIDNIGHT

Fireflies flicker in the tops of trees,
Flicker in the lower branches,
Skim along the ground.
Over the moon-white lilies
Is a flashing and ceasing of small, lemon-green stars.
As you lean against me,
Moon-white,
The air all about you
Is slit, and pricked, and pointed with sparkles of
lemon-green flame
Starting out of a background of great vague trees.

AMY LOWELL

THE CRICKET IN THE PATH

She passed through the shadowy garden, so tall and
so white,
Her eyes on the stars and her face like an angel's
upturned,
And it seemed to my thought that the dusk round her
head with the light
Of an aureole burned.

But where she had trodden unseeing, I found on the
path
A cricket, so frail that her light foot had maimed it,
yet strong
To valiantly pipe, tiny hero, a faint aftermath
Of its yesterday song.

And I whispered, "Alas, Little Brother, why must it
befall
That the passing of angels but cripples and leaves us
to die?
Poor imp of the greensward, God trumpets me clear
in thy call;
Thou art braver than I.

"The Bright Ones of Heaven have trodden me down
as they passed;
I crawl in their footsteps a trampled and impotent
thing.
I know not the reason, nor question henceforth. To
the last,
While I live, I will sing."

AMELIA JOSEPHINE BURR

REST AT NOON

Now with a re-created mind
Back to the world my way I find;

Fed by the hills one little hour,
By meadow-slope and beechen-
bower,

Cedar serene, benignant larch,
Hoar mountains and the azure arch

Where dazzling vapors make vast
sport
In God's profound and spacious court.

The universe played with me. Earth
Harped to high heaven her sweetest
mirth;

The clouds built castles for my
pleasure,
And airy legions without measure

Flung, spindrift-wise, across the sky
To thrill my heart once and to die.

I have held converse with large
things;
For cherubim with cooling wings

Brushed me, and gay stars, hid from
view,
Called through the arras of the blue

And clapped their hands: "These veils
uproll!
And see the comrades of your soul!"

The very flowers that ringed my bed
Their little "God-be-with-you" said,

And every insect, bird and bee
Brought cool cups from eternity.

HERMANN HAGEDORN

ORDER

It is half-past eight on the blossomy
bush:

The petals are spread for a
sunning;

The little gold fly is scrubbing his
face;

The spider is nervously running
To fasten a thread; the night-going
moth

Is folding his velvet perfection;
And presently over the clover will
come

The bee on a tour of inspection.

PAUL SCOTT MOWRER

THE NIGHT-MOTH

My night-moth, my white moth, out of the fragrant
dark

Blowing in and growing like a dim star-spark,
So swift in the shifting of your elfin wings,
So slight in your lighting, as a flower that clings,

As a boat to ride the dew, with sheer up-bearing
sails,
Pulsing and breathing, rocked with delicate gales,—
You gleam as a dream, by my window's light,
My white moth, my bright moth, my wandering
wraith of night.

From the velvet screening of a great gray cloud
The moon floats swiftly, white and open-browed,
Flooding cloud and water with her shining trail,
Till the night shrinks, sighing, behind the radiant
veil;
The night, with her shy soul, to the deep wood slips
—

Her shy soul, her high soul, shrine of all the stars;
And you fly, like the sigh from her tender lips,
Athwart the wavering shadows, beating the silver
bars;
You fleet in the meeting of the dark and bright,
My light moth, my white moth, spark from the soul
of night.

MARION COUTHOUY SMITH

THE BUTTERFLY

O winged brother on the harebell,
stay—
Was God's hand very pitiful, the
hand
That wrought thy beauty at a
dream's demand?
*Yes, knowing I love so well the
flowery way,
He did not fling me to the world
astray—*

*He did not drop me to the weary
sand,
But bore me gently to a leafy land:
Tinting my wings, He gave me to the
day.*

Oh, chide no more my doubting, my
despair!
I will go back now to the world of
men.
Farewell, I leave thee to the world of
air,
Yet thou hast girded up my heart
again;
For He that framed the impenetrable
plan,
And keeps His word with thee, will
keep with man.

EDWIN MARKHAM

THE SECRET

O, little bird, you sing
As if all months were June;
Pray tell me ere you go
The secret of your tune?

"I have no hidden word
To tell, nor mystic art;
I only know I sing
The song within my heart!"

ARTHUR WALLACE PEACH

THE GARDENS OF YESTERDAY

THE GARDEN

*Old gardens have a language of their
own,*

*And mine sweet speech to linger in
the heart.*

*A goodly place it is and primly
spaced,*

*With straight box-bordered paths and
squares of bloom.*

*Bay-trees by rows of antique urns tell
tales*

*Of one who loved the gardens Dante
loved.*

*Magnolias edge the placid lily-pool
And flank the sagging seat, whence
vista leads*

*To blaze of rhododendrons banked in
green.*

*Azaleas by the scarlet quince flame
up*

*Against the lustrous grape-vines
trellised high*

*To pigeon-cote and old brick wall
where hide*

*First snowdrops and the bravest
violets.*

*A place of solitudes whose silences
Enfold the heart as an unquiet bird.*

GERTRUDE HUNTINGTON MCGIFFERT

OLD HOMES

Old homes among the hills! I love their gardens;
Their old rock fences, that our day inherits;
Their doors, round which the great trees stand like
 wardens;
Their paths, down which the shadows march like
 spirits;
Broad doors and paths that reach bird-haunted
 gardens.

I see them gray among their ancient acres,
Severe of front, their gables lichen-sprinkled,—
Like gentle-hearted, solitary Quakers,
Grave and religious, with kind faces wrinkled,—
Serene among their memory-hallowed acres.

Their gardens, banked with roses and with lilies—
Those sweet aristocrats of all the flowers—
Where Springtime mints her gold in daffodillies,
And Autumn coins her marigolds in showers,
And all the hours are toilless as the lilies.

I love their orchards where the gay woodpecker
Flits, flashing o'er you, like a wingèd jewel;
Their woods, whose floors of moss the squirrels
 checker
With half-hulled nuts; and where, in cool renewal,
The wild brooks laugh, and raps the red woodpecker.

Old homes! Old hearts! Upon my soul forever
Their peace and gladness lie like tears and laughter;
Like love they touch me, through the years that
 sever,

With simple faith; like friendship, draw me after
The dreamy patience that is theirs forever.

MADISON CAWEIN

A PURITAN LADY'S GARDEN

This fairy pleasance in the brake—
This maze run wild of flower
and vine—
Our fathers planted for the sake
Of eyes that longed for English
gardens
Amid the virgin wastes of pine.

Here, by the broken, moldering
wall,
Where still the tiger-lilies ride,
Once grew the crown imperial,
The tall blue larkspur, white Queen
Margaret,
Prince's-feather, and mourning
bride.

Beyond their pale, a humbler
throng,
Grew Bouncing Bet and
columbine;
The mountain fringe ran all along
The thick-set hedge of cinnamon
roses,
And overhung the eglantine.

And Sunday flowers were here as
well—

Adam-and-Eve within their
hood,
The stately Canterbury bell,
And, oft in churches breathing
fragrance,
The sweet and pungent
southernwood.

When ships for England cleared
the bay,
If long beside these reefs of
foam
She stood, and watched them sail
away,
It was her garden first enticed her
To turn, and call this country
"home."

SARAH N. CLEGHORN

THE OLD-FASHIONED GARDEN

Among the meadows of the countryside,
From city noise and tumult far away,
Where clover-blossoms spread their fragrance wide
And birds are warbling all the sunny day,
There is a spot which lovingly I prize,
For there a fair and sweet old-fashioned country
garden lies.

The gray old mansion down beside the lane
Stands knee-deep in the fields that lie around
And scent the air with hay and ripening grain.
Behind the manse box-hedges mark the bound
And close the garden in, or nearly close,

For on beyond the hollyhocks an olden orchard
grows.

So bright and lovely is the dear old place,
It seems as though the country's very heart
Were centered here, and that its antique grace
Must ever hold it from the world apart.
Immured it lies among the meadows deep,
Its flowery stillness beautiful and calm as softest
sleep.

The morning-glories ripple o'er the hedge
And fleck its greenness with their tinted foam;
Sweet wilding things, up to the garden's edge
They love to wander from their meadow home,
To take what little pleasure here they may
Ere all their silken trumpets close before the warm
midday.

The larkspur lifts on high its azure spires,
And up the arbor's lattices are rolled
The quaint nasturtium's many-colored fires;
The tall carnation's breast of faded gold
Is striped with many a faintly-flushing streak,
Pale as the tender tints that blush upon a baby's
cheek.

The old sweet-rocket sheds its fine perfumes,
With golden stars the coreopsis flames,
And here are scores of sweet old-fashioned blooms,
Dear for the very fragrance of their names,—
Poppies and gilly flowers and four-o'clocks,
Cowslips and candytuft and heliotrope and
hollyhocks,

Harebells and peonies and dragon-head,
Petunias, scarlet sage and bergamot,
Verbenas, ragged-robins, soft gold-thread,

The bright primrose and pale forget-me-not,
Wall-flowers and crocuses and columbines,
Narcissus, asters, hyacinths, and honeysuckle vines.

A sweet seclusion this of sun and shade,
A calm asylum from the busy world,
Where greed and restless care do ne'er invade,
Nor news of 'change and mart each morning
hurled
Round half the globe; no noise of party feud
Disturbs this peaceful spot nor mars its perfect
quietude.

But summer after summer comes and goes
And leaves the garden ever fresh and fair;
May brings the tulip, golden June the rose,
And August winds shake down the mellow pear.
Man blooms and blossoms, fades and disappears,—
But scarce a tribute pays the garden to the passing
years.

Sweet is the odor of the warm, soft rain
In violet-days when spring opes her green heart;
And sweet the apple trees along the lane
Whose lovely blossoms all too soon depart;
And sweet the brimming dew that overfills
The golden chalices of all the trembling daffodils.

But sweeter far, in this old garden-close
To loiter 'mid the lovely old-time flowers,
To breathe the scent of lavender and rose,
And with old poets pass the peaceful hours.

Old gardens and old poets,—happy he
Whose quiet summer days are spent in such sweet
company!

JOHN RUSSELL HAYES

A COLONIAL GARDEN

Down this pathway, through the
shade,
Lightly tripped the dainty maid,
In her eyes the smile of June,
On her lips some old sweet tune.
Through yon ragged rows of box,
By that awkward clump of phlox,
To her favorite pansy bed
Like a ray of light, she sped.
Satin slippers trim and neat
Gleamed upon her slender feet;
Round her ankles, deftly tied,
Ribbons crossed from side to side,
Here her pinks, old fashioned, fair,
Breathed their fragrance on the air;
There her fluttering azure gown
Shook the poppy's petals down.
Here a rose, with fond caress,
Stooped to touch a truant tress
From her fillet struggling free,
Scorning its captivity.
There a bed of rue was set
With an edge of mignonette,
And the spicy bergamot
Meshed the frail forget-me-not.
Honeysuckles, hollyhocks,
Bachelor's buttons, four-o'clocks,
Marigolds and blue-eyed grass

Curtsied when the maid did pass.
Now the braggart weeds have spread
Through the paths she loved to tread,
And the creeping moss has grown
O'er yon shattered dial-stone.
Still beside the ruined walks
Some old flowers, on sturdy stalks,
Dream of her whose happy eyes
Roam the fields of paradise.

JAMES B. KENYON

IN MY MOTHER'S GARDEN

There were many flowers in my
 mother's garden,
Sword-leaved gladiolas, taller far
 than I,
Sticky-leaved petunias, pink and
 purple flaring,
Velvet-painted pansies smiling at the
 sky;

Scentless portulacas crowded down
 the borders,
White and scarlet-petalled, rose and
 satin-gold,
Clustered sweet alyssum, lacy-white
 and scented,
Sprays of gray-green lavender to keep
 'til you were old.

In my mother's garden were green-
 leaved hiding-places,
Nooks between the lilacs—oh, a
 pleasant place to play!

Still my heart can hide there, still my
 eyes can dream it,
Though the long years lie between
 and I am far away;

When the world is hard now, when
 the city's clanging
Tires my eyes and tires my heart and
 dust lies everywhere,
I can dream the peace still of the soft
 wind's blowing,
I can be a child still and hide my
 heart from care.

Lord, if still that garden blossoms in
 the sunlight,
Grant that children laugh there now
 among its green and gold—
Grant that little hearts still hide its
 memoried sweetness,
Locking one bright dream away for
 light when they are old!

MARGARET WIDDEMER

TO THE SWEETWILLIAM

I search the poet's honied lines,
And not in vain, for columbines;
And not in vain for other flowers
That sanctify the many bowers
Unsanctified by human souls.
See where the larkspur lifts among
The thousand blossoms finely sung,
Still blossoming in the fragrant
 scrolls!

Charity, eglantine, and rue
And love-in-a-mist are all in view,
With coloured cousins; but where
 are you,
Sweetwilliam?

The lily and the rose have books
Devoted to their lovely looks,
And wit has fallen in vital showers
Through England's most miraculous
 hours
To keep them fresh a thousand years.
The immortal library can show
The violet's well-thumbed folio
Stained tenderly by girls in tears.
 The shelf where Genius stands in
 view
Has brier and daffodil and rue
And love-lies-bleeding; but not
 you,
Sweetwilliam.

Thus, if I seek the classic line
For marybuds, 'tis, Shakespeare,
 thine!
And ever is the primrose born
'Neath Goldsmith's overhanging
 thorn.
In Herrick's breastknot I can see
The apple-blossom, fresh and fair
As when he plucked and put it there,
Heedless of Time's anthology.
 So flower by flower comes into
 view
Kept fadeless by the Olympian
 dew
For startled eyes; and yet not you,

Sweetwilliam.

Though gods of song have let you be,
Bloom in my little book for me.
Unwont to stoop or lean, you show
An undefeated heart, and grow
As pluckily as cedars. Heat
And cold, and winds that make
Tumbledown sallies, cannot shake
Your resolution to be sweet.

Then take this song, be it born to
die

Ere yet the unwedded butterfly
Has glimpsed a darling in the sky,
Sweetwilliam!

NORMAN GALE

ROSE-GERANIUM

A pungent spray of rose-geranium—
A breath of the old life.

It brings up the little five-room cottage where I was
born,
And where I grew through a smiling childhood.
The white-bearded grandfather sits in his mended
rocking-chair,
His eyes far off, crooning "The Sweet By and By,"
Marked with the tapping of his toe upon the
weathered porch-floor,
While the sunshine drizzles through the great oaks.

And there is my grandmother's kneeling figure,

Turning over the rich black earth with her trowel;
And the kind wrinkles on her face, as she says:
"Didn't the pansies do finely this year, Clem?
And the scarlet verbenas, and the larkspurs,
And the row of flaming salvia....
Those roses ... they're Maréchal Niels ... my
favorites.
And little grandson, smell this spray of rose-
geranium—
Just think, when grandmother was a little tiny girl
Her grandmother grew them in her yard!"
CLEMENT WOOD

FOUR O'CLOCKS

It is mid-afternoon. Long, long ago
Each morning-glory sheathed the
slender horn
It blew so gayly on the hills of
morn,
And fainted in the noontide's fervid
glow.

Gone are the dew-drops from the
rose's heart—
Gone with the freshness of the
early hours,
The songs that filled the air with
silver showers,
The lovely dreams that were of morn
a part.

Yet still in tender light the garden
lies;

The warm, sweet winds are
 whispering soft and low;
Brown bees and butterflies flit to
 and fro;
The peace of heaven is in the
 o'erarching skies.

And here be four-o'clocks, just
 opening wide
Their many colored petals to the
 sun,
As glad to live as if the evening
 dun
Were far away, and morning had not
 died!

JULIA C. R. DORR

ASKING FOR ROSES

A house that lacks, seemingly,
 mistress and master,
With doors that none but the wind
 ever closes,
Its floor all littered with glass and
 with plaster;
It stands in a garden of old-
 fashioned roses.

I pass by that way in the gloaming
 with Mary;
"I wonder," I say, "who the owner
 of those is."
"Oh, no one you know," she answers
 me airy,

"But one we must ask if we want
any roses."

So we must join hands in the dew
coming coldly
There in the hush of the wood that
reposes,
And turn and go up to the open door
boldly,
And knock to the echoes as
beggars for roses.

"Pray, are you within there, Mistress
Who-were-you?"

'Tis Mary that speaks and our
errand discloses.

"Pray are you within there? Bestir
you, bestir you!

'Tis summer again; there's two
come for roses.

"A word with you, that of the singer
recalling—

Old Herrick: a saying that every
man knows is

A flower unplucked is but left to the
falling,

And nothing is gained by not
gathering roses."

We do not loosen our hands'
intertwining

(Not caring so very much what she
supposes),

There when she comes on us mistily
shining

And grants us by silence the boon
of her roses.

ROBERT FROST

THE OLD BROCADE

In a black oak chest all carven,
We found it laid,
Still faintly sweet of Lavender,
An old brocade.
With that perfume came a vision,
A garden fair,
Enclosed by great yew hedges;
A Lady there,
Is culling fresh blown lavender,
And singing goes
Up and down the alleys green—
A human rose.
The sun glints on her auburn hair
And brightens, too,
The silver buckles that adorn
Each little shoe.
Her 'kerchief and her elbow sleeves
Are cobweb lace;
Her gown, it is our old brocade,
Worn with a grace.
Methinks I hear its soft frou-frou,
And see the sheen
Of its dainty pink moss-rose buds,
Their leaves soft green,
On a ground of palest shell pink,
In garlands laid;
But long dead the Rose who wore it
—
The old brocade.

M. G. BRERETON

STAIRWAYS AND GARDENS

Gardens and Stairways; those are
words that thrill me
Always with vague suggestions of
delight.
Stairways and Gardens. Mystery and
grace
Seem part of their environment; they
fill all space
With memories of things veiled from
my sight
In some far place.

Gardens. The word is overcharged
with meaning;
It speaks of moonlight, and a closing
door;
Of birds at dawn—of sultry
afternoons.
Gardens. I seem to see low branches
screening
A vine-roofed arbor with a leaf-tiled
floor
Where sunlight swoons.

Stairways. The word winds upward to
a landing,
Then curves and vanishes in space
above.
Lights fall, lights rise; soft lights that
meet and blend.
Stairways; and some one at the
bottom standing
Expectantly with lifted looks of love.
Then steps descend.

Gardens and Stairways. They belong
with song—
With subtle scents of perfume, myrrh
and musk—
With dawn and dusk—with youth,
romance, and mystery,
And times that were and times that
are to be.
Stairways and Gardens.

ELLA WHEELER WILCOX

OLD MOTHERS

I love old mothers—mothers with
white hair,
And kindly eyes, and lips grown
softly sweet
With murmured blessings over
sleeping babes.
There is a something in their quiet
grace
That speaks the calm of Sabbath
afternoons;
A knowledge in their deep,
unfaltering eyes
That far outreaches all philosophy.
Time, with caressing touch, about
them weaves
The silver-threaded fairy-shawl of
age,
While all the echoes of forgotten
songs
Seem joined to lend a sweetness to
their speech.

Old mothers!—as they pace with
 slow-timed step,
Their trembling hands cling gently to
 youth's strength;
Sweet mothers!—as they pass, one
 sees again
Old garden-walks, old roses, and old
 loves.

CHARLES ROSS

PASTURES AND HILLSIDES

SONG FROM "APRIL "

I know

Where the wind flowers blow!

I know,

I have been

Where the wild honey bees

Gather honey for their queen!

I would be

A wild flower,

Blue sky over me,

For an hour ... an hour!

So the wild bees

Should seek and discover me,

And kiss me ... kiss me ... kiss me!

*Not one of the dusky dears
should miss me!*

I know

Where the wind flowers blow!

I know,

I have been

Where the little rabbits run

In the warm, yellow sun!

Oh, to be a wild flower

For an hour ... an hour ...

In the heather!

A bright flower, a wild flower,

Blown by the weather!

*I know,
I have been
Where the wild honey bees
Gather Honey for their queen!*

IRENE RUTHERFORD MCLEOD

THE ROAD TO THE POOL

I know a road that leads from town,
A pale road in a Watteau gown
Of wild-rose sprays, that runs away
All fragrant-sandaled, slim and gray.

It slips along the laurel grove
And down the hill, intent to rove,
And crooks an arm of shadow cool
Around a willow-silvered pool.

I never travel very far
Beyond the pool where willows are:
There is a shy and native grace
That hovers all about the place,

And resting there I hardly know
Just where it was I meant to go,
Contented like the road that dozes
In panniered gown of briar roses.

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING

THE WILD ROSE

Summer has crossed the fields, and
 where she trod
Violets bloom; the dancing wind-
 flowers nod,
And daisies blossom all across
 the sod.

She passed the brook, and in their
 glad surprise
The first forget-me-nots smiled at the
 skies
And caught the very color of her
 eyes.

But, sleeping in the meadow-land,
 she pressed
The dear wild rose so closely to her
 breast
It stole her heart—and so she loves it
 best.

CHARLES BUXTON GOING

UP A HILL AND A HILL

Up a hill and a hill there's a sudden
 orchard-slope,
And a little tawny field in the sun;
There's a gray wall that coils like a
 twist of frayed-out rope,
And grasses nodding news one to
 one.

Up a hill and a hill there's a windy
 place to stand,

And between the apple-boughs to
find the blue
Of the sleepy summer sea, past the
cliffs of orange sand,
With the white charmed ships
sliding through.

Up a hill and a hill there's a little
house as gray
As a stone that the glaciers scored
and stained;
With a red rose by the door, and a
tangled garden-way,
And a face at the window, checker-
paned.

I could climb, I could climb, till the
shoes fell off my feet,
Just to find that tawny field above
the sea!

Up a hill and a hill,—oh, the
honeysuckle's sweet!
And the eyes at the window watch
for me!

FANNIE STEARNS DAVIS

THE JOYS OF A SUMMER MORNING

The smell of the morning that lurks in
the hay,
The swish of the scythe
And the roundelay
Of the meadow-lark as he wings
away,
Are the joys of a summer morning.

The daisy's bloom on the meadow's
 breast,
 The wandering bee
 And his ceaseless quest
Of the tempting sweets in the clover's
 crest,
Are the joys of a summer morning.

The lowing kine on a distant hill,
 The rollicking fall
 Of the near-by rill
And the lazy drone of the ancient
 mill,
Are the joys of a summer morning.

The feathery clouds in a faultless sky,
 The new-risen sun
 With its kindly eye
And the woodland breezes floating
 by,
Are the joys of a summer morning.

HENRY A. WISE WOOD

SOUTH WIND

Where have you been, South Wind,
 this May-day morning,
With larks aloft, or skimming with
 the swallow,
Or with blackbirds in a green, sun-
 glinted thicket?

Oh, I heard you like a tyrant in the
 valley;

Your ruffian hosts shook the young,
 blossoming orchards;
You clapped rude hands, hallooing
 round the chimney,
And white your pennons streamed
 along the river.

You have robbed the bee, South
 Wind, in your adventure,
Blustering with gentle flowers; but I
 forgave you
When you stole to me shyly with
 scent of hawthorn.

SIEGFRIED SASSOON

TO A WEED

You bold thing! thrusting 'neath the
 very nose
Of her fastidious majesty, the rose,
Even in the best ordained garden bed,
Unauthorized, your smiling little
 head!

The gardener, mind! will come in his
 big boots,
And drag you up by your rebellious
 roots,
And cast you forth to shrivel in the
 sun,
Your daring quelled, your little
 weed's life done.

And when the noon cools, and the
 sun drops low,

He'll come again with his big
wheelbarrow,
And trundle you—I don't know
clearly where,
But off, outside the dew, the light, the
air.

Meantime—ah, yes! the air is very
blue,
And gold the light, and diamond the
dew,—
You laugh and courtesy in your
worthless way,
And you are gay, ah, so exceeding
gay!

You argue in your manner of a weed,
You did not make yourself grow from
a seed,
You fancy you've a claim to standing-
room,
You dream yourself a right to breathe
and bloom.

The sun loves you, you think, just as
the rose,
He never scorned you for a weed,—
he knows!
The green-gold flies rest on you and
are glad,
It's only cross old gardeners find you
bad.

You know, you weed, I quite agree
with you,
I am a weed myself, and I laugh too,
—

Both, just as long as we can shun his
 eye,
Let's sniff at the old gardener
 trudging by!

GERTRUDE HALL

THE PASTURE

I'm going out to clean the pasture
 spring;
I'll only stop to rake the leaves away
(And wait to watch the water clear, I
 may):
I sha'n't be gone long.—You come
 too.

I'm going out to fetch the little calf
That's standing by the mother. It's so
 young,
It totters when she licks it with her
 tongue.
I sha'n't be gone long.—You come
 too.

ROBERT FROST

THE THISTLE

Ha, prickle-armèd knight,
 How oft the world hath cursed
 thee,
Thou pestilence of Earth,

The beldame who hath nursed
thee!

Hath hellish Proserpine
Her needs lent to arm thee
That mischief-loving gods,
Pricked sorely, may not harm thee?

Or hath the mirthful Love
Presented thee his pinions
To dress thy tiny seeds,
The curse of man's dominions!

Thou like a maiden art
Who best can find protection
Employed at needlework
From idleness' infection.

And like a prude thou art
When he who loves embraces;
Thou dost repel with thorns
And she with sharper phrases.

And like the wraith thou art
Wherewith my heart is haunted;
Ye both take most delight
Where ye the least are wanted.

MILES M. DAWSON

CLOVER

Little masters, hat in hand,
Let me in your presence stand,
Till your silence solve for me
This your threefold mystery.

Tell me—for I long to know—
How, in darkness there below,
Was your fairy fabric spun,
Spread and fashioned, three in one.

Did your gossips gold and blue,
Sky and Sunshine, choose for you,
Ere your triple forms were seen,
Suited liveries of green?

Can ye—if ye dwelt indeed
Captives of a prison seed—
Like the Genie, once again
Get you back into the grain?

Little masters, may I stand
In your presence, hat in hand,
Waiting till you solve for me
This your threefold mystery?

JOHN B. TABB

WILD GARDENS

On the ripened grass is a bloomy mist
Of silver and rose and amethyst
Where the long June wave has run.

There are glints of copper and
tarnished brass,
And hyacinthine flames that pass
From the green fires of the sun.

This web of a thousand gleams and
glows
Was woven silently out of the snows
And the patient shine and rain.

It was fashioned cunningly day by
day
From the silken spear to the pollened
spray
With its folded sheaths of grain.

Oh, garden of grasses deep and wild,
So dear to the vagrant and the child
And the singer of an hour.

To the wayworn soul you give your
balm,
Your cup of peace, your stringèd
psalm,
Your grace of bud and flower.

ADA FOSTER MURRAY

THE DANDELION

O dandelion, rich and haughty,
King of village flowers!
Each day is coronation time,
You have no humble hours.
I like to see you bring a troop
To beat the blue-grass spears,
To scorn the lawn-mower that would
be
Like fate's triumphant shears.
Your yellow heads are cut away,
It seems your reign is o'er.
By noon you raise a sea of stars
More golden than before.

VACHEL LINDSAY

JOE-PYEWEED

And the name brings back those
 kindly hills
And the drowsing life so new to
 me;
And the welcome that those purple
 blossoms
With their tiny trumpets blew to
 me.

Stout and tall, they raised their
 clustered heads,
Leaping, as a lusty fellow would,
Through the lowlands, down the
 twisting cow-paths;
Running past the green and yellow
 wood.

How they come again—those
 rambling roads;
And the weeds' wild jewels
 glowing there.
Richer than a Paradise of flowers
Was that bit of pasture growing
 there.

Weeds—the very names call up those
 faint
Half-forgotten smells and cries
 again ...
Weeds—like some old charm, I say
 them over,
And the rolling Berkshires rise
 again:

Basil, Boneset, Toadflax, Tansy,

*Weeds of every form and fancy;
Milk-weed, Mullein, Loose-strife,
Jewel-weed,
Mustard, Thimble-weed, Tear-thumb
(a cruel weed).
Clovers in all sorts—Nonesuch,
Melilot;
Staring Buttercups, a bold and yellow
lot.
Daisies rioting about the place
With Black-eyed Susan and Queen
Anne's Lace....*

Names—they blossom into colored
hills;
Hills whose rousing beauty flows
to me ...
And with all its soundless, purple
trumpets,
Lo, the Joe-Pyeweed still blows to
me!

LOUIS UNTERMAYER

TO A DAISY

Slight as thou art, thou art enough to
hide
Like all created things, secrets
from me,
And stand a barrier to eternity.
And I, how can I praise thee well and
wide

From where I dwell—upon the hither
side?

Thou little veil for so great
mystery,
When shall I penetrate all things
and thee,
And then look back? For this I must
abide,

Till thou shalt grow and fold and be
unfurled
Literally between me and the world.
Then I shall drink from in beneath
a spring,

And from a poet's side shall read his
book.
O daisy mine, what will it be to look
From God's side even of such a
simple thing?

ALICE MEYNELL

A SOFT DAY

A soft day, thank God!
A wind from the south
With a honeyed mouth;
A scent of drenching leaves,
Briar and beech and lime,
White elder-flower and thyme
And the soaking grass smells sweet,
Crushed by my two bare feet,
While the rain drips,
Drips, drips, drips from the eaves.

A soft day, thank God!
The hills wear a shroud

Of silver cloud;
The web the spider weaves
Is a glittering net;
The woodland path is wet,
And the soaking earth smells sweet
Under my two bare feet,
And the rain drips,
Drips, drips, drips from the eaves.

W. M. LETTS

ARBUTUS

Not Spring's
Thou art, but hers,
Most cool, most virginal,
Winter's, with thy faint breath, thy
 snows
Rose-tinged.

ADELAIDE CRAPSEY

JEWEL-WEED

Thou lonely, dew-wet mountain road,
 Traversed by toiling feet each day,
What rare enchantment maketh thee
 Appear so gay?

Thy sentinels, on either hand
 Rise tamarack, birch, and balsam-
 fir,
O'er the familiar shrubs that greet
 The wayfarer;

But here's a magic cometh new—
 A joy to gladden thee, indeed:
This passionate out-flowering of
 The jewel-weed,

That now, when days are growing
 drear,
 As Summer dreams that she is old,
Hangs out a myriad pleasure-bells
 Of mottled gold!

Thine only, these, thou lonely road!

Though hands that take, and
naught restore,
Rob thee of other treasured things,
Thine these are, for

A fairy, cradled in each bloom,
To all who pass the charmed spot
Whispers in warning: "Friend,
admire,—
But touch me not!

"Leave me to blossom where I
sprung,
A joy untarnished shall I seem;
Pluck me, and you dispel the charm
And blur the dream!"

FLORENCE EARLE COATES

THE WALL

"Something there is that doesn't like a wall." (ROBERT FROST)

"Not like a wall?"
I sit above the meadow in the
glowing fall
Tracing the grey redoubt from
square to square
Which bound the acres harvest-ripe
and fair,—
And wonder if it's true?
Nay, ask the sumac and the
teeming vine,
That lean upon the boulders,
The crimsoning ivy and the wild
woodbine

Whose eager fingers clutch the stony
shoulders,
The golden rod, the aster and the rue.
Ask the red squirrel with the chubby
cheek
 Skipping from stone to stone
By a quick route, his hidden hoard to
seek,
 Making the little viaduct his own.
Look where the woodchuck lifts a
cautious head
Between the rocks close by the
cabbage bed;
 The honey-bees have built a secret
hive
In a forgotten chink;
And there a grey cocoon is tucked
away
Shrouding a miracle in mauve and
pink
To wait its Easter day.
 The wall with pageantry is all
alive!

And I who gaze
 On the dark border here,
Drawn like a ribbon round the
pasture-ways,
 Embroidered with the glory of the
year,—
Do I not like the wall?
Lo, I remember how in days of old
 My grandsire toiled with weariness
and pain
To dig the cumbering boulders from
the mould;
 Piled them in ordered rows again,

Fitting them firm and fast,
A monument to last
Long after his own harried day was
past.

He cleared the rocky soil for corn
and grain
By which his children thrive
To carry on the race.

We live by his life-giving.
I see each stone, rough like his
granite face,—

Uncompromising, stern, no slave
to love,
Dowered with little grace,
Grim with the hard, unjoyful task
of living,
But strong to stand the wrath of storm
and time,
And bolts that heaven let fall.
Built of a patriot's prime,—
I love the wall!

ABBIE FARWELL BROWN

BOULDERS

There is a look of wisdom in yon
stones,
Great boulders basking in the
noonday heat,
Their grimness lightened by a fringe
of sweet
Fresh fern or moss or green-gray
lichen tones.
While through the glade an insect
army drones

And birds from neighboring boughs
 their notes repeat,
These patriarchs, drowsing as in bliss
 complete,
Rest on the flowery sward their
 tranquil bones.

A thousand or ten thousand years ago,
Shattered by frost, or by the torrent's
 might,
These boulders hurtled from some
 toppling height
And crashed through forests to the
 plain below.
Now, reconciled to Nature's gentler
 mood,
They lie on lowly earth and find it
 good.

CHARLES WHARTON STORK

AFTERNOON ON A HILL

I will be the gladdest thing
 Under the sun;
I will touch a hundred flowers
 And not pick one;

I will look at cliffs and clouds
 With quiet eyes;
Watch the wind bow down the grass,
 And the grass rise;

And when lights begin to show
 Up from the town,
I will mark which must be mine,

And then start down.

EDNA ST. VINCENT MILLAY

THE GOLDEN-ROD

O Rod of gold!
O swaying sceptre of the year—
Now frost and cold
Show Winter near,
And shivering leaves grow brown and
sere.
The bleak hillside,
And marshy waste of yellow reeds,
And meadows wide
Where frosted weeds
Shake on the damp wind light-winged
seeds,
Are decked with thee,—
The lingering Summer's latest grace,
And sovereignty.
Each wind-swept space
Waves thy red gold in Winter's face—
He strives each star,
In stormy pride to lay full low;
But when thy bar
Resists his blow,
Will crown thee with a puff of snow!

MARGARET DELAND

THE PATH THAT LEADS TO NOWHERE

There's a path that leads to nowhere

In a meadow that I know,
Where an inland island rises
And the stream is still and slow;
There it wanders under willows
And beneath the silver green
Of the birches' silent shadows
Where the early violets lean.

Other pathways lead to Somewhere,
But the one I love so well
Had no end and no beginning—
Just the beauty of the dell,
Just the windflowers and the lilies,
Yellow striped as adder's tongue
Seem to satisfy my pathway
As it winds their sweets among.

There I go to meet the Spring-time,
When the meadow is aglow,
Marigolds amid the marshes,—
And the stream is still and slow.—
There I find my fair oasis,
And with care-free feet I tread
For the pathway leads to nowhere,
And the blue is overhead!

All the ways that lead to Somewhere
Echo with the hurrying feet
Of the Struggling and the Striving,
But the way I find so sweet
Bids me dream and bids me linger,
Joy and Beauty are its goal,—
On the path that leads to nowhere
I have sometimes found my soul!

CORINNE ROOSEVELT ROBINSON

LOVERS AND ROSES

THE MESSAGE

*So fair the world about me lies,
So pure is heaven above,
Ere so much beauty dies
I would give a gift to my love;
Now, ere the long day close,
That has been so full of bliss,
I will send to my love the rose,
In its leaves I will shut a kiss;
A rose in the night to perish,
A kiss through life to cherish;
Now, ere the night-wind blows,
I will send unto her the rose.*

GEORGE EDWARD WOODBERRY

"WHERE LOVE IS LIFE"

Where love is life
The roses blow,
Though winds be rude
And cold the snow,
The roses climb
Serenely slow,
They nod in rhyme
We know—we know
Where love is life

The roses blow.

Where life is love
The roses blow,
Though care be quick
And sorrows grow,
Their roots are twined
With rose-roots so
That rosebuds find
A way to show
Where life is love
The roses blow.

DUNCAN CAMPBELL SCOTT

THE TIME OF ROSES

Love, it is the time of roses!
In bright fields and garden-closes
How they burgeon and unfold!
How they sweep o'er tombs and
 towers
In voluptuous crimson showers
And untrammelled tides of gold!

How they lure wild bees to capture
All the rich mellifluous rapture
Of their magical perfume,
And to passing winds surrender
And their frail and dazzling splendor
Rivalling your turban-plume!

How they cleave the air adorning
The high rivers of the morning
In a blithe, bejewelled fleet!
How they deck the moonlit grasses

In thick rainbow tinted masses
Like a fair queen's bridal sheet!

Hide me in a shrine of roses,
Drown me in a wine of roses
Drawn from every fragrant grove!
Bind me on a pyre of roses,
Burn me in a fire of roses,
Crown me with the rose of Love!

SAROJINI NAIDU

LOVE PLANTED A ROSE

Love planted a rose,
 And the world turned sweet.
Where the wheat-field blows
Love planted a rose.
Up the mill-wheel's prose
 Ran a music-beat.
Love planted a rose,
 And the world turned sweet.

KATHARINE LEE BATES

THE GARDEN

My heart shall be thy garden. Come,
 my own,
Into thy garden; thine be happy
 hours
Among my fairest thoughts, my
 tallest flowers,

From root to crowning petal thine
alone.

Thine is the place from where the
seeds are sown
Up to the sky enclosed, with all its
showers.
But ah, the birds, the birds! Who
shall build bowers
To keep these thine? O friend, the
birds have flown.

For as these come and go, and
quit our pine
To follow the sweet season,
or, new-comers,
Sing one song only from
our alder-trees,

My heart has thoughts, which, though
thine eyes hold mine,
Fit to the silent world and other
summers,
With wings that dip beyond the
silver seas.

ALICE MEYNELL

CLOUD AND FLOWER

I saw the giant stalking to the sky,
The giant cloud above the wilderness,
Bearing a mystery too far, too high,
For my poor guess.
Away I turned me, sighing: "I must
seek

In lowlier places for the wonder-
word.
Something more little, intimate, shall
speak."
A bright rose stirred.
And long I looked into its face, to see
At last some hidden import of the
hour.

And I had thought to turn from
mystery—
But O, flower! flower!

AGNES LEE

PROGRESS

There seems no difference between
To-day and yesterday—
The forest glimmers just as green,
The garden's just as gay.

Yet, something came and something
went
Within the night's chill gloom:
An old rose fell, her fragrance spent,
A new rose burst in bloom.

CHARLOTTE BECKER

"BUT WE DID WALK IN EDEN"

But we did walk in Eden,
Eden, the garden of God;—

There, where no beckoning wonder
Of all the paths we trod,
No choiring sun-filled vineyard,
No voice of stream or bird,
But was some radiant oracle
And flaming with the Word!

Mine ears are dim with voices;
Mine eyes yet strive to see
The black things here to wonder at,
The mirth,—the misery.
Beloved, who wert with me there,
How came these shames to be?—
On what lost star are we?

Men say: The paths of gladness
By men were never trod!—
But we have walked in Eden,
Eden, the garden of God.

JOSEPHINE PRESTON PEABODY

A GARDEN-PIECE

Among the flowers of summer-time
she stood,
And underneath the films and
blossoms shone
Her face, like some pomegranate
strangely grown
To ripe magnificence in solitude;
The wanton winds, deft whisperers,
had strewed
Her shoulders with her shining hair
out blown,

And dyed her breast with many a
 changing tone
Of silvery green, and all the hues that
 brood
 Among the flowers;
She raised her arm up for her dove to
 know
That he might preen him on her
 lovely head;
Then I, unseen, and rising on tiptoe,
Bowed over the rose-barriers, and lo!
Touched not her arm, but kissed her
 lips instead,
 Among the flowers!

EDMUND GOSSE

"HOW MANY FLOWERS ARE GENTLY MET"

How many flowers are gently met
Within my garden fair!
The daffodil, the violet,
And lilies dear are there.

They fade and pass, the fleeting
 flowers,
And brief their little light;
They hold not Love's diviner hours,
Nor Sower's human night.

Tho' one by one their bloom depart,
No change thy lover knows,
For mine the fragrance of thy heart,
O thou my perfect rose!

GEORGE STERLING

WITH A ROSE, TO BRUNHILDE

Brunhilde, with the young Norn soul
That has no peace, and grim as those
That spun the thread of life, give
 heed:

Peace is concealed in every rose.
And in these petals peace I bring:
A jewel clearer than the dew:
A perfume subtler than the breath
Of Spring with which it circles you.

Peace I have found, asleep, awake,
By many paths, on many a strand.
Peace overspreads the sky with stars.
Peace is concealed within your hand.
And when at night I clasp it there
I wonder how you never know
The strength you shed from finger-
 tips:
The treasure that consoles me so.

Begin the art of finding peace,
Beloved:—it is art, no less.
Sometimes we find it hid beneath
The orchards in their springtime
 dress:
Sometimes one finds it in oak woods,
Sometimes in dazzling mountain-
 snows;
In books, sometimes. But pray begin
By finding it within a rose.

VACHEL LINDSAY

"MY SOUL IS LIKE A GARDEN-CLOSE"

My soul is like a garden-close
Where marjoram and lilac grow,
Where soft the scent of long ago
Over the border lightly blows.

Where sometimes homing winds at
play
Bear the faint fragrance of a rose—
My soul is like a garden-close
Because you chanced to pass my way.

THOMAS S. JONES, JR.

A DREAM

I dreamed a dream of roses
somewhere breathing
Their sweet souls out upon the
summer night:
The flowers I saw not, but their
fragrance wreathing
Like clouds of incense filled me with
delight.
And then as if for my still further
pleasure
There came a flood of sweetest
melody,—
But whence I knew not flowed the
wondrous measure,
For neither flute nor viol could I see.
Then in the vision love sublime,
immortal,

Encircled all my soul with its pure
stream;
And though I saw thee not through
dreamland's portal,
I knew thou only hadst inspired the
dream.
'Tis thus thine influence itself
discloses,
In dreams of love, of music, and of
roses!

ANTOINETTE DE COURSEY PATTERSON

THE ROSE

The rose-tree wears a diadem,
Both bud and bloom of gold and
fire,
Too high upon the slender stem
For baby hands that reach for them:

And *Roses!* my brown Elsa cries:
Her chubby arms in vain aspire.
But rose-leaf Hilda smiles and sighs
And worships them with patient eyes.

I gathered them a rose or two,
But not the shy one hanging higher
That brushed my lips with honey-
dew!
That is the rose I send to you.

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING

PRAYER

Would that I might become you,
Losing myself, my sweet!—
So longs the dust that lies
About the rose's feet.

So longs the last, dim star
Hung on the verge of night;—
She moves—she melts—she slips—
She trembles into the light.

JOHN HALL WHEELLOCK

IN A GARDEN

I sat one day within a garden fair
Pining for thee and sad because
alone,
Wishing some fate could send thee to
me there.

All things appeared to share my
saddened mood,
Each flower drooped, the sun was hid
from view,
The very birds in silence seemed to
brood.

Then, as I day-dreamed with my eyes
half closed,
Sudden the birds began to sing again,
The flow'rs, uplifting heads, no
longer dozed.

Thinking the sun had come once
more for me
And for all nature, to effect such
change,
I turned and lo! saw not the sun but
thee.

LIVINGSTON L. BIDDLE

A SONG OF FAIRIES

Oh, the beauty of the world is in this
garden,
I hear it stir on every hand.
See how the flowers keep still
because of it!
hear how it trembles in the
blackbird's song!
There is a secret in it, a blessed
mystery.
I fain would weep to feel it near me,
my eyes
grow dim before these unseen
wings.
And the secret is in other places, it is
in songs
and music and all lovers' hearts.
Hush now, and walk on tiptoe, for
these are fairy things.

ELIZABETH KIRBY

A SONG TO BELINDA

Belinda in her dimity,
Whereon are wrought pink roses,
Trips through the boxwood paths to
me,
A-down the garden-closes,
As though a hundred roses came,
('Twas so I thought) to meet me,
As though one rosebud said my name
And bent its head to greet me.

Belinda, in your rose-wrought dress
You seemed the garden's growing;
The tilt and toss o' you, no less
Than wind-swayed posy blowing.
'Twas so I watched in sweet dismay,
Lest in that happy hour,
Sudden you'd stop and thrill and sway
And turn into a flower.

THEODOSIA GARRISON

SWEETHEART-LADY

De roses lean ter love her an' des won't leave de
place;
De climbin' mawnin'-glories sweet-smilin' in her
face;
De twinklin' pathway know her an' seem ter pass
de word,
An' de South Win' singin' ter her ter match de
mockin'-bird.

She sweetheart ter de Springtime,
W'en de dreamy roses stir,
An' Winter shine lak' Summer

An' wear a rose fer her.

"Sweetheart!" sing de Medder, w'en lak' de light she
pass;

De River take de tune up: "Make me yo' lookin'-
glass!"

But des who her true lover she never let 'em know;
De Win' is sich a tell-tale, an' de River run on so!

But Springtime come a-courtin'

An' let de blossoms fall,

An' Summer say: "I loves you!"

She sweetheart ter 'em ALL!

FRANK L. STANTON

HEART'S GARDEN

I have a garden filled with many
flowers:

The mignonette, the sweet-pea, and
the rose,

Daisies, and daffodils, whose color
glows

The fairer for the verdure which
embowers

Their beauty, and sets forth their
hidden powers

To charm my heart, whenever at the
close

Of day's dull hurry I would seek
repose

In my still garden through the
darkening hours.

Thus, Lady, do I keep a place apart,

Wherein my love for you cloistered
 shall be,
Far from the rattle of the city cart,
Even as my garden, where daily I
 may see
The flowers of your love, and none
 from me
May win the hidden secret of my
 heart.

NORREYS JEPHSON O'CONOR

A ROSE LOVER

Do thou, my rose, incline
Thy heart to mine.
If love be real
Ah, whisper, whisper low
That I at last may know.
Quick! breathe it now!
A sigh,—a tear,—a vow:
Oh, any lightest thing
Its cadences to sing
That loved am I, and not,
Ah, not forgot!

FREDERIC A. WHITING

SONNET

The sweet caresses that I gave to you
Are but the perfume of the Rose of
 Love,
The color and the witchery thereof,

And not the Rose itself. Each is a clue
Merely, whereby to seek the hidden,
true,
Substantial blossom. Like the
Jordan dove
A kiss is but a symbol from above
—
An emblem the Reality shines
through.

The Rose of Love is ever unrevealed
In all its beauty, for the sight of it
Were perilous with purpose of the
world.
The hand of Life has cautiously
concealed
The pollen-chamber of the infinite
Flower, and its petals only half
uncurled.

ELSA BARKER

A SONG IN A GARDEN

Will the garden never forget
That it whispers over and over,
"Where is your lover, Nanette?
Where is your lover—your lover?"
Oh, roses I helped to grow,
Oh, lily and mignonette,
Must you always question me so,
"Where is your lover, Nanette?"
Since you looked on my joy one day,
Is my grief then a lesser thing?
Have you only this to say
When I pray you for comforting?

Now that I walk alone
Here where our hands were met,
Must you whisper me everyone,
"Where is your lover, Nanette?"

I have mourned with you year and
year,
When the Autumn has left you bare,
And now that my heart is sere
Does not one of your roses care?
Oh, help me forget—forget,
Nor question over and over,
"Where is your lover, Nanette?
Where is your lover—your lover?"

THEODOSIA GARRISON

"IT WAS JUNE IN THE GARDEN"

It was June in the garden,
It was our time, our day;
And our gaze with love on everything
Did fall;
They seemed then softly opening,
And they saw and loved us both,
The roses all.

The sky was purer than all limpid
thought;
Insect and bird
Swept through the golden texture of
the air,
Unheard;
Our kisses were so fair they brought
Exaltation to both light and bird.

It seemed as though a happiness at
once
Had skied itself and wished the
heavens entire
For its resplendent fire;
And life, all pulsing life, had entered
in,
Into the fissures of our beings to the
core,
To fling them higher.

And there was nothing but invocatory
cries,
Mad impulses, prayers and vows that
cleave
The archèd skies,
And sudden yearning to create new
gods,
In order to believe.

EMILE VERHAEREN

TWO ROSES

A fair white rose sedately grows
Within the garden wall. There blows
No wind to ruff her petals white,
No stain of earth, no touch of blight
The pure face of my ladye shows.
The queen of all the walls enclose
Might be mine own, an' if I chose;
But yet, but yet I cannot slight
My wild red rose.

Outside the garden wall she throws
Her clinging tendrils, and she knows

How strong the winds of passion
 smite;
She's fragrant, though not faultless
 quite;
Just as she is, none shall depose
My wild red rose.

WILLIAM LINDSEY

ROSES

Red roses floating in a crystal bowl
You bring, O love; and in your eyes I
 see,
Blossom on blossom, your warm love
 of me
Burning within the crystal of your
 soul—
Red roses floating in a crystal bowl.

WILFRID WILSON GIBSON

HER GARDEN

This friendly garden, with its fragrant
 roses,—
It was not ours, when she was here
 below;
And so, in that low bed where she
 reposes,
The beauty of it all she cannot
 know.

But in the evening when the birds are
calling
The fragrance rises like a breath of
myrrh,
And in my empty heart, benignly
falling,
Becomes a little prayer to send to
her.

So, in that silent, lonely bed that
holds her,
Where nevermore the shadows rise
or flee,
I think a dream of radiant spring
enfolds her—
Of bloom and bird and bending
bough ... and me.

LOUIS DODGE

ÆRE PERENNIUS

As long as the stars of God
Hang steadfast in the sky,
And the blossoms 'neath the sod
Awake when Spring is nigh;
As long as the nightingale
Sings love-songs to the rose,
And the Winter wind in the vale
Makes moan o'er the virgin snows
—

As long as these things be
I would tell my love for thee!

As long as the rose of June
Bursts forth in crimson fire,

And the mellow harvest-moon
Shines over hill and spire;
As long as heaven's dew
At morning kisses the sod;
As long as you are you,
And I know that God is God—
As long as these things be
I would tell my love for thee!

CHARLES HANSON TOWNE

EVER THE SAME

King Solomon walked a thousand
times
Forth of his garden-close;
And saw there spring no goodlier
thing,
Be sure, than the same little rose.

Under the sun was nothing new,
Or now, I well suppose.
But what new thing could you find to
sing
More rare than the same little rose?

Nothing is new; save I, save you,
And every new heart that grows,
On the same Earth met, that nurtures
yet
Breath of the same little rose.

JOSEPHINE PRESTON PEABODY

THE MESSAGE

When one has heard the message of
the Rose,
For what faint other calling shall
he care?
Dark broodings turn to find their
lonely lair;
The vain world keeps her posturing
and pose.
He, with his crimson secret, which
bestows
Heaven in his heart, to Heaven lifts
his prayer,
And knows all glory trembling
through the air
As on triumphal journeying he goes.

So through green woodlands in the
twilight dim,
Led by the faint, pale argent of a
star,
What though to others it is
weary night,
Nature holds out her wide, sweet
heart to him;
And, leaning o'er the world's
mysterious bar,
His soul is great with everlasting
light.

HELEN HAY WHITNEY

TELL-TALE

The Lily whispered to the Rose:
"The Tulip's fearfully stuck up.
You'd think to see the creature's pose,
She was a golden altar-cup.
There's method in her boldness, too;
She catches twice her share of Dew."

The Rose into the Tulip's ear
Murmured: "The Lily is a sight;
Don't you believe she *powders*, dear,
To make herself so saintly white?
She takes some trouble, it is plain,
Her reputation to sustain."

Said Tulip to the Lily white:
"About the Rose—what do you
think?—
Her color? Should you say it's quite
—

Well, quite a natural shade of
pink?"
"Natural!" the Lily cried. "Good
Saints!
Why, *everybody* knows she paints!"

OLIVER HERFORD

DA THIEF

Eef poor man goes
An' steals a rose
Een Juna-time—
Wan leetla rose—
You gon' su'pose
Dat dat's a crime?

Eh! w'at? Den taka look at me,
For here bayfore your eyes you see
Wan thief dat ees so glad an' proud
He gona brag of eet out loud!
So moocha good I do, an' feel
From dat wan leetla rose I steal,
Dat eef I gon' to jail to-day
Dey could no tak' my joy away.
So, lees'en! here ees how eet com':
Las' night w'en I am walkin' home
From work een hotta ceety street,
Ees sudden com' a smal so sweet
Eet maka heaven een my nose—
I look an' dere I see da rose!
Not wan, but manny, fine an' tall,
Dat peep at me above da wall.
So, too, I close my eyes an' find
Anudder peecture een my mind;
I see a house dat's small an' hot
Where manny pretta theengs is not,
Where leetla woman, good an' true,
Ees work so hard da whole day
 through,
She's too wore out, w'en com's da
 night,
For smile an' mak' da housa bright.

But, presto! now I'm home an' she
Ees settin' on da step weeth me.
Bambino, sleepin' on her breast,
Ees nevva know more sweeta rest,
An' nevva was sooch glad su'prise
Like now ees shina from her eyes;
An' all baycause to-night she wear
Wan leetla rose stuck een her hair.
She ees so please'! Eet mak' me feel
I shoulda sooner learned to steal.

Eef "thief's" my name
I feel no shame;
 Eet ees no crime—
Dat rose I got.
Eh! w'at? O! not
 Een Juna-time!

T. A. DALY

RESULTS AND ROSES

The man who wants a garden fair,
 Or small or very big,
With flowers growing here and there,
 Must bend his back and dig.

The things are mighty few on earth
 That wishes can attain.
Whate'er we want of any worth
 We've got to work to gain.

It matters not what goal you seek,
 Its secret here reposes:
You've got to dig from week to week
 To get Results or Roses.

EDGAR A. GUEST

UNDERNEATH THE BOUGH

MIRACLE

*Yesterday the twig was brown and
bare;
To-day the glint of green is there
To-morrow will be leaflets spare;
I know no thing so wondrous fair
No miracle so strangely rare.*

I wonder what will next be there!

L. H. BAILEY

THE AWAKENING

You little, eager, peeping thing—
You embryonic point of light
Pushing from out your winter night,
How you do make my pulses sing!
A tiny eye amid the gloom—
The merest speck I scarce had seen—
So doth God's rapture rend the tomb
In this wee burst of April green!

And lo, 'tis here—and lo! 'Tis there—
Spurting its jets of sweet desire
In upward curling threads of fire
Like tapers kindling all the air.
Why, scarce it seems an hour ago

These branches clashed in bitter cold;
What Power hath set their veins
 aglow?

O soul of mine, be bold, be bold!
If from this tree, this blackened thing,
Hard as the floor my feet have prest,
This flame of joy comes clamoring
In hues as red as robin's breast
Waking to life this little twig—
O faith of mine, be big! Be big!

ANGELA MORGAN

SHADE

The kindest thing God ever made,
His hand of very healing laid
Upon a fevered world, is shade.

His glorious company of trees
Throw out their mantles, and on these
The dust-stained wanderer finds ease.

Green temples, closed against the
 beat
Of noontime's blinding glare and
 heat,
Open to any pilgrim's feet.

The white road blisters in the sun;
Now, half the weary journey done,
Enter and rest, Oh, weary one!

And feel the dew of dawn still wet
Beneath thy feet, and so forget
The burning highway's ache and fret.

This is God's hospitality,
And whoso rests beneath a tree
Hath cause to thank Him gratefully.

THEODOSIA GARRISON

SELECTION FROM "UNDER THE TREES"

The wonderful, strong, angelic trees,
With their blowing locks and their
 bared great knees
And nourishing bosoms, shout all
 together,
And rush and rock through the glad
 wild weather.

They are so old they teach me,
With their strong hands they reach
 me,
Into their breast my soul they take,
And keep me there for wisdom's sake.

They teach me little prayers;
To-day I am their child;
The sweet breath of their innocent
 airs
Blows through me strange and wild.

I never feel afraid
Among the trees;
Of trees are houses made;
And even with these,
Unhewn, untouched, unseen,

Is something homelike in the safe
 sweet green,
Intimate in the shade.

We are all brothers! Come, let's rest
 awhile
In the great kinship. Underneath the
 trees
Let's be at home once more, with
 birds and bees
And gnats and soil and stone. With
 these I must
Acknowledge family ties. Our
 mother, the dust,
With wistful and investigating eyes
Searches my soul for the old
 sturdiness,
Valor, simplicity! Stout virtues these,
 We learned at her dear knees.
 Friend, you and I
Once played together in the good old
 days.
Do you remember? Why, brother,
 down what wild ways
We traveled, when—
 That's right! Draw close to me!
Come now, let's tell the tale beneath
 the old roof-tree.

ANNA HEMPSTEAD BRANCH

A GARDEN FRIEND

O comrade tree, perhaps alive as I—
One process lacking of this mortal
 clay—
Give me your constant outlook to the
 sky,
The courtesy and cheer that fill your
 day.

Your noble gift of perfect service
 teach;
Your wisdom in the wild storm softly
 bent
Aware 'twill end; your patience that
 can reach
Across the years from clod to
 firmament.

CATHERINE MARKHAM (MRS. EDWIN MARKHAM)

A LADY OF THE SNOWS

The mountain hemlock droops her
 lacy branches
Oh, so tenderly
 In the summer sun!
Yet she has power to baffle
 avalanches—
She, rising slenderly
 Where the rivers run.

So pliant yet so powerful! Oh, see her
 Spread alluringly
 Her thin sea-green dress!
Now from white winter's thrall the
 sun would free her

To bloom unenduringly
In his glad caress.

HARRIET MONROE

THE TREE

Spread, delicate roots of my tree,
Feeling, clasping, thrusting, growing;
Sensitive pilgrim root tips roaming everywhere.
Into resistant earth your filaments forcing,
Down in the dark, unknown, desirous:
The strange ceaseless life of you, eating and drinking
 of earth,
The corrosive secretions of you, breaking the stuff of
 the world to your will.

Tips of my tree in the springtime bursting to terrible
 beauty,
Folded green life, exquisite, holy exultant;
I feel in you the splendour, the autumn of ripe
 fulfilment,
Love and labour and death, the sacred pageant of
 life.
In the sweet curled buds of you,
In the opening glory of leaves, tissues moulded of
 green light;
Veined, cut, perfect to type,
Each one like a child of high lineage bearing the sigil
 of race.

The open hands of my tree held out to the touch of
 the air
As love that opens its arms and waits on the lover's
 will;

The curtsey, the sway, and the toss of the spray as it
sports with the breeze;
Rhythmical whisper of leaves that murmur and move
in the light;
Crying of wind in the boughs, the beautiful music of
pain:
Thus do you sing and say
The sorrow, the effort, the sweet surrender, the joy.

Come! tented leaves of my tree;
High summer is here, the moment of passionate life,
The hushed, the maternal hour.
Deep in the shaded green your mystery shielding,
Heir of the ancient woods and parent of forests to be,
Lo! to your keeping is given the Father's life-giving
thought;
The thing that is dream and deed and carries the gift
of the past.
For this, for this, great tree,
The glory of maiden leaves, the solemn stretch of the
bough,
The wise persistent roots
Into the stuff of the world their filaments forcing,
Breaking the earth to their need.

Tall tree, your name is peace.
You are the channel of God:
His mystical sap,
Elixir of infinite love, syrup of infinite power,
Swelling and shaping, brooding and hiding,
With out-thrust of delicate joy, with pitiless pageant
of death,
Sings in your cells;
Its rhythmical cycle of life
In you is fulfilled.

EVELYN UNDERHILL

"LOVELIEST OF TREES"

Loveliest of trees, the cherry now
Is hung with bloom along the bough,
And stands about the woodland ride
Wearing white for Eastertide.

Now, of my threescore years and ten,
Twenty will not come again,
And take from seventy springs a
score,
It only leaves me fifty more.

And since to look at things in bloom
Fifty springs are little room,
About the woodlands I will go
To see the cherry hung with snow.

A. E. HOUSMAN

THE SPIRIT OF THE BIRCH

I am the dancer of the wood
I shimmer in the solitude
Men call me Birch Tree, yet I know
In other days it was not so.
I am a Dryad slim and white
Who danced too long one summer
night,
And the Dawn found and prisoned
me!

Captive I moaned my liberty.
But let the wood wind flutes begin
Their elfin music, faint and thin,
I sway, I bend, retreat, advance,
And evermore—I dance! I dance!

ARTHUR KETCHUM

FAMILY TREES

You boast about your ancient line,
But listen, stranger, unto mine:

You trace your lineage afar,
Back to the heroes of a war
Fought that a country might be free;
Yea, farther—to a stormy sea
Where winter's angry billows tossed,
O'er which your Pilgrim Fathers
crossed.

Nay, more—through yellow, dusty
tomes

You trace your name to English
homes

Before the distant, unknown West
Lay open to a world's behest;
Yea, back to days of those Crusades
When Turk and Christian crossed
their blades,

You point with pride to ancient
names,

To powdered sires and painted
dames;

You boast of this—your family tree;
Now listen, stranger, unto me:

When armored knights and gallant
squires,
Your own belovèd, honored sires,
Were in their infants' blankets rolled,
My fathers' youngest sons were old;
When they broke forth in infant tears
My fathers' heads were crowned with
years,
Yea, ere the mighty Saxon host
Of which you sing had touched the
coast,
Looked back as far as you look now.
Yea, when the Druids trod the wood,
My venerable fathers stood
And gazed through misty centuries
As far as even Memory sees.
When Britain's eldest first beheld
The light, my fathers then were eld.
You of the splendid ancestry,
Who boast about your family tree,

Consider, stranger, this of mine—
Bethink the lineage of a Pine.

DOUGLAS MALLOCH

IDEALISTS

Brother Tree:
Why do you reach and reach?
Do you dream some day to touch the
sky?
Brother Stream:
Why do you run and run?
Do you dream some day to fill the
sea?

Brother Bird:
Why do you sing and sing?
Do you dream—
Young Man:
Why do you talk and talk and talk?

ALFRED KREYMBORG

"DRAW CLOSER, O YE TREES"

O quiet cottage room,
Whose casements, looking o'er the
 garden-close,
Are hid in wildings and the woodbine
 bloom
And many a clambering rose,

Sweet is thy light subdued,
Gracious and soft, lingering upon my
 book,
As that which shimmers through the
 branchèd wood
Above some dreamful nook!

Leaning within my chair,
Through the curtain I can see the stir
 —
The gentle undulations of the air—
 Sway the dark-layered fir;

And, in the beechen green,
Mark many a squirrel romp and
 chirrup loud;
While far beyond, the chestnut-
 boughs between,
Floats the white summer cloud.

Through the loopholes in the
leaves,
Upon the yellow slopes of far-off
farms,
I see the rhythmic cradlers and the
sheaves
Gleam in the binders' arms.

At times I note, nearby,
The flicker tapping on some hollow
bole;
And watch the sun, against the sky,
The fluting oriole;

Or, when the day is done,
And the warm splendors make the
oak-top flush,
Hear him, full-throated in the setting
sun,—
The darling wildwood thrush.

O sanctuary shade
Enfold one round! I would no longer
roam:
Let not the thought of wandering e'er
invade
This still, reclusive home!

Draw closer, O ye trees!
Veil from my sight e'en the loved
mountain's blue;
The world may be more fair beyond
all these,
Yet I would know but you!

LLOYD MIFFLIN

TREES

In the Garden of Eden, planted by
God,
There were goodly trees in the
springing sod,—

Trees of beauty and height and grace,
To stand in splendor before His face.

Apple and hickory, ash and pear,
Oak and beech and the tulip rare,

The trembling aspen, the noble pine,
The sweeping elm by the river line;

Trees for the birds to build and sing,
And the lilac tree for a joy in spring;

Trees to turn at the frosty call
And carpet the ground for their Lord's
footfall;

Trees for fruitage and fire and shade,
Trees for the cunning builder's trade;

Wood for the bow, the spear, and the
flail,
The keel and the mast of the daring
sail;

He made them of every grain and
girth,
For the use of man in the Garden of
Earth.

Then lest the soul should not lift her
eyes

From the gift to the Giver of
Paradise,

On the crown of a hill, for all to see,
God planted a scarlet maple tree.

BLISS CARMAN

THE TREES

There's something in a noble tree—
What shall I say? a soul?
For 'tis not form, or aught we see
In leaf or branch or bole.
Some presence, though not
understood,
Dwells there alway, and seems
To be acquainted with our mood,
And mingles in our dreams.

I would not say that trees at all
Were of our blood and race,
Yet, lingering where their shadows
fall,
I sometimes think I trace
A kinship, whose far-reaching root
Grew when the world began,
And made them best of all things
mute
To be the friends of man.

Held down by whatsoever might
Unto an earthly sod,
They stretch forth arms for air and
light,
As we do after God;

And when in all their boughs the
 breeze
 Moans loud, or softly sings,
As our own hearts in us, the trees
 Are almost human things.

What wonder in the days that burned
 With old poetic dream,
Dead Phaëthon's fair sisters turned
 To poplars by the stream!
In many a light cotillion stept
 The trees when flutters blew;
And many a tear, 'tis said, they wept
 For human sorrow too.

Mute, said I? They are seldom thus;
 They whisper each to each,
And each and all of them to us,
 In varied forms of speech.
"Be serious," the solemn pine
 Is saying overhead;
"Be beautiful," the elm-tree fine
 Has always finely said;

"Be quick to feel," the aspen still
 Repeats the whole day long;
While, from the green slope of the
 hill,
 The oak-tree adds, "Be strong."
When with my burden, as I hear
 Their distant voices call,
I rise, and listen, and draw near,
 "Be patient," say they all.

SAMUEL VALENTINE COLE

THE POPLARS

My poplars are like ladies trim,
Each conscious of her own estate;
In costume somewhat over prim,
In manner cordially sedate,
Like two old neighbours met to chat
Beside my garden gate.

My stately old aristocrats—
I fancy still their talk must be
Of rose-conserves and Persian cats,
And lavender and Indian tea;—
I wonder sometimes as I pass
If they approve of me.

I give them greeting night and morn,
I like to think they answer, too,
With that benign assurance born
When youth gives age the reverence
 due,
And bend their wise heads as I go
As courteous ladies do.

Long may you stand before my door,
Oh, kindly neighbours garbed in
 green,
And bend with rustling welcome o'er
The many friends who pass between;
And where the little children play
Look down with gracious mien.

THEODOSIA GARRISON

TREES

I think that I shall never see
A poem lovely as a tree.

A tree whose hungry mouth is prest
Against the earth's sweet flowing
 breast;

A tree that looks at God all day,
And lifts her leafy arms to pray;

A tree that may in Summer wear
A nest of robins in her hair;

Upon whose bosom snow has lain;
Who intimately lives with rain.

Poems are made by fools like me,
But only God can make a tree.

JOYCE KILMER

THE LOST GARDENS OF THE HEART

AS IN A ROSE-JAR

*As in a rose-jar filled with petals
sweet
Blown long ago in some old garden
place,
Mayhap, where you and I, a little
space
Drank deep of love and knew that
love was fleet—
Or leaves once gathered from a lost
retreat
By one who never will again
retrace
Her silent footsteps—one, whose
gentle face
Was fairer than the roses at her feet;

So, deep within the vase of memory
I keep my dust of roses fresh and
dear
As in the days before I knew the
smart
Of time and death. Nor aught can
take from me
The haunting fragrance that still
lingers here—
As in a rose-jar, so within the
heart!*

THOMAS S. JONES, JR.

IN AN OLD GARDEN

Old phantoms haunt it of the long-
 ago;
Old ghosts of old-time lovers and of
 dreams:
Within the quiet sunlight there,
 meseems,
I see them walking where those lilies
 blow.
The hardy phlox sways to some
 garments' flow;
The salvia there with sudden scarlet
 streams,
Caught from some ribbon of some
 throat that gleams,
Petunia fair, in flounce and furbelow.
I seem to hear their whispers in each
 wind
That wanders 'mid the flowers. There
 they stand!
Among the shadows of that apple
 tree!
They are not dead, whom still it
 keeps in mind,
This garden, planted by some lovely
 hand
That keeps it fragrant with its
 memory.

MADISON CAWEIN

THE GARDEN OF DREAMS

My heart is a garden of dreams

Where you walk when day is done,
Fair as the royal flowers,
Calm as the lingering sun.

Never a drouth comes there,
Nor any frost that mars,
Only the wind of love
Under the early stars,—

The living breath that moves
Whispering to and fro,
Like the voice of God in the dusk
Of the garden long ago.

BLISS CARMAN

HOMESICK

O my garden! lying whitely in the moonlight and the
dew,
Far across the leagues of distance flies my heart to-
night to you,
And I see your stately lilies in the tender radiance
gleam
With a dim, mysterious splendor, like the angels of a
dream!

I can see the stealthy shadows creep along the ivied
wall,
And the bosky depths of verdure where the drooping
vine-leaves fall,
And the tall trees standing darkly with their crowns
against the sky,
While overhead the harvest moon goes slowly
sailing by.

I can see the trellised arbor, and the roses' crimson
 glow,
And the lances of the larkspurs all glittering, row on
 row,
And the wilderness of hollyhocks, where brown bees
 seek their spoil,
And butterflies dance all day long, in glad and gay
 turmoil.

O, the broad paths running straightly, north and
 south and east and west!
O, the wild grape climbing sturdily to reach the
 oriole's nest!
O, the bank where wild flowers blossom, ferns nod
 and mosses creep
In a tangled maze of beauty over all the wooded
 steep!

Just beyond the moonlit garden I can see the orchard
 trees,
With their dark boughs overladen, stirring softly in
 the breeze,
And the shadows on the greensward, and within the
 pasture bars
The white sheep huddling quietly beneath the pallid
 stars.

O my garden! lying whitely in the moonlight and the
 dew,
Far across the restless ocean flies my yearning heart
 to you,
And I turn from storied castle, hoary fane, and ruined
 shrine,
To the dear, familiar pleasaunce where my own
 white lilies shine—

With a vague, half-startled wonder if some night in
 Paradise,

From the battlements of heaven I shall turn my
 longing eyes
All the dim, resplendent spaces and the mazy
 stardrifts through
To my garden lying whitely in the moonlight and the
 dew!

JULIA C. R. DORR

THE WAYS OF TIME

As butterflies are but winged flowers,
 Half sorry for their change, who
 fain,
So still and long they live on leaves,
 Would be thought flowers again.—

E'en so my thoughts, that should
 expand,
 And grow to higher themes above,
Return like butterflies to lie
 On the old things I love.

WILLIAM H. DAVIES

A MIDSUMMER GARDEN

There is a little garden-close,
 Girdled by golden apple trees,
That through the long sweet summer
 hours
 Is haunted by the hum of bees.

The poppy tosses here its torch,

And the tall bee-balm flaunts its
fire,
And regally the larkspur lifts
The slender azure of its spire.

And from the phlox and mignonette
Rich attars drift on every hand;
And when star-vestured twilight
comes
The pale moths weave a saraband.

And crickets in the aisles of grass
With their clear fifeing pierce the
hush;
And somewhere you may hear anear
The passion of the hermit-thrush.

It is a place where dreams convene,
Dreams of the dead years gone
astray,
Of love and loveliness borne back
From some forgotten yesterday.

It is a memory-hallowed spot
Where joy assumes its vernal
guise,
And two walk silent side by side,
Youth's glory shining in their eyes.

CLINTON SCOLLARD

THE WHITE ROSE

This is the spirit flower,
The ghost of an old regret;
All night she stands in the garden-
close,

And her face with tears is wet.
But I love the pale white rose,
For she always seems to me
A pallid nun who dreams all day
Of a distant memory.

Alas! how well I know
That every garden spot
Is haunted by a gentle ghost
Who will not be forgot.
In the garden of the heart,
Ere the sun of life is set,
O many a wild rose blooms and
dreams
Of many an old regret!

CHARLES HANSON TOWNE

A HAUNTED GARDEN

Between the moss and stone
The lonely lilies rise;
Wasted and overgrown
The tangled garden lies.
Weeds climb about the stoop
And clutch the crumbling walls;
The drowsy grasses droop—
The night wind falls.

The place is like a wood;
No sign is there to tell
Where rose and iris stood
That once she loved so well.
Where phlox and asters grew,
A leafless thornbush stands,
And shrubs that never knew

Her tender hands....

Over the broken fence

The moonbeams trail their shrouds;

Their tattered cerements

Cling to the gauzy clouds,

In ribbons frayed and thin—

And startled by the light,

Silence shrinks deeper in

The depths of night.

Useless lie spades and rakes;

Rust's on the garden-tools.

Yet, where the moonlight makes

Nebulous silver pools,

A ghostly shape is cast—

Something unseen has stirred ...

Was it a breeze that passed?

Was it a bird?

Dead roses lift their heads

Out of a grassy tomb;

From ruined pansy-beds

A thousand pansies bloom.

The gate is opened wide—

The garden that has been,

Now blossoms like a bride ...

Who entered in?

LOUIS UNTERMAYER

THE DUSTY HOUR-GLASS

It had been a trim garden,

With parterres of fringed pinks and gillyflowers,

and smooth-raked walks.

Silks and satins had brushed the box edges
of its alleys.
The curved stone lips of its fishponds
had held the rippled reflections of tricorns
and
powdered periwigs.
The branches of its trees had glittered with lanterns,
and swayed to the music of flutes and
violins.

Now, the fishponds are green with scum;
And paths and flower-beds
are run together and overgrown.
Only at one end is an octagonal Summerhouse
not yet in ruins.
Through the lozenged panes of its windows,
you can see the interior:
A dusty bench; a fireplace,
with a lacing of letters carved in the stone
above it;
A broken ball of worsted
rolled away into a corner.

Dolci, dolci, i giorni passati!

AMY LOWELL

THE SONG OF WANDERING AENGUS

I went out to the hazel wood
Because a fire was in my head,
And cut and peeled a hazel wand,
And hooked a berry to a thread;
And when white moths were on the
wing,

And moth-like stars were flickering
out,
I dropped the berry in a stream,
And caught a little silver trout.

When I had laid it on the floor,
I went to blow the fire a-flame,
But something rustled on the floor,
And some one called me by my
name:
It had become a glimmering girl,
With apple-blossom in her hair,
Who called me by my name and ran
And faded through the brightening
air.

Though I am old with wandering
Through hollow lands and hilly lands,
I will find out where she has gone,
And kiss her lips and take her hands;
And walk among long dappled grass,
And pluck till time and times are
done
The silver apples of the moon,
The golden apples of the sun.

W. B. YEATS

THE THREE CHERRY TREES

There were three cherry trees once,
Grew in a garden all shady;
And there for delight of so gladsome
a sight,
Walked a most beautiful lady,
Dreamed a most beautiful lady.

Birds in those branches did sing,
Blackbird and throstle and linnet,
But she walking there was by far the
 most fair—
Lovelier than all else within it,
Blackbird and throstle and linnet.

But blossoms to berries do come,
All hanging on stalks light and
 slender,
And one long summer's day charmed
 that lady away,
With vows sweet and merry and
 tender;
A lover with voice low and tender.

Moss and lichen the green
 branches deck;
Weeds nod in its paths green and
 shady;
Yet a light footstep seems there to
 wander in dreams,
The ghost of that beautiful lady,
That happy and beautiful lady.

WALTER DE LA MARE

OLD GARDENS

The white rose tree that spent its
 musk
For lovers' sweeter praise,
The stately walks we sought at dusk,
Have missed thee many days.

Again, with once-familiar feet,

I tread the old parterre—
But, ah, its bloom is now less sweet
Than when thy face was there.

I hear the birds of evening call;
I take the wild perfume;
I pluck a rose—to let it fall
And perish in the gloom.

ARTHUR UPSON

THE BLOOMING OF THE ROSE

What is it like, to be a rose?

Old Roses, softly, "Try and see."

Nay, I will tarry. Let me be
In my green peacefulness and smile.
I will stay here and dream awhile.
'Tis well for little buds to dream,
Dream—dream—who knows—
Say, is it good to be a rose?
Old roses, tell me! Is it good?

Old Roses, very softly, "Good."

I am afraid to be a rose!
This little sphere wherein I wait,
Curled up and small and delicate,
Lies in a twilight of pure green,
Wherein are dreams of night and
morn
And the sweet stillness of a world
Where all things are that are unborn.

Old Roses, "Better to be born."

I cannot be a bud for long.
My sheath is like a heart full blown,
And I, the silence of a song
Withdrawn into that heart alone,
Well knowing that it shall be sung.
Outside the great world comes and
 goes—
I think I doubt, to be a rose—

Old Roses, "Doubt? To be a Rose!"

ANNA HEMPSTEAD BRANCH

THE GARDEN OF MNEMOSYNE

There are no roses in the garden now,
 The summer birds have vanished
 oversea,
The ashen keys hang rusty on the
 bough,
 Autumn's gold ensigns flame from
 tree to tree.

Music and perfume sleep, and light is
 fled,
 Autumn's fine gold is faery gold,
 we know.
Where shall we turn for joy when
 flowers are dead,
 When birds are silent, and the cold
 winds blow?

The summer birds have vanished
 oversea,
 But Memory's palace-courts are
 full of song;

There sings a nightingale for you and
me,
And there a hidden lute plays all
day long.

There are no roses in the garden now,
But Memory's garden grows each
day more fair;
Sun, moon, and stars her orchard
close endow,
And there bloom roses—roses
everywhere.

ROSAMUND MARRIOTT WATSON

BALLADE OF THE DREAMLAND ROSE

Where the waves of burning cloud
are rolled
On the further shore of the sunset
sea,
In a land of wonder that none behold,
There blooms a rose on the
Dreamland Tree
That stands in the Garden of Mystery
Where the River of Slumber softly
flows;
And whenever a dream has come to
be,
A petal falls from the Dreamland
Rose.

In the heart of the tree, on a branch of
gold,
A silvern bird sings endlessly
A mystic song that is ages old,

A mournful song in a minor key,
Full of the glamour of faery;
And whenever a dreamer's ears
unclose
To the sound of that distant melody,
A petal falls from the Dreamland
Rose.

Dreams and visions in hosts untold
Throng around on the moonlit lea:
Dreams of age that are calm and cold,
Dreams of youth that are fair and
free—
Dark with a lone heart's agony,
Bright with a hope that no one
knows—
And whenever a dream and a dream
agree,
A petal falls from the Dreamland
Rose.

ENVOI

Princess, you gaze in a reverie
Where the drowsy firelight redly
glows;
Slowly you raise your eyes to me ...
A petal falls from the Dreamland
Rose.

BRIAN HOOKER

THE FLOWERS OF JUNE

These flowers of June
The gates of memory unbar;

These flowers of June
Such old-time harmonies retune,
 I fain would keep the gates ajar,
 So full of sweet enchantment are
These flowers of June.

Was it the bloom of the laurel sprays,
 That wakened remembrance of
 singing birds?
Or, was it the charm of
 remembered words,
That set my heart singing through
 somber days?
I longed for the summer-time,
 flower and tree;
And lo! the summer-time came
 with thee.
The bloom is no more, but the charm
 still stays.

JAMES TERRY WHITE

IN MEMORY'S GARDEN

There is a garden in the twilight lands
 Of Memory, where troops of
 butterflies
Flutter adown the cypress paths, and
 bands
Of flowers mysterious droop their
 drowsy eyes.

There through the silken hush come
 footfalls faint
And hurried through the vague
 parterres, and sighs

Whispering of rapture or of sweet
complaint
Like ceaseless parle of bees and
butterflies.

And by one lonely pathway steal I
soon
To find the flowerings of the old
delight
Our hearts together knew—when lo,
the moon
Turns all the cypress alleys into
white.

THOMAS WALSH

SERENADE

Dark is the iris meadow,
Dark is the ivory tower,
And lightly the young moth's shadow
Sleeps on the passion-flower.

Gone are our day's red roses.
So lovely and lost and few,
But the first star uncloses
A silver bud in the blue.

Night, and a flame in the embers
Where the seal of the years was set,

—

When the almond-bough remembers
How shall my heart forget?

MARJORIE L. C. PICKTHALL

"WHAT HEART BUT FEARS A FRAGRANCE?"

What heart but fears a fragrance?

Alien they

Who breathe in the white lilac only

May;

For there be other spirits unto whom

Fate's kiss lies dreaming in each stray
perfume!

Who mock at ghosts of odour—poor
they be!

Bereft the scented balms of memory,

For unto one in April's rain-blest
earth

There starts for aye the sharp, glad
cry of birth;

And Love will find in rooms
unbarred for years

Familiar sweetness loosing sudden
tears,

Clasping the will in mastering
embrace

As in the presence of a phantom
grace.

Then there be odours pungent—fires
in Fall

The gipsying of boyhood to recall;

And there be perfumes holy—nay,
but one

Whose pang is like none other 'neath
the sun

To drown the sinking senses in a joy

Beyond all time to weaken or
destroy!

Odours there be that swoon, entreat,
caress—
Elusive thrall, to doom or stab or
bless;
Each vagrant scent that holds the
breath in fee
Doth wed the heart in Life's eternity.

Who fear no wraiths of fragrance—
sorry they;
Who breathe in lilac odours only
May;
For there be other mortals unto whom
White magic wanders in each stray
perfume.

MARTHA GILBERT DICKINSON BIANCHI

YEARS AFTERWARD

It is not sight or sound
That, when a heart forgets,
Most makes it to remember:
It's some old poignant scent re-found

—
Like breath of April violets,
Or apples of September.

It isn't song or scene
That stirs the tears again:
It's brush smoke from the hills at
night,
Spicy and sweet; or that wet, keen,
Long lost aroma of delight,
Fresh ploughed fields after rain.

NANCY BYRD TURNER

AUTUMNAL

Across the scented garden of my
dreams
Where roses grew, Time passes like
a thief,
Among my trees his silver sickle
gleams,
The grass is stained with many a
ruddy leaf;
And on cold winds the petals float
away
That were the pride of June and her
array.

The bare boughs weave a net upon
the sky
To catch Love's wings and his fair
body bruise;
There are no flowers in the rosary—
No song-birds in the mournful
avenues;
Though on the sodden air not lightly
breaks
The elegy of Youth, whom love
forsakes.

Ah, Time! one flower of all my
garden spare,
One rose of all the roses, that in
this
I may possess my love's perfumed
hair

And all the crimson secrets of her
kiss.
Grant me one rose that I may drink its
wine,
And from her lips win the last
anodyne.

For I have learnt too many things to
live,
And I have loved too many things
to die;
But all my barren acres I would give
For one red blossom of eternity,
To animate the darkness and delight
The spaces and the silences of night.

But dreams are tender flowers that in
their birth
Are very near to death, and I shall
reap,
Who planted wonder, unavailing
earth,
Harsh thorns and miserable husks
of sleep.
I have had dreams, but have not
conquered Time,
And love shall vanish like an empty
rhyme.

RICHARD MIDDLETON

"OH, TELL ME HOW MY GARDEN GROWS"

Oh, tell me how my garden grows,
Now I no more may labor there;
Do still the lily and the rose

Bloom on without my fostering
care?

Do peonies blush as deep with pride,
The larkspurs burn as bright a blue,
And velvet pansies stare as wide
I wonder, as they used to do?

The tender things that would not
blow
Unless I coaxed them, do they raise
Their petals in a sturdy row,
Forgetful, to the stranger's gaze?

Or do they show a paler shade,
And sigh a little in the wind
For one whose sheltering presence
made
Their step-dame Nature less
unkind?

Oh, tell me how my garden grows,
Where I no more may take delight,
And if some dream of me it knows,
Who dream of it by day and night.

MILDRED HOWELLS

HER GARDEN

This was her dearest walk last year.
Her hands
Set all the tiny plants, and tenderly
Pressed firm the unfamiliar soil; and
she
It was who watered them at evening
time.

She loved them; and I too, because of
her.

And now another June has come,
while I

Am walking in the shadow, sad,
alone.

Yet when I reach the rose-path that
was hers,

And breathe the fragrancy of bud and
bloom,

She stands beside; the murmur of the
leaves,

The well-remembered rustle of her
gown,

And low her whisper comes, "My
dear! My dear!"

This is her garden. Only she and I—

But always we—may walk its
hallowed ways;

And all the thoughts she planted in
my heart,

Sunned with her smile, and chastened
with her tears,

Again have blossomed—love's
perennials.

ELDREDGE DENISON

THE LITTLE GHOST

I knew her for a little ghost

That in my garden walked,—

The wall is high—higher than most—

And the green gate was locked;

And yet I did not think of that

Till after she was gone;
I knew her by the broad white hat,
All ruffled, she had on,

By the dear ruffles round her feet,
By her small hands, that hung
In their lace mitts, austere and sweet,
Her gown's white folds among.

I watched to see if she would stay,
What she would do,—and, oh,
She looked as if she liked the way
I let my garden grow!

She bent above my favorite mint
With conscious garden grace,
She smiled and smiled,—there was
no hint
Of sadness in her face;

She held her gown on either side,
To let her slippers show,
And up the walk she went with pride,
The way great ladies go;

And where the wall is built in new,
And is of ivy bare,
She paused,—then opened and passed
through
A gate that once was there.

EDNA ST. VINCENT MILLAY

ROSES IN THE SUBWAY

A wan-cheeked girl with faded eyes

Came stumbling down the crowded
car,
Clutching her burden to her breast
As though she held a star.

Roses, I swear it! Red and sweet
And struggling from her pinched
white hands,
Roses ... like captured hostages
From far and fairy lands!

The thunder of the rushing train
Was like a hush.... The flower scent
Breathed faintly on the stale, whirled
air
Like some dim sacrament—

I saw a garden stretching out
And morning on it like a crown—
And o'er a bed of crimson bloom
My mother ... stooping down.

DANA BURNET

THE GARDEN OVER-SEAS

A GARDEN PRAYER

*That we are mortals and on earth
must dwell
Thou knowest, Allah, and didst give
us bread—
And remembering of our souls didst
give us food of flowers—
Thy name be hallowed.*

THOMAS WALSH

IN THE GARDEN-CLOSE AT MEZRA

In the garden-close at Mezra,
When the cactus was in flower,
We sat apart together
Through the languid noonday hour.

I was her Arab lover,
(Of course it was all in play!)
And I called her "Star-of-Twilight,"
And I called her "Dream-of-Day."

She—has she quite forgotten?
Soothly, I do not know
If ever she tenderly opens
The volume of Long Ago.

But I—I can still remember
Her lips like the cactus flower
In the garden-close at Mezra
At the languid noonday hour!

CLINTON SCOLLARD

THE CACTUS

The scarlet flower, with never a
sister-leaf,
Stemless, springs from the edge of
the Cactus-thorn:
Thus from the rugged wounds of
desperate grief
A beautiful Thought, perfect and
pure, is born.

LAURENCE HOPE

THE WHITE PEACOCK

Here where the sunlight
Floodeth the garden,
Where the pomegranate
Reareth its glory
Of gorgeous blossom;
Where the oleanders
Dream through the noontides;
And, like surf o' the sea
Round cliffs of basalt,
The thick magnolias
In billowy masses
Front the sombre green of the ilexes:

Here where the heat lies
Pale blue in the hollows,
Where blue are the shadows
On the fronds of the cactus,
Where pale blue the gleaming
Of fir and cypress,
With the cones upon them
Amber or glowing with virgin gold:
Here where the honey-flower
Makes the heat fragrant,
As though from the gardens
Of Gulistan,
Where the bulbul singeth
Through a mist of roses
A breath were borne:
Here where the dream-flowers,
The cream-white poppies
Silently waver,
And where the Scirocco,
Faint in the hollows,
Foldeth his soft white wings in the
 sunlight,
And lieth sleeping
Deep in the heart of
A sea of white violets:
Here, as the breath, as the soul of this
 beauty,
Moveth in silence, and dreamlike,
 and slowly,
White as a snow-drift in mountain-
 valleys
When softly upon it the gold light
 lingers:
White as the foam o' the sea that is
 driven
O'er billows of azure agleam with
 sun-yellow:

Cream-white and soft as the breasts
 of a girl,
Moves the White Peacock, as though
 through the noontide
A dream of the moonlight were real
 for a moment.
Dim on the beautiful fan that he
 spreadeth,
Foldeth and spreadeth abroad in the
 sunlight,
Dim on the cream-white are blue
 adumbrations,
Shadows so pale in their delicate
 blueness
That visions they seem as of
 vanishing violets,
The fragrant white violets veined
 with azure,
Pale, pale as the breath of blue smoke
 in far woodlands.
Here, as the breath, as the soul of this
 beauty,
White as the cloud through the heats
 of the noontide
Moves the White Peacock.

WILLIAM SHARP

AT ISOLA BELLA

Once at Isola Bella,
 With sunset in the sky,
We stood on the topmost terrace—
 You and I.

Around us Lago Maggiore,

Incomparably fair,
Gave back the hues of heaven
To the Italian air.

Then up the marble terrace
Below the cypress trees
Came a flock of milk-white peacocks
With fans spread to the breeze.

Rose-pink on each outspread feather,
Rose-pink upon the crest,—
Never were birds in plumage
So ravishingly drest!

Wherever we walked they followed,
Stately at our feet,
No picture so enchanting
Will any hour repeat.

And here in the murky city
Those milk-white peacocks seem
To follow and follow me ever
Like ghosts of a haunting dream.

JESSIE B. RITTENHOUSE

THE FOUNTAIN

All through the deep blue night
The fountain sang alone;
It sang to the drowsy heart
Of the satyr carved in stone.

The fountain sang and sang
But the satyr never stirred—
Only the great white moon
In the empty heaven heard.

The fountain sang and sang
While on the marble rim
The milk-white peacocks slept,
And their dreams were strange and
dim.

Bright dew was on the grass,
And on the ilex, dew,
The dreamy milk-white birds
Were all a-glisten, too.

The fountain sang and sang
The things one cannot tell;
The dreaming peacocks stirred
And the gleaming dew-drops fell.

SARA TEASDALE

THE CHAMPA FLOWER

Supposing I became a champa flower, just for fun, and grew on a branch high up that tree, and shook in the wind with laughter and danced upon the newly budded leaves, would you know me, mother?

You would call, "Baby, where are you?" and I should laugh to myself and keep quite quiet.

I should slyly open my petals and watch you at your work.

When after your bath, with wet hair spread on your shoulders, you walked through the shadow of the champa tree to the little court where you say your prayers, you would notice the scent of the flower, but not know that it came from me.

When after the midday meal you sat at the window reading *Ramayana*, and the tree's shadow fell over your hair and your lap, I should fling my wee little shadow on to the page of your book, just where you were reading.

But would you guess that it was the tiny shadow of your little child?

When in the evening you went to the cow-shed with the lighted lamp in your hand, I should suddenly drop on to the earth again and be your own baby once more, and beg you to tell me a story.

"Where have you been, you naughty child?"

"I won't tell you, mother." That's what you and I would say then.

RABINDRANATH TAGORE

IN AN EGYPTIAN GARDEN

Can it be winter elsewhere?

Forsooth, it seems not so!

The moonlight on the garden square

Must be the only snow,

For all about me, fragrant fair,

The blooms of summer blow.

Wine-lipped and beautiful and bland,

The rose displays its dower;

The heavy-scented citron and

The stainless lily-tower;

And whiter than a houri's hand,

El Ful, the Arab flower.

In purple silhouette a palm

Lifts from a vine-wreathed plinth

Against a sky whose cloudless calm

Is hued like hyacinth;

And echoes with a bulbul's psalm

The jasmine labyrinth.

In life's tumultuous ocean swell

Here is a charmed isle;

I hear a late muezzin tell
His holy tale the while,
And like the faint notes of a bell
The boat-songs of old Nile.

Across my spirit thrills no theme
That is not marvel-bright;
I see within the lotus gleam
The nectar of delight,
And, tasting it, I drift and dream
Adown the glamoured night!

CLINTON SCOLLARD

EVENING IN OLD JAPAN

Peaceful and mellow looks the sky
to-night
As some great Buddha made of
ivory,
Upon whose brow is set a moonstone
white,
The shining emblem of its purity.

A dim blue haze like incense, rising
high,
Merges together mountain, tree,
and stream;
But over all still broods an ivory sky
Cloudless as Buddha's face, one
gem a gleam.

ANTOINETTE DE COURSEY PATTERSON

REFLECTIONS

When I looked into your eyes,
I saw a garden
With peonies, and tinkling pagodas,
And round-arched bridges
Over still lakes.

A woman sat beside the water
In a rain-blue, silken garment.
She reached through the water

To pluck the crimson peonies
Beneath the surface.

But as she grasped the stems,
They jarred and broke into white-
 green ripples.
And as she drew out her hand,
The water drops dripping from it
Stained her rain-blue dress like tears.

AMY LOWELL

IN THE GARDEN

Do you remember, Sister,
The golden afternoon
When we looked upon the lotus
And listened to the croon
Of the doves that sat together
Among the flowers of June?

And deep among the valleys
A far, sweet sound was heard—
Some fluter in the forest
That like a magic bird
Sang of the unseen heavens
And mystic Way and Word.

PAI TA-SHUN

THE DESERTED GARDEN

I hear no more the swish of silks
Along the marble walks;

The autumn wind blows sharp and
cold
Among the flowerless stalks.

In place of petals of the peach
Fast drifts the yellow leaf;
And looking in the lotus-pond
I see one face of grief.

PAI TA-SHUN

A ROMAN GARDEN

All night above that garden the rose-flushed moon
will sail,
Making the darkness deeper where hides the
nightingale.
Below the Sabine mountain
The tossed and slender fountain
Will curve, a lily pale;
And where the plumed pine soars tallest,
'Tis there, O nightingale, thou callest;
Where the loud water leaps the highest.
'Tis there, O nightingale, thou criest;
In the dripping luscious dark,
Hark, oh, hark!
Wonderful, delirious,
Soul of joy mysterious.

A garden full of fragrances,
Of pauses and of cadences,
Whence come they all?
Of cypresses and ilex-trees,
Plumes and dark candles like to these
Were long ago Persephone's.

All night within that garden
The glimmering gods of stone,
The satyrs and the naiads
Will laugh to be alone,
In starless courts of shadows
By silence overgrown,
Save for the nightingale's
Wild lyric thither blown.

By pools and dusky closes
Dim shapes will move about,
Twirled wands and masks and faces,
Dancers and wreaths of roses,
The moonlight's trick, no doubt.
A naked nymph upon the stair,
A sculptured vine that clasps the air,—
And then one Bacchic bird somewhere
Will pour his passion out.
All night above that garden the rose-flushed moon
will sail,
Making the darkness deeper where hides the
nightingale.

Down yonder velvet alley,
Floats Daphne like a feather,
A finger bidding silence,
The dark and she together.
Look, where the secret fount is misting.
Apollo, thou shalt have thy trysting:
For where a ruined sphinx lay smiling
The wood-girl waits thee, white, beguiling.
All night above that garden the rose-flushed moon
will sail,
Making the darkness deeper where hides the
nightingale.

FLORENCE WILKINSON EVANS

COMO IN APRIL

The wind is Winter, though the sun be
 Spring:
 The icy rills have scarce begun to
 flow;
The birds unconfidently fly and sing.

As on the land once fell the northern
 foe,
 The hostile mountains from the
 passes fling
Their vandal blasts upon the lake
 below.

Not yet the round clouds of the
 Maytime cling
 Above the world's blue wonder's
 curving show,
And tempt to linger with their
 lingering.

Yet doth each slope a vernal promise
 know:
 See, mounting yonder, white as
 angel's wing.
A snow of bloom to meet the bloom
 of snow.

Love, need we more than our
 imagining
 To make the whole year May?
 What though
The wind be Winter if the heart be
 Spring?

ROBERT UNDERWOOD JOHNSON

AN EXILE'S GARDEN

I live in the heart of a garden
With cypresses all about;
To the east and west, and the south
and north,
Straight shadowy paths run out.

There are ancient gods in my garden;
They have faces young and pale;
And a hundred thousand roses here
Enrapture the nightingale.

Yet, among the gods of the garden,
The roses and gods, I think,
Daylong, of a far-off clover field,
And the song of a bob-o-link.

SOPHIE JEWETT

THE CLOISTER GARDEN AT CERTOSA

It is a place monastic, set above
The city's pride and pleasuring
below;
The benediction of the sky breathes
love
Over the olive trees and vines a-
row.

The old gray walls are delicate to
prayer
And silence; in the corridors dim-
lit
Lurks many a painting, many a fresco
rare
Done by some brother for the joy
of it.

Pale lavender and red pomegranate
trees,
Roses and poppies spilling garden
sweets;
And tall lush grass and grain, and,
circling these,
The cool of cloistral walks and
shadowed seats.

By a sun-dial in the center, rests
One brown-robed Father; and his
lips recite
Some holy word; little he heeds the
jests
Of those who make the world their
chief delight.

While Florence, far below, from
dreamy towers
Throws back the sun and tolls the
tranquil hours.

RICHARD BURTON

A GARDEN IN VENICE

There is a garden in a vineyard set

Beneath the spell of Adriatic skies;
A lovely place of dreams and
 ecstasies,
Of color tangled in a verdant net,
The shimmer of the low lagoon
 whose fret
Washes the garden's length, and
 rose that vies
With rose, pomegranate and tall
 flowers that rise
Above their fellows in one glory met.
And there I think in the still summer
 night,
When all the world is sleeping save
 the moon
And the blest nightingale who
 shuns the noon,
The closed flowers open out of sheer
 delight
And the white lilies bow their
 slender stalks,
For thro' them, 'neath the vines
 Madonna walks.

DOROTHY FRANCES GURNEY

IN A GARDEN OF GRANADA

The city rumour rises all the day
Across the potted plants along the
 wall;
The sun and winds upon the slopes
 hold sway,
Tossing the dust and shadows in a
 squall.

The sun is old and weary—weary
here
Upon the ageing roofs and
miradors,
The broken terraces and basins drear
Where each old bell its ancient
echoes pours.

Ring—what memories to ring—to
those
That linger here—the lizard and
the cat,
That haunt these solitudes in state
morose
Through the long day their silent
habitat.

Untroubled,—save when in the
moonlight steals
Some voice in song across the
lower wall,
And sudden magic each old rafter
feels,
The while the echoes round it rise
and fall.

For as the wail of love or sorrow
rings
Along the night soft steps are on
the stair
And pathway; in the broken window
wings
Are stirring, and white arms are
lolling there.

And that old rose tree lifts its head
anew,

And there is perfume o'er the hills
afar,
From where Alhambra's crescent
cleaves the blue
To where agleam Genil and Darro
are.

O Voice!—what is thy necromantic
word
That all Granada waits adown the
years?
Is it the sound some love-swept night
has heard?—
The cry of love amid the cry of
tears?—

THOMAS WALSH

AMIEL'S GARDEN

His Garden! His bright candelabra
trees
En fête. His lilacs steeped in joy! His
sky
Limpid and blue! The same flecked
shadows lie
Athwart this path he paced. His
reveries
Float in the air. His moods, his
ecstasies
Still linger charmed. Pale butterflies
flit by—
Were one his soul it had not found on
high
Banquet more choice than those
infinities

He daily knew. And now no one to
 hear
The hovering hours, the singing
 grass, to feel
The wrinkles of the soul smooth out,
 to see
God's shadow bend down from
 eternity—
His garden empty! Yet I gently steal
Lest I disturb his dreams still smiling
 near.

GERTRUDE HUNTINGTON MCGIFFERT

EDEN-HUNGER

O that a nest, my mate! were once
 more ours,
 Where we, by vain and barren
 change untutored,
Could have grave friendships with
 wise trees and flowers,
 And live the great, green life of
 field and orchard!

From the cold birthday of the
 daffodils,
 E'en to that listening pause that is
 November,
O to confide in woods, confer with
 hills,
 And then—then, to that palmland
 you remember,

Fly swift, where seas that brook not
 Winter's rule

Are one vast violet breaking into
lilies;
There where we spent our first
strange wedded Yule,
In the far, golden, fire-hearted
Antilles.

WILLIAM WATSON

THE GARDEN AT BEMERTON

FOR A FLYLEAF OF HERBERT'S POEMS

Year after year, from dusk to dusk,
How sweet this English garden
grows,
Steeped in two centuries' sun and
musk,
Walled from the world in gray repose,
Harbor of honey-freighted bees,
And wealthy with the rose.

Here pinks with spices in their throats
Nod by the bitter marigold;
Here nightingales with haunting
notes,
When west and east with stars are
bold,
From out the twisted hawthorn-trees,
Sing back the weathers old.

All tuneful winds do down it pass;
The leaves a sudden whiteness show,
And delicate noises fill the grass;
The only flakes its spaces know
Are petals blown off briers long,

And heaped on blades below.

Ah! dawn and dusk, year after year,
'Tis more than these that keeps it rare!
We see the saintly Master here,
Pacing along the alleys fair,
And catch the throbbing of a song
Across the amber air!

LIZETTE WOODWORTH REESE

IN AN OXFORD GARDEN

As one whose road winds upward
 turns his face
Unto the valleys where he late hath
 stood,
Leaning upon his staff in peace to
 brood
On many a beauty of the distant
 place,
So I in this cool garden pause a space,
Reviewing many things in many a
 mood,
Accumulating friends in solitude
From the assembly of my thoughts
 and days.

ARTHUR UPSON

THE HOMELY GARDEN

"GRANDMOTHER'S GATHERING BONESET"

*Grandmother's gathering boneset to-
day;
In the garret she'll dry and hang it
away.
Next winter I'll "need" some boneset
tea—
I wish she wouldn't think always of
me!*

EDITH M. THOMAS

A BREATH OF MINT

What small leaf-fingers veined with
emerald light
Lay on my heart that touch of elfin
might?

What spirals of sharp perfume do
they fling,
To blur my page with swift
remembering?

Borne in a country basket
marketward,
Their message is a music spirit-heard,

A pebble-hindered lilt and gurgle and
run
Of tawny singing water in the sun.

Their coolness brings that ecstasy I
knew
Down by the mint-fringed brook that
wandered through

My mellow meadows set with linden-
trees
Loud with the summer jargon of the
bees.

Their magic has its way with me until
I see the storm's dark wing shadow
the hill

As once I saw: and draw sharp breath
again,
To feel their arrowy fragrance pierce
the rain.

O sudden urging sweetness in the air,
Exhaled, diffused about me
everywhere,

Yours is the subtlest word the
summer saith,
And vanished summers sigh upon
your breath.

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING

A SELLER OF HERBS

Black, comely, of abiding cheer,

Three times a week she fares,
Townward from gabled Windermere,
To sell her dainty wares.

Green balms she brings from winding
lanes,
And some in handfuls tall,
Of the old days of Annes and Janes,
Grown by a kitchen wall.

Keen mint has she in dewy sprigs,
With spears of violet;
And the spiced bloom of elder-twigs
In a field's hollow set.

My snatch of May I get from her,
In white buds off a tree;
June in one whiff of lavender,
That breaks my heart for me.

The swaying boughs of Windermere,
Each gust that takes the grass,
High over the town roar I hear,
When that old stall I pass.

What homely memories are mine,
At sight of her quaint stalks;
Of grave dusks mellowing like wine
Down long, box-bordered walks;

Of garret windows eastward thrust,
Of rafters shining dim,
And heaped with herbs as gray as
dust
All scented to the brim.

This lady of the market-place,
Three times a week and more,

I pray her seasons thick with grace;
And ever at her door,

Shut from the road by wall of stone,
And ample cherry trees,
A garden fair as Herrick's own,
And just as full of bees!

LIZETTE WOODWORTH REESE

LAVENDER

Gray walls that lichen stains,
That take the sun and the rains,
 Old, stately, and wise:
Clipt yews, old lawns flag-bordered,
In ancient ways yet ordered;
 South walks where the loud bee
 plies
 Daylong till Summer flies—
Here grows Lavender, here breathes
 England.

Gay cottage gardens, glad,
Comely, unkempt, and mad,
 Jumbled, jolly, and quaint;
Nooks where some old man dozes;
Currants and beans and roses
 Mingling without restraint;
 A wicket that long lacks paint—
Here grows Lavender, here breathes
 England.

Sprawling for elbow-room,
Spearing straight spikes of bloom,
 Clean, wayward, and tough;

Sweet and tall and slender,
True, enduring, and tender,
 Buoyant and bold and bluff,
 Simplest, sanest of stuff—
Thus grows Lavender, thence
 breathes England.

W. W. BLAIR FISH

DAWN IN MY GARDEN

I went into my garden at break of Delight,
 Before Joy had risen in the Eastern sky,
To see how many cucumbers had happened over
 night,
 And how much higher stood the corn that
 yesterday was high.

I went into my garden when Rest had fallen away
 From the tops of blue hills, from the valleys gold
 and green,
To see how far the beans had travelled up into the
 day,
 And whether all my lettuces were glad and cool
 and clean.

I went into my garden when Mirth was laughing low
 Through the sharp-scented leaves of the lush
 tomato vines,
Through the long blue-grey leaves of the turnips in a
 row,
 Where early in the every day the dew shakes and
 shines.

Oh, Rest had slipped away from the valleys green
 and gold,

From the tops of blue hills that were silent all the
night,
But the big, round Joy was rising, busy and bold,
When I went into my garden at break of Delight!
MARGUERITE WILKINSON

THE PROUD VEGETABLES

In a funny little garden not much bigger than a mat,
There lived a thriving family, its members all were
fat;
But some were short, and some were tall, and some
were almost round,
And some ran high on bamboo poles, and some lay
on the ground.

Of these old Father Pumpkin was, perhaps, the
proudest one.
He claimed to trace his family vine directly from the
sun.
"We both are round and yellow, we both are bright,"
said he,
"A stronger family likeness one could scarcely wish
to see."

Old Mrs. Squash hung on the fence; she had a
crooked neck,
Perhaps 'twas hanging made it so,—her nerves were
quite a wreck.
Near by, upon a planted row of faggots, dry and lean,
The young cucumbers climbed to swing their Indian
clubs of green.

A big white *daikon* hid in earth beneath his leafy
crest;

And mole-like sweet potatoes crept around his quiet
nest.

Above were growing pearly pease, and beans of
many kinds
With pods like tiny castanets to mock the summer
winds.

There, in a spot that feels the sun, the swarthy egg-
plant weaves
Great webs of frosted tapestry and hangs them out
for leaves.
Its funny azure blossoms give a merry, shrivelled
wink,
And lifting up the leaves display great drops of
purple ink.

Now, life went on in harmony and pleasing
indolence
Till Mrs. Squash had vertigo and tumbled off the
fence;
But not to earth she fell! Alas,—but down, with all
her force,
Upon old Father Pumpkin's head, and cracked his
skull, of course.

At this a fearful din arose. The pods began to split,
Cucumbers turned a sickly hue, the *daikon* had a fit,
The sweet potatoes rent the ground,—the egg-plant
dropped his loom,
While every polished berry seemed to gain an added
gloom.

And, worst of all, there came a man, who once had
planted them.
He dug that little family up by root and leaf and
stem,
He piled them high in baskets, in a most unfeeling
way—

All this was told me by the cook,—we ate the last to-day.

MARY McNEIL FENOLLOSA

THE CHOICE

When skies are blue and days are
 bright
A kitchen-garden's my delight,
Set round with rows of decent box
And blowsy girls of hollyhocks.

Before the lark his Lauds hath done
And ere the corncrake's southward
 gone;
Before the thrush good-night hath
 said
And the young Summer's put to bed.

The currant-bushes' spicy smell,
Homely and honest, likes me well,
The while on strawberries I feast,
And raspberries the sun hath kissed.

Beans all a-blowing by a row
Of hives that great with honey go,
With mignonette and heaths to yield
The plundering bee his honey-field.

Sweet herbs in plenty, blue borage
And the delicious mint and sage,
Rosemary, marjoram, and rue,
And thyme to scent the winter
 through.

Here are small apples growing round,

And apricots all golden-gowned,
And plums that presently will flush
And show their bush a Burning Bush.

Cherries in nets against the wall,
Where Master Thrush his madrigal
Sings, and makes oath a churl is he
Who grudges cherries for a fee.

Lavender, sweet-briar, orris. Here
Shall Beauty make her pomander,
Her sweet-balls for to lay in clothes
That wrap her as the leaves the rose.

Take roses red and lilies white,
A kitchen-garden's my delight;
Its gillyflowers and phlox and cloves,
And its tall cote of irised doves.

KATHARINE TYNAN

THOUGHTS FER THE DISCOURAGED FARMER

The summer winds is sniffin' round the bloomin'
locus' trees;
And the clover in the pastur' is a big day fer the bees,
And they been a-swiggin' honey, above board and on
the sly,
Tel they stutter in theyr buzzin' and stagger as they
fly.
The flicker on the fence-rail 'pears to jest spit on his
wings
And roll up his feathers, by the sassy way he sings;
And the hoss-fly is a-whettin'-up his forelegs fer biz,
And the off-mare is a-switchin' all of her tail they is.

You can hear the blackbirds jawin' as they foller up
the plow—
Oh, theyr bound to git theyr brekfast, and theyr not a
carin' how;
So they quarrel in the furries, and they quarrel on the
wing—
But theyr peaceabler in pot-pies than any other thing:
And it's when I git my shotgun drawed up in stiddy
rest,
She's as full of tribbellation as a yellor-jacket's nest;
And a few shots before dinner, when the sun's a-
shinin' right,
Seems to kindo'-sorto' sharpen up a feller's appetite!

They's been a heap o' rain, but the sun's out to-day,
And the clouds of the wet spell is all cleared away,
And the woods is all the greener, and the grass is
greener still;
It may rain again to-morry, but I don't think it will.
Some says the crops is ruined, and the corn's
drownded out,
And propa-sy the wheat will be a failure, without
doubt;
But the kind Providence that has never failed us yet,
Will be on hand onc't more at the 'leventh hour, I bet!

Does the medder-lark complain, as he swims high
and dry
Through the waves of the wind and the blue of the
sky?
Does the quail set up and whissel in a disappointed
way,
Er hang his head in silence, and sorrow all the day?
Is the chipmuck's health a-failin'?—Does he walk, er
does he run?
Don't the buzzards ooze around up thare jest like
they've allus done?

Is they anything the matter with the rooster's lungs er
voice?

Ort a mortul be complainin' when dumb animals
rejoice?

Then let us, one and all, be contented with our lot;
The June is here this morning, and the sun is shining
hot.

Oh! let us fill our harts up with the glory of the day,
And banish ev'ry doubt and care and sorrow fur
away!

Whatever be our station, with Providence fer guide,
Sich fine circumstances ort to make us satisfied;
Fer the world is full of roses, and the roses full of
dew,

And the dew is full of heavenly love that drips fer
me and you.

JAMES WHITCOMB RILEY

GRACE FOR GARDENS

Lord God in Paradise,
Look upon our sowing,
Bless the little gardens
And the good green growing!
Give us sun,
Give us rain,
Bless the orchards
And the grain!

Lord God in Paradise,
Please bless the beans and peas,
Give us corn full on the ear—
We will praise Thee, Lord, for
these!

Bless the blossom
And the root,
Bless the seed
And the fruit!

Lord God in Paradise,
Over my brown field is seen,
Trembling and adventuring.
A miracle of green.
Send such grace
As you know,
To keep it safe
And make it grow!

Lord God in Paradise,
For the wonder of the seed,
Wondering, we praise you, while
We tell you of our need.
Look down from Paradise,
Look upon our sowing,
Bless the little gardens
And the good green growing!
Give us sun,
Give us rain,
Bless the orchards
And the grain!

LOUISE DRISCOLL

SILVER BELLS AND COCKLE SHELLS

PLANTING

*The sky is blue and soft to-day,
The grass is green this month of May,
And Muvver with her spade and rake
My little garden helps me make;
For every one must plant more seeds
To grow the food that each one needs:
Potatoes, corn, green peas, and beets,
The kind of beans that sister eats,
We plant in rows marked by a string,
For neatness is the one great thing;
The earth is then raked smooth and
 pressed
And Nature 'tends to all the rest.*

ROBERT LIVINGSTON

SPRING PATCHWORK

If I could patch a coverlet
 From pieces of the Spring,
What dreams a happy child would
 have
 Beneath so fair a thing!

A center of the dear blue sky,
 A bordering of green,

With patches of the yellow sun
All chequered in between.

Bright ribbons of the silky grass
Laced prettily across,
With satin of new little leaves,
And velvet of the moss.

In every corner, violets,
Half-hidden from the view,
With many-flowered squares betwixt,
Of pinky tints and blue;

Of flossy silk and gossamer,
Of tissue and brocade;
A warp of rosy morning mist,
A woof of purple shade.

Embroideries of little vines,
And spider-webs of lace,
With tassels of the alder tied
At each convenient place.

With gold-thread I would sew the
seams,
And needles of the pine,
Oh, never child in all the world
Would have a quilt like mine!

ABBIE FARWELL BROWN

BBY'S VALENTINE

Valentine, O Valentine,
Pretty little Love of mine;
Little Love whose yellow hair
Makes the daffodils despair;

Little Love whose shining eyes
Fill the stars with sad surprise:
Hither turn your ten wee toes,
Each a tiny shut-up rose,
End most fitting and complete
For the rosy-pinky feet;
Toddle, toddle here to me,
For I'm waiting, do you see?—
Waiting for to call you mine,
Valentine, O Valentine!

Valentine, O Valentine,
I will dress you up so fine!
Here's a frock of tulip-leaves,
Trimmed with lace the spider weaves;
Here's a cap of larkspur blue,
Just precisely made for you;
Here's a mantle scarlet-dyed,
Once the tiger-lily's pride,
Spotted all with velvet black
Like the fire-beetle's back;
Lady-slippers on your feet,
Now behold you all complete!
Come and let me call you mine,
Valentine, O Valentine!

Valentine, O Valentine,
Now a wreath for you I'll twine.
I will set you on a throne
Where the damask rose has blown,
Dropping all her velvet bloom,
Carpeting your leafy room:
Here while you shall sit in pride,
Butterflies all rainbow-pied,
Dandy beetles gold and green,
Creeping, flying, shall be seen,
Every bird that shakes his wings,

Every katydid that sings,
Wasp and bee with buzz and hum.
Hither, hither see them come,
Creeping all before your feet,
Rendering their homage meet.
But 'tis I that call you mine,
Valentine, O Valentine!

LAURA E. RICHARDS

BABY SEED SONG

Little brown brother, oh! little brown
brother,
Are you awake in the dark?
Here we lie cosily, close to each
other:
Hark to the song of the lark—
"Waken!" the lark says, "waken and
dress you;
Put on your green coats and gay,
Blue sky will shine on you, sunshine
caress you—
Waken! 'tis morning—'tis May!"

Little brown brother, oh! little brown
brother,
What kind of flower will you be?
I'll be a poppy—all white, like my
mother;
Do be a poppy like me.
What! you're a sun-flower? How I
shall miss you
When you're grown golden and
high!

But I shall send all the bees up to kiss
 you;
Little brown brother, good-bye.

E. NESBIT

RAIN IN THE NIGHT

Raining, raining,
 All night long;
Sometimes loud, sometimes soft,
 Just like a song.

There'll be rivers in the gutters
 And lakes along the street.
It will make our lazy kitty
 Wash his little dirty feet.

The roses will wear diamonds
 Like kings and queens at court;
But the pansies all get muddy
 Because they are so short.

I'll sail my boat to-morrow
 In wonderful new places,
But first I'll take my watering-pot
 And wash the pansies' faces.

AMELIA JOSEPHINE BURR

A LITTLE GIRL'S SONGS

I
SPRING SONG

I love daffodils.
I love Narcissus when he bends his
 head.
I can hardly keep March and spring
 and Sunday and daffodils
Out of my rhyme of song.
Do you know anything about the
 spring
When it comes again?
God knows about it while winter is
 lasting:
Flowers bring him power in the
 spring,
And birds bring it, and children.
He is sometimes sad and alone
Up there in the sky trying to keep his
 worlds happy.
I bring him songs when he is in his
 sadness, and weary.
I tell him how I used to wander out to
 study stars and the moon he
 made
And flowers in the dark of the wood.
I keep reminding him about his
 flowers he has forgotten,
And that snowdrops are up.
What can I say to make him listen?
"God," I say,
"Don't you care!
Nobody must be sad or sorry
In the spring-time of flowers."

II

VELVETS

By a Bed of Pansies

This pansy has a thinking face

Like the yellow moon.
This one has a face with white blots:
I call him the clown.
Here goes one down the grass
With a pretty look of plumpness:
She is a little girl going to school
With her hands in the pockets of her
 pinafore.
Her name is Sue.
I like this one, in a bonnet,
Waiting—
Her eyes are so deep!
But these on the other side,
These that wear purple and blue,
They are the Velvets,
The king with his cloak,
The queen with her gown,
The prince with his feather.
These are dark and quiet
And stay alone.

*I know you, Velvets
Color of Dark,
Like the pine-tree on the hill
When stars shine!*

HILDA CONKLING
(Six years old)

WHEN SWALLOWS BUILD

When apple-blossom time doth come
And with their scent the air is
 filled,
And fields are full of buttercups,—
'Tis then the swallows build.

And when the rippling brooks are
 deep,
 Filled to the overflowing,
When o'er the hills and meadows fair
 The south wind's softly blowing,

With sun a-shining, birds a-singing
 Till their joyous throats are thrilled,
And with all the world in laughter,—
 'Tis then the swallows build.

CATHERINE PARMENTER
(Eleven years old)

SPRING PLANTING

"What shall we plant for our Summer,
 my boy,—
 Seeds of enchantment and
 seedlings of joy?
Brave little cuttings of laughter and
 light?
Then shall our summer be flowery
 and bright."

"Nay!—You are wrong in your
 planting," said he,
 "Have we not grass and the weeds
 and a tree?
Why should we water and weary
 away
 For sake of a flower that lives but a
 day!"

So she made gardens which he would
 not dig,

Tended her apricot, apple and fig.
Then, when one morning he chanced
to appear,
Sadly he noticed—"No trespassing
here."

HELEN HAY WHITNEY

IF I COULD DIG LIKE A RABBIT

If I could dig holes in the ground like a rabbit,
D'you know what I'd do?
Well, I'd dig a deep hole—
Right under that tree—
Then I'd go down—and down,
And find out where the tree starts,
And I'd find out how it eats and drinks,
And what makes it grow....
Yes I would!
P'r'aps I could dig a hole right up into that tree,
And—see—it—grow!...
But p'r'aps I couldn't.

Anyway I could dig 'way down,
And see all the flower seeds,
And all the grass seeds,
And under that big rock there might be some rock
seeds.
And I'd see everything start growing.

Do all the seeds make noises
When they start to grow?
What do You s'pose about that?
I s'pose they sing,
'Cause they're so glad to come up here and see the
sunshine....

Well, anyway I'd find out all about it, 'way down
there,
And then I'd want to come up home,
And I'd have so much to tell to You!

If I could dig holes like a rabbit,
That's just what I would do.

ROSE STRONG HUBBELL

THE LITTLE GOD

Mother says there's a little god
Lives in my garden.
I asked her—"In the tree?"—
I asked her—"In the fountain?"
And she said, yes, that she,
Plain as plain could be,
Everywhere could see
The little god.
"What's he look like, mother?"
"Oh," she said, "like the flowers,
Like the summer showers,
Like the morning dew,—
Like you."
She says he's everywhere
In my garden—I can't see him there.

KATHARINE HOWARD

DAISIES

At evening when I go to bed
I see the stars shine overhead;

They are the little daisies white
That dot the meadow of the Night.

And often while I'm dreaming so,
Across the sky the Moon will go;
It is a lady, sweet and fair,
Who comes to gather daisies there.

For, when at morning I arise,
There's not a star left in the skies;
She's picked them all and dropped
 them down
Into the meadows of the town.

FRANK DEMPSTER SHERMAN

THE ANXIOUS FARMER

It was awful long ago
 That I put those seeds around;
And I guess I ought to know
 When I stuck 'em in the ground.
'Cause I noted down the day
 In a little diary book,—
It's gotten losted somewhere and
 I don't know where to look.

But I'm certain anyhow
 They've been planted most a week
And it must be time by now
 For their little sprouts to peek.
They've been watered every day
 With a very speshul care,
And once or twice I've dug 'em up to
 see if they were there.

I fixed the dirt in humps

Just the way they said I should;
And I crumbled all the lumps
Just as finely as I could.
And I found a nangle-worm
A-poking up his head,—
He maybe feeds on seeds and such,
and so I squushed him dead.

A seed's so very small,
And dirt all looks the same;—
How can they know at all
The way they ought to aim?
And so I'm waiting round
In case of any need;
A farmer ought to do his best for
every single seed!

BURGES JOHNSON

OVER THE GARDEN WALL

By the side of a wall in a garden gay,
A little Rose-bush grew;
In the first dear days of the month of
May,
Loved by the sun and dew.

It gazed to the top of the wall so high
With happy longing and pride,
When it heard the children laugh and
cry
As they passed on the other side.

And into its leaves and buds there
came
A beautiful thought of God.

"I can climb to the heights of love
and fame,
If my roots are in the sod."

Then up and over the garden-wall,
It clambered far and wide,
Shedding its sweetness for one and
all
As they passed on the other side,—

The weary laborer, the beggar cold,
The wise man and the fool,
The mother and daughter, the
grandam old
And the children going to school.

The breezes scattered its pink and
white
In a perfumed shower for all,
And the beautiful days of June were
bright
With the Rose on the Garden-wall.

Our hearts are like the Roses of June,
They can live for one and all,
Giving their love as a blessed boon,
From a palace or cottage wall.

EMILY SELINGER

THE FLOWERPHONE

See the morning-glories hung
On the vine for me to use:
Hark! A flower-bell has rung,
I can talk now, if I choose.

"Hellow Central! Oh, hello!
Give me Puck of Fairyland—
Mr. Puck, I want to know
What I cannot understand.

"How the leaves are scalloped out;
Where's the den of Dragon Fly?
What do crickets chirp about?
Where do flowers go when they
die?

"How far can a Fairy see?
Why are woodsy things afraid?
Who lives in the hollow tree?
How are cobweb carpets made?

"Why do Fairies hide?—Hello!
What? I cannot understand—"
That's the way they always do,
They've cut me off from Fairyland!

ABBIE FARWELL BROWN

THE FAITHLESS FLOWERS

I went this morning down to where the Johnny-
Jump-Ups grow
Like naughty purple faces nodding in a row.
I stayed 'most all the morning there—I sat down on a
stump
And watched and watched and watched them—and
they never gave a jump!

And Golden-Glow that stands up tall and yellow by
the fence,
It doesn't glow a single bit—it's only just pretence—

I ran down after tea last night to watch them in the
dark—
I had to light a match to see; they didn't give a spark!

And then the Bouncing Bets don't bounce—I tried
them yesterday,
I picked a big pink bunch down in the meadow
where they stay,
I took a piece of string I had and tied them in a ball,
And threw them down as hard as hard—they never
bounced at all!

And tiger-lilies may look fierce, to meet them all
alone,
All tall and black and yellowy and nodding by a
stone,
But they're no more like tigers than the dogwood's
like a dog,
Or bulrushes are like a bull or toadwort like a frog!

I like the flowers very much—they're pleasant as can
be
For bunches on the table, and to pick and wear and
see,
But still it doesn't seem quite fair—it does seem very
queer—
They don't do what they're named for—not at any
time of year!

MARGARET WIDDEMER

THE FLOWER-SCHOOL

When storm clouds rumble in the sky and June showers come down,
The moist east wind comes marching over the heath to blow its bagpipes
among the bamboos.

Then crowds of flowers come out of a sudden, from nobody knows where,
and dance upon the grass in wild glee.

Mother, I really think the flowers go to school underground.

They do their lessons with doors shut, and if they want to come out to play
before it is time, their master makes them stand in a corner.

When the rains come down they have their holidays.

Branches clash together in the forest, and the leaves rustle in the wild wind,
the thunder-clouds clap their giant hands and the flower children rush out in
dresses of pink and yellow and white.

Do you know, mother, their home is in the sky, where the stars are.

Haven't you seen how eager they are to get there? Don't you know why they
are in such a hurry?

Of course, I can guess to whom they raise their arms: they have their
mother as I have my own.

RABINDRANATH TAGORE

IRIS FLOWERS

My mother let me go with her,
 (I had been good all day),
To see the iris flowers that bloom
 In gardens far away.

We walked and walked through
 hedges green,
Through rice-fields empty still,
To where we saw a garden gate
 Beneath the farthest hill.

She pointed out the rows of
 "flowers";—
I saw no planted things,
But white and purple butterflies
 Tied down with silken strings.

They strained and fluttered in the
 breeze,
 So eager to be free;
I begged the man to let them go,
 But mother laughed at me.

She said that they could never rise,
 Like birds, to heaven so blue.
But even mothers do not know
 Some things that children do.

That night, the flowers untied
 themselves
 And softly stole away,
To fly in sunshine round my dreams
 Until the break of day.

MARY MCNEIL FENOLLOSA

IF I WERE A FAIRY

I'd love to sit on a clover-top
 And sway,
And swing and shake, till the dew
 would drop
 In spray;
To croon a song for the bumble-bee
To leave his golden honey with me,
And sway and swing, till the wind
 would stop

To play.

I'd weave a hammock of spider-
thread
Loose-hung,
Where grasses nodded above my
head
And swung.
And all day long, while the
hammock swayed
I'd twine and tangle the sun and
shade,
Till the crickets' song, "It is time for
bed!"
Was sung.

Then wrapped in a wee gold sunset
cloud
I'd lie,
While night winds sang to the stars
that crowd
The sky.
And all night long, I would swing
and sleep
While fireflies lighted their lamps
to peep—
"Oh, hush!" they'd whisper, if frogs
sang loud—
"Oh hush-a-by!"

CHARLES BUXTON GOING

FRINGED GENTIAN

Near where I live there is a lake
As blue as blue can be, winds make

It dance as they go blowing by.
I think it curtseys to the sky.

It's just a lake of lovely flowers,
And my Mamma says they are ours;
But they are not like those we grow
To be our very own, you know.

We have a splendid garden, there
Are lots of flowers everywhere;
Roses, and pinks, and four o'clocks,
And hollyhocks, and evening stocks.

Mamma lets us pick them, but never
Must we pick any gentians—ever!
For if we carried them away
They'd die of homesickness that day.

AMY LOWELL

THE SCISSORS-MAN

As I was busy with my tools
That make my garden neat,
I heard a little crooked tune
Come drifting up the street.

It didn't seem to have an end
Like others that are plain;
You always felt it going on
Till it began again.

It came quite near: I heard it call,
And dropped my tools and ran
To peer out through the gate;
I thought it might be Pan.

But it was just the scissors-man
Who walked along and played
Upon a little instrument
He told me he had made.

Now, if you hope to see a god
As hard to find as Pan,
It's sad when it turns out to be
A plain old scissors-man.

But when my mother came to hear
The crooked tune he made,
She said his instrument was like
Some pipes that Pan had played.

And I must ask the scissors-man
If he had ever known
Or met a queer old god who played
On pipes much like his own.

He would not tell: and when I asked
Who taught him how to play,
He made that crooked tune again,
And laughed and went away.

GRACE HAZARD CONKLING

THE GARDEN OF LIFE

GOD'S GARDEN

*The years are flowers and bloom
within
Eternity's wide garden;
The rose for joy, the thorn for sin,
The gardener God, to pardon
All wilding growths, to prune,
reclaim,
And make them rose-like in His name.*

RICHARD BURTON

"THE LORD GOD PLANTED A GARDEN"

The Lord God planted a garden
In the first white days of the world,
And He set there an angel warden
In a garment of light enfurled.

So near to the peace of Heaven,
That the hawk might nest with the
wren,
For there in the cool of the even
God walked with the first of men.

And I dream that these garden-closes
With their shade and their sun-
flecked sod

And their lilies and bowers of roses,
Were laid by the hand of God.

The kiss of the sun for pardon,
The song of the birds for mirth,—
One is nearer God's heart in a garden
Than anywhere else on earth.

DOROTHY FRANCES GURNEY

THE LILIES

Ever the garden has a spiritual word:
In the slow lapses of unnoticed
time
It drops from heaven, or upward
learns to climb,
Breathing an earthly sweetness, as a
bird
Is in the porches of the morning
heard;
So, in the garden, flower to flower
will chime,
And with the music thought and
feeling rhyme,
And the hushed soul is with new
glory stirred.

Beauty is silent,—through the
summer day
Sleeps in her gold,—O wondrous
sunlit gold,
Frosting the lilies, virginal array!
Green, full-leaved walls the
fragrant sculpture hold,

Warm, orient blooms!—how
 motionless are they—
Speechless—the eternal loveliness
 untold!

GEORGE E. WOODBERRY

BARTER

Life has loveliness to sell,
All beautiful and splendid things,
Blue waves whitened on a cliff,
Soaring fire that sways and sings,
And children's faces looking up
Holding wonder like a cup.

Life has loveliness to sell,
Music like a curve of gold,
Scent of pine trees in the rain,
Eyes that love you, arms that hold,
And for your spirit's still delight,
Holy thoughts that star the night.

Spend all you have for loveliness,
Buy it and never count the cost;
For one white singing hour of peace
Count many a year of strife well lost,
And for a breath of ecstasy
Give all you have been, or could be.

SARA TEASDALE

SONNET

Drop me the seed, that I, even in my
 brain,
May be its nourishing earth. No
 mortal knows
From what immortal granary comes
 the grain,
Nor how the earth conspires to make
 the rose;

But from the dust and from the
 wetted mud
Comes help, given or taken; so with
 me
Deep in my brain the essence of my
 blood
Shall give it stature until Beauty be.

It will look down, even as the burning
 flower
Smiles upon June, long after I am
 gone.
Dust-footed Time will never tell its
 hour,
Through dusty Time its rose will
 draw men on,

Through dusty Time its beauty shall
 make plain
Man, and, Without, a spirit scattering
 grain.

JOHN MASEFIELD

THE TILLING

The dull ox, Sorrow, treads my heart,

Dragging the harrow, Pain,
And turning the old year's tillage
Under the sod again.
So, well do I know the Tiller
Will bring once more the grain;
For grief comes never to the strong—
Nor dull despair's benumbing wrong

—
But from them spring a hidden throng
Of seeds, for new life fain.

So heavily do I let the hoofs
Trample the deeps of me;
For only thus is spirit
Brought to fecundity.
But when the ox is stabled
And the harrow set aside,
With calm I watch a new world grow,
Sweetly green, up out of woe,
And, glad of the Tiller, then I know
He too is satisfied.

CALE YOUNG RICE

SAFE

Now shall your beauty never fade;
For it was budding when you
passed
Beyond this glare, into the shade
Of fairer gardens unforecast,
Where, by the dreaded Gardener's
spade,
Beauty, transplanted once, shall
ever last.

Now never shall that glorious breast
 Wither, those deft hands lose their
 art,
Nor those glad shoulders be
 oppressed
 By failing breath or fluttering
 heart,
Nor, from the cheek by dawn
 possessed,
 The subtle ecstasy of hue depart.

Forever shall you be your best,—
 Nay, far more luminously shine
Than when our comradeship was
 blessed
 By what on earth seemed most
 divine,
Before your body passed to rest
 With what I then supposed this
 heart of mine.

Now shall your bud of beauty blow
 Far lovelier than I knew before
When, such a little time ago,
 I looked upon your face, and swore
That Helen's never moved men so
 When her white, magic hands
 enkindled war.

As you sweep on from power to
 power
 Shall every earthward thought you
 think
Irradiate my lonely hour
 Till I shall taste the golden drink
Of Life, and see the full-blown
 flower,

Whose opening bud was mine,
beyond the brink.

ROBERT HAVEN SCHAUFFLER

SORROW IN A GARDEN

Here in this ancient garden
When Winter days had flown
I came, with Comrade Sorrow
To dwell with her alone.

Here in this sweet seclusion
Far from the World's cold stare
What exquisite communings
Sorrow and I would share!

What banquets of remembrance!
What luxury of tears!
With Sorrow in a garden
Through the rose-scented years!

But one day when she called me
I did not hear her voice;
I only heard the lilies
Which sang "Rejoice, rejoice!"

The world was gold and azure
The air was sweet with birds;
My garden laughed with rapture
How could I hear her words?

For June was in the garden
And June was in my heart,
And since that hour pale Sorrow
And I have dwelt apart.

But often in the twilight
When birds and gardens sleep
I feel her presence with me
Her arms about me creep.

And when the ghosts of Summer
With the dead roses talk,
I hear her softly sobbing
Along the moonlit walk.

I never can forget her
So intimate were we!
But Sorrow, in my garden
Abides no more with me.

MAY RILEY SMITH

MOTH-FLOWERS

The pale moth
Trembles in the white moonlight;
Thus my heart trembles with love!

The rose petals fall—
The red petals of my heart;
Oh, the breath of love!

Cool, sweet tears
Of honey, the jasmine weeps;
Burning fall the tears of love.

Oh, how bitter
Is the White Poppy, Death;
There are no more dreams of love.

JEANNE ROBERT FOSTER

ALCHEMY

I lift my heart as spring lifts up
A yellow daisy to the rain;
My heart will be a lovely cup
Altho' it holds but pain.

For I shall learn from flower and leaf
That color every drop they hold,
To change the lifeless wine of grief
To living gold.

SARA TEASDALE

FLOWERS IN THE DARK

Late in the evening, when the room
had grown
Too hot and tiresome with its flaring
light
And noisy voices, I stole out alone
Into the darkness of the summer
night.

Down the long garden-walk I slowly
went,
A little wind was stirring in the trees;
I only saw the whitest of the flowers,
And I was sorry that the earlier hours
Of that fair evening had been so ill
spent,
Because I said, "I am content with
these
Dear friends of mine who only speak
to me

With their delicious fragrance, and
 who tell
To me their gracious welcome
 silently."

The leaves that touch my hand with
 dew are wet;
I find the tall white lilies I love well.
I linger as I pass the mignonette,
And what surprise could clearer be
 than this:
To find my sweet rose waiting with a
 kiss!

SARAH ORNE JEWETT

WELCOME

There is a hillside garden that their tender hands
 have tended,
Below a house that holds for me a shrine of joy and
 light.
And there beneath a cloudless sun when June is
 warm and splendid
I see them coming home to me, three girls in
 garments white.

Alice with lilies in her hands, and little dark Dolores
Showing her glowing marigolds; and Iris last of all
Under the arbor by the wall of purple morning-
 glories,
Bringing my crimson ramblers back that sought to
 scale the wall.

Alice with smiles along her lips; Dolores still and
 tender;

Iris whose eyes can tell me more than tongue shall
 ever say;
They offer to my open arms their bodies soft and
 slender,
Bringing the best of summer here, they garlanded to-
 day.

Into my study they have swept, and brasses from
 Benares,
Vases from Venice they have filled, and hung their
 wreaths around
The portrait where their mother smiles like the tall
 tranquil Maries
That Perugino used to paint, with hair like sunlight
 crowned.

"Mother is coming home to-day." (The words
 themselves are singing.)
"How long it is," our litany, forgotten, they repeat,
Making their last response to love, their last oblation
 bringing
Till at the hour of evensong, their voices still more
 sweet,
Tremble and sanctify the house where happy hearts
 shall meet.

JOHN CURTIS UNDERWOOD

THE CHILD IN THE GARDEN

When to the garden of untroubled
 thought
I came of late, and saw the open
 door,
And wished again to enter, and
 explore

The sweet, wild ways with stainless
bloom inwrought
And bowers of innocence with beauty
fraught,
It seemed some purer voice must
speak before
I dared to tread that garden loved
of yore,
That Eden lost unknown and found
unsought.

Then just within the gate I saw a
child,—
A stranger-child, yet to my heart
most dear;
He held his hands to me, and softly
smiled
With eyes that knew no shade of
sin or fear:
"Come in," he said, "and play awhile
with me;
I am the little child you used to be."

HENRY VAN DYKE

A WONDER GARDEN

"And a little child shall lead them"
Into her world, beneath her smiling
skies;
A little child with wide, wondering
eyes
Deep with the mystery that in them
lies.
Her soft hand plucks a stem asunder,
And with the dream that is a part

Of Childhood's heart,
She questions:
"Now I want to wonder!"

She "wants to wonder" how so fair a
thing
Is born; from what it springs, and
why it blooms:
Whence comes its sweet, elusive odor
rare,—
The garnered fragrance of a
hundred Junes.
Was it all planned,—or just some
lovely blunder?
Thus gazing, with the seeking look
that lies
In Childhood's eyes,
She questions:
"Now I want to wonder!"

Dear Child, your groping mind seeks
far and true:
Mankind and Nature,—all "want to
wonder" too.

FREDERIC A. WHITING

FROM A CAR-WINDOW

Pines, and a blur of lithe young
grasses;
Gold in a pool, from the western
glow;
Spread of wings where the last thrush
passes—

And thoughts of you as the sun
dips low.

Quiet lane, and an irised meadow ...
(*How many summers have died
since then?*) ...
I wish you knew how the deepening
shadow
Lies on the blue and green again!

Dusk, and the curve of field and
hollow
Etched in gray when a star appears:
Sunset,... twilight,... and dark to
follow,...
And thoughts of you thro' a mist of
tears.

RUTH GUTHRIE HARDING

SONG OF THE WEARY TRAVELLER

I am weary. I would rest
On the wide earth's swelling breast,
Nurtured by the quiet sod
Where the fragrant dew has trod,
Soothed by all the winds that pass,
Hearing voices in the grass
Of the little insect things
Happier than the mightiest kings!

I am weary. I would sleep
In some quiet perfumed deep
Where no human touch could bring
Tears to me or anything.
There I would forget to weep

And my silent cloister keep,—
There I would the earth embrace
Meeting Beauty face to face.

I am weary. I would go
Where the fields are white with snow,
Where the violets are lain
Far from human strife and pain—
Far from longing and delight,
Thro' the endless starry night,
There I would forget to weep,
And my silent cloister keep.

BLANCHE SHOEMAKER WAGSTAFF

COBWEBS

Who would not praise thee, miracle
 of Frost?
Some gesture overnight, some breath
 benign,
And lo! the tree's a fountain all a-
 shine,
The hedge a throne of unimagined
 cost;
In wheel and fan along a wall
 embossed,
The spider's humble handiwork
 shows fine
With jewels girdling every airy line;
Though the small mason in the cold
 be lost.

Web after web, a morning snare of
 bliss

Starring with beauty the whole
 neighbourhood,
May well beget an envy clean and
 good.
When man goes too into the earth-
 abyss,
And God in His altered garden walks,
 I would
My secret woof might gleam so fair
 as this.

LOUISE IMOGEN GUINEY

BLIND

The Spring blew trumpets of color;
Her Green sang in my brain—
I heard a blind man groping
"Tap—tap" with his cane;

I pitied him his blindness;
But can I boast, "I see?"
Perhaps there walks a spirit
Close by, who pities me,—

A spirit who hears me tapping
The five-sensed cane of mind
Amid such unguessed glories—
That I—am worse than blind!

HARRY KEMP

HERB OF GRACE

I do not know what sings in me—
I only know it sings
When pale the stars, and every tree
Is glad with waking wings.

I only know the air is sweet
With wondrous flowers unseen—
That unaccountably complete
Is June's accustomed green.

The wind has magic in its touch;
Strange dreams the sunsets give.
Life I have questioned overmuch—
To-day, I live.

AMELIA JOSEPHINE BURR

BEFORE MARY OF MAGDALA CAME

Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre.... The first day of the week cometh Mary Magdalene early ... unto the sepulchre.... And ... she turned herself back, and saw Jesus standing.... Jesus saith unto her, Mary. She turned herself, and saith unto him ... Master. St. John.

From silvering mid-sea to the Syrian
 sand,
It was the time of blossom in the
 land.
On field and hill and down the steep
 ravine,
Ran foam and fire of bloom and
 ripple of green.
The Sepulchre was open wide, and
 thrown

Among the crushed, hurt lilies lay the
Stone.

A light wind stirred the Garden:
everywhere

The smell of myrrh was out upon the
air.

For three days He had traveled with
the dead,

And now was risen to go with stiller
tread

The old earth ways again,
To stay the heart and build the hope
of men.

He made a luster in that leafy place,
His form serene, majestic; His face
Touched with a cryptic beauty like
the sea

Lit by the moon when night begins to
be.

The cold gray east was warming into
rose

Beyond the steep ravine where
Kedron goes.

Now suddenly on the morning faint
with flame

Jerusalem with all her clamors came
—

A snarl of noises from the far-off
street,

Dispute and barter and the clack of
feet.

A moment it brawled upward and was
gone—

Faded, forgotten in the deep still
dawn.

He passed across the morning: felt
the cool,
Keen, kindling air blown upward
from the pool.
A busy wind brought little tender
smells
From barley fields and weeds by
April wells.
Up in the tree-tops where the breezes
ran
The old sweet noises in the nests
began;
And once He paused to listen while a
bird
Shouted the joy till all the Garden
heard.

There in the morning, on the old
worn ways—
New-risen from the sacrament of
death—
He looked toward Olivet with tender
gaze:
Old things of the heart came back
from other days—
The happy, homely shop in Nazareth;
The noonday shadow of a wayside
tree
That had befriended Him in Galilee;
Sweet talks in Bethany by the
chimney stone,
And night-long lingering talks with
John alone.
And then He thought of all the weary
men
He would have gathered as a mother
hen

Gathers her brood under her wings at
 night.
And then He saw the ages in one
 flight,
And heard as a great sea
All of the griefs that had been and
 must be....

As He stood looking on the endless
 sky,
Over the Garden went a sobbing cry.
He turned, and saw where the tall
 almonds are
His Mary of Magdala, wildly pale,
Fast-fleeting down the trail,
And suddenly His face was like a
 star!
He spoke; she knew—a blaze of
 happy tears;
Then "Master!" ... and the word rings
 down the years!

EDWIN MARKHAM

CONSCIENCE

Wisdom am I
 When thou art but a fool;
My part the man,
 When thou hast played the clod;
Hast lost thy garden?
 When the eve is cool,
Harken!—'tis I who walk
 There with thy God!

MARGARET STEELE ANDERSON

ROSA MYSTICA

This rose so exquisite,
So perfect, so complete,
Beauty beyond all price,—
With the hour it dies.

God makes Him roses fast,
With such magnificent haste,
Multitudes, multitudes,
In gardens, fields and woods.

The roses tell His praise
Their little length of days;
Testify to His name,
Gold on gold, flame on flame.

They are scarce here, scarce blown,
But they are gone, are flown;
The gardener's broom must sweep
 them
And in the darkness heap them.

Drift of rose-leaves upon
The garden-bed, the lawn:
The exquisite thought of God
Is scattered, wasted abroad.

What of the soul of the rose?
It shall not die with those;
It shall wake, shall live again
In God's rose-garden.

It shall climb rose-trellises
Before God's palaces;
The Eternal Rose shall cover
The House of God all over.

She shall breathe out her soul
And yet living, made whole,
Shall offer her oblation
Out of her purest passion.

She shall know all bliss
Where God's garden is:
The rose drinking her fill is
Of joy with her sister lilies.

Where the Water of Life sweet
Bathes her from head to feet,
The River of Life flows—
There is the Rose.

KATHARINE TYNAN

THE MYSTERY

He came and took me by the hand
Up to a red rose tree,
He kept His meaning to Himself
But gave a rose to me.

I did not pray Him to lay bare
The mystery to me,
Enough the rose was Heaven to smell
And His own face to see.

RALPH HODGSON

THE ROSE

And so must life be many-veined;

The loves that hurt, the fate that blent
My life with myriad lives and ways,
The processes that probed and
 pained,
The pencillings of nights and days—
Cross currents, tangling as they went,
With oh, such conflict in my soul!—
How should I know that they were
 meant
Just to make living sweet and whole,
Just to unclothe
God's perfect rose?

ANGELA MORGAN

FOR THESE

An acre of land between the shore
 and the hills,
Upon a ledge that shows my
 Kingdoms three,
The lovely visible earth and sky and
 sea,
Where what the curlew needs not, the
 farmer tills:

A house that shall love me as I love
 it,
Well-hedged, and honoured by a few
 ash trees
That linnets, greenfinches, and
 goldfinches
Shall often visit and make love in and
 flit;

A garden I need never go beyond,

Broken but neat, whose sunflowers
 every one
Are fit to be the sign of the Rising
 Sun:
A spring, a brook's bend, or at least a
 pond!

For these I ask not, but neither too
 late
Nor yet too early, for what men call
 content,—
And also that something may be sent
To be contented with, I ask of fate.
 EDWARD THOMAS (EDWARD EASTAWAY)

SAMUEL GARDNER

I who kept the greenhouse,
Lover of trees and flowers,
Oft in life saw this umbrageous elm,
Measuring its generous branches with
 my eye,
And listened to its rejoicing leaves
Lovingly patting each other
With sweet æolian whispers.
And well they might:
For the roots had grown so wide and
 deep
That the soil of the hill could not
 withhold
Aught of its virtue, enriched by rain,
And warmed by the sun;
But yielded it all to the thrifty roots,
Through which it was drawn and
 whirled to the trunk,

And thence to the branches, and into
the leaves,
Wherefrom the breeze took life and
sang.
Now I, an under-tenant of the earth,
can see
That the branches of a tree
Spread no wider than its roots.
And how shall the soul of a man
Be larger than the life he has lived?

EDGAR LEE MASTERS

SEEDS

What shall we be like when
We cast this earthly body and attain
To immortality?
What shall we be like then?

Ah, who shall say
What vast expansions shall be ours
that day?
What transformations of this house of
clay,
To fit the heavenly mansions and the
light of day?
Ah, who shall say?

But this we know,—
We drop a seed into the ground,
A tiny, shapeless thing, shrivelled and
dry,
And, in the fulness of its time, is seen
A form of peerless beauty, robed and
crowned

Beyond the pride of any earthly
 queen,
Instinct with loveliness, and sweet
 and rare,
The perfect emblem of its Maker's
 care.

This from a shrivelled seed?—
—Then may man hope indeed!

For man is but the seed of what he
 shall be,
When, in the fulness of his
 perfecting,
He drops the husk and cleaves his
 upward way,
Through earth's retardings and the
 clinging clay,
Into the sunshine of God's perfect
 day.
No fetters then! No bonds of time or
 space!
But powers as ample as the boundless
 grace
That suffered man, and death, and
 yet, in tenderness,
Set wide the door, and passed
 Himself before—
As He had promised—to prepare a
 place.

Yea, we may hope!
For we are seeds,
Dropped into earth for heavenly
 blossoming.
Perchance, when comes the time of
 harvesting,

His loving care
May find some use for even a humble
tare.

We know not what we shall be—only
this—
That we shall be made like Him—as
He is.

JOHN OXENHAM

"LORD, I ASK A GARDEN"

Lord, I ask a garden in a quiet spot
where there may be a brook with a
good flow,
an humble little house covered with
bell-flowers
and a wife and a son who shall
resemble Thee.

I should wish to live many years, free
from hates,
and make my verses, as the rivers
that moisten the earth, fresh and pure.
Lord, give me a path with trees and
birds.

I wish that you would never take my
mother,
for I should wish to tend her as a
child
and put her to sleep with kisses, when
somewhat old
she may need the sun.

R. AREVALO MARTINEZ

MY FLOWER-ROOM

My flower-room is such a little place,
Scarce twenty feet by nine, yet in that
 space
I have met God; yea, many a radiant
 hour
Have talked with Him, the All-
 Embracing Cause,
About His laws.
And he has shown me, in each vine
 and flower,
Such miracles of power
That day by day this flower-room of
 mine
Has come to be a shrine.

Fed by the self-same soil and
 atmosphere,
Pale, tender shoots appear,
Rising to greet the light in that sweet
 room.
One speeds to crimson bloom,
One slowly creeps to unassuming
 grace,
One climbs, one trails,
One drinks the light and moisture,
One exhales.
Up through the earth together, stem
 by stem,
Two plants push swiftly in a floral
 race,
Till one sends forth a blossom like a
 gem,
And one gives only fragrance.
In a seed,

So small it scarce is felt within the
 hand,
Lie hidden such delights
Of scents and sights,
When by the elements of Nature
 freed,
As paradise must have at its
 command.

From shapeless roots and ugly
 bulbous things,
What gorgeous beauty springs!
Such infinite variety appears,
A hundred artists in a hundred years
Could never copy from a floral world
The marvels that in leaf and bud lie
 curled.
Nor could the most colossal mind of
 man
Create one little seed of plant or vine
Without assistance from the First
 Great Plan,
Without the aid divine.

Who but a God
Could draw from light and moisture,
 heat and cold,
And fashion in earth's mold,
A multitude of blooms to deck one
 sod?
Who but a God?
Not one man knows
Just why the bloom and fragrance of
 the rose,
Or how its tints were blent;
Or why the white camellia, without
 scent,

Up through the same soil grows;
Or how the daisy and the violet
And blades of grass first on wild
 meadows met.

Not one, not one man knows,
The wisest but suppose.
This flower-room of mine
Has come to be a shrine,
And I go hence
Each day with larger faith and
 reverence.

ELLA WHEELER WILCOX

"VESTURED AND VEILED WITH TWILIGHT"

Vestured and veiled with twilight,
Lulled in the winter's ease,
Dim, and happy, and silent,
My garden dreams by its trees.

Urn of the sprayless fountain,
Glimmering nymph and faun,
Gleam through the dark-plumed
 cedar,
Fade on the dusky lawn.

Here is no stir of summer,
Here is no pulse of spring;
Never a bud to burgeon,
Never a bird to sing.

Dreams—and the kingdom of quiet!
Only the dead leaves lie
Over the fallen roses
Under the shrouded sky.

Folded and fenced with silence
Mindless of moil and mart,
It is twilight here in my garden,
And twilight here in my heart.

ROSAMUND MARRIOTT WATSON

THE FRUIT GARDEN PATH

The path runs straight between the
 flowering rows,
A moonlit path hemmed in by beds
 of bloom,
Where phlox and marigolds
 dispute for room
With tall, red dahlias and the briar
 rose.
'Tis reckless prodigality which throws
 Into the night these wafts of rich
 perfume
Which sweep across the garden
 like a plume.
Over the trees a single bright star
 glows.
Dear garden of my childhood, here
 my years
Have run away like little grains of
 sand;
The moments of my life, its hopes
 and fears
Have all found utterance here, where
 now I stand;
My eyes ache with the weight of
 unshed tears,
You are my home, do you not
 understand?

AMY LOWELL

WOOD SONG

I heard a woodthrush in the dusk
Twirl three notes and make a star—
My heart that walked with bitterness
Came back from very far.

Three shining notes were all he had,
And yet they made a starry call—
I caught life back against my breast
And kissed it, scars and all.

SARA TEASDALE

A PRAYER

Teach me, Father, how to go
Softly as the grasses grow;
Hush my soul to meet the shock
Of the wild world as a rock;
But my spirit, propt with power,
Make as simple as a flower.
Let the dry heart fill its cup,
Like a poppy looking up;
Let life lightly wear her crown,
Like a poppy looking down,
When its heart is filled with dew
And its life begins anew.

Teach me, Father, how to be
Kind and patient as a tree.

Joyfully the crickets croon
Under shady oak at noon;
Beetle, on his mission bent,
Tarries in that cooling tent.
Let me, also, cheer a spot,
Hidden field or garden grot—
Place where passing souls can rest
On the way and be their best.

EDWIN MARKHAM

THE PHILOSOPHER'S GARDEN

*"See this my garden,
Large and fair!"*
—Thus, to his friend,
The Philosopher.

"'Tis not too long,"
His friend replied,
With truth exact,—
*"Nor yet too wide.
But well compact,
If somewhat cramped
On every side."*

Quick the reply—
*"But see how high!—
It reaches up
To God's blue sky!"*

JOHN OXENHAM

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Transcriber's Notes:

Punctuation and obvious spelling errors repaired, but variant spellings retained.

Inconsistent indentations within a poem were retained.

In original, book title "Melody of Earth" appears twice at beginning, and "Index of Titles" and "Index of Authors" headings appear twice before their respective indexes. These redundancies were removed.

Shaemas O Sheel: name occurs consistently with no punctuation after the O.

Spaces were removed from spaced contractions: for example, "'t was" to "'twas," "that 's" to "that's," "did n't" to "didn't."

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